Maps and Keys

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Mature

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Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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by masternoveller

Summary

Adora is being chased by monsters as she comes across an unexpectant Catra.
As they get to know each other, more pieces of a map show up on Adora's body.
Following the map that appears on Adora's body to hopefully figure out why these creatures are out to get her.

Notes

To adventure!

See the end of the work for more notes

Just Hanging Around

This was the safe place Catra came to when she needed to be away from everything. It was her tower to utilise whenever she felt like, since it did fall into her part of the lands, and no one would be watching her. Entrapta and her had built a few towers together and they owned the ones they built. The towers were rented out to other companies that wanted to add antennas onto the structures that wouldn't inhibit Entrapta's own. Catra didn't have much in terms of possessions, but she did have a lot of land. That's how she lived, the rent covered more than what she needed in terms of expenses, and she didn't spend more than what was essential. She had also spent almost a year building her own home with the help of Scorpia and Entrapta's robots.

It was another slow day, Catra had climbed to the top of one of the towers, perching herself on the platform. She has a rope attached to herself to stop herself from falling off if she happened to roll off in her slumber. She's about to drift off for a mid-morning nap when she hears someone breathing heavily, running through the field beneath her. She looks down and in the mid-morning sunlight and she spots her. A blonde running through the field. Her hair coming undone from her ponytail as she runs raggedly away from someone or something. Catra looks around to see what she is running from and that's when she sees it. The blonde is being chased by a large beast with horns, claws and fangs. Quickly swinging into action, Catra swings down off her 50m tower platform.
"Hey! Up here!" She yells to the blonde. "Grab the rope!"
The blonde manages to catch the rope and Catra starts pulling her up the few meters to the ladder in the middle of the tower.
"Climb up here!" Catra yells again as she makes her way further down to meet the blonde halfway, "Come on!"
The blonde starts frantically climbing up the ladder as Catra quickly pulls the rope up, hauling the rope up, securing it off to herself. It doesn't take long before the blonde's climb up the ladder slows and then eventually stops as fatigue sets in. Catra

meets up with the blonde who is now desperately holding onto the ladder.
"Hey!" Catra says breathlessly, "I'm going to tie this rope around you, just in case you let go. Okay?"
The blonde nods weakly as Catra ties a double bowline and slips the blonde legs through the loops, with another couple of loops tied, Catra's got the rope around the blonde's arms, making it into a full body harness. She gives it a tug, it's secure. Catra grabs another shorter rope off her belt and ties the blonde onto the ladder.
"You can let go now." Catra says breathing heavily, "You're tied off to the ladder. Lean back and rest your arms."
Hesitantly, the blonde lets go of the ladder and leans back into her rope harness, a relieved look on both their faces as the blonde turns to Catra, "Thank you." She says softly.
Catra nods as she climbs across to one of the beams and sits down on it, balancing her body on the beam. "Yeah, no problem." Catra tries to say without sounding like she's about to cough up a lung.
The blonde laughs while shaking out her arms, "I'm Adora."
"Catra." She gestures to the tower, "And, welcome to my tower."
Adora laughs again, "I had no idea you could own a tower. But thank you for letting me get halfway up."
Catra grins, "There's still another 25m or so to get to the top. Whenever you're ready. I've got supplies at the top."
Adora leans forward on the ladder and tests out her grip on the rungs, she lets out a hiss as she wraps a hand around one of the rungs, "If it's okay with you, I think I might hang here for a while. I don't think I can climb just yet."
Catra comes closer, "Lemme see your hands?"
Adora reluctantly holds her hands out as Catra inspects them. There are scratches on the back of her hands from running through the fields. That's when she spots why Adora hissed. On her left hand was a few splinters and her other hand looked bruised.
"Is it bad?" Adora asks nervously.
Catra shakes her head, "Nah, but let me pull out those splinters first. Don't want them getting deeper." Catra looks up, "Let me go

grab my pliers and maybe some tweezers or something."
Adora gives Catra a look like she doesn't want to be left alone, but she doesn't voice it, instead she says softly, "Okay. I'll just wait here?"
Catra smiles, "Yeah. Just uh, hang around for a bit. Whatever that was chasing won't be able to get you from this height. You'll be safe here." Catra looks down to see if she can see the beast, "Looks like whatever that was is gone now anyways."
"It's not." Adora says flatly, "Its hiding. Waiting."
Catra just nods, "Well, it can wait a little longer then." She puts a reassuring hand on Adora's shoulder, "I'll be right back, okay?"
Adora nods this time, "Promise?"
"Promise." Catra replies earnestly, gently squeezing Adora's shoulder, "Don't worry. I've got you."

Letting go of Adora's shoulder, Catra starts climbing up the ladder to the top platform, disappearing from Adora's sight for a few minutes. Adora hears something being set up on the top platform but can't make it out from where she is. A rope is then slowly lowered down, stopping just next to Adora's shoulder and then she hears Catra climbing back down the ladder.
Catra is back and face to face with Adora, securing herself on the ladder as well as she hangs her kit bag on the ladder just a rung above them, so the opening of the bag is easily accessible.
"Hand?" Catra asks, holding out hers while wielding a pair of tweezers in her other. Adora puts her right hand out and into Catra's awaiting hand, "No, dummy!" Catra laughs, "Your other hand. The one with the splinters in it."
Adora's face goes red in embarrassment as she laughs nervously, "Sorry."
"It's alright Adora." Catra reassures now holding Adora's left hand in hers as she starts pulling out the splinters with the tweezers, "Does it hurt?"
Adora shakes her head, "No. Feels better now that some are out."
Catra hums, "Good. Just got a few more and then we can get it covered."
The splinters in Adora's hand aren't too deep, so they come out quite easily with the tweezers. When Catra is satisfied she's got all

of them she looks up into Adora's blue eyes, her face instantly reddening, "Oh wow."
"What?"
"Your eyes." Catra says, looking away and putting the tweezers back into her bag while digging out some bandages, "They're so… blue."
Adora blushes and it's the cutest thing Catra has seen in a while. The blonde clears her throat, "Thank you." She replies shyly, "But I've never met someone with two different coloured eyes before."
An awkward chuckle comes from Catra, "…yeah, guess I'm just a rarity."
They smile at each other as Catra takes Adora's left hand again, started to bandage up the hand.
"I don't think I can climb to the top, Catra." Adora admits, disappointed in her voice, "My hands hurt too much."
Before Catra can stop herself, she kisses the palm of Adora's left hand after she's bandaged it, before her eyes quickly widen and she stutters out an apology, "Oh! I'm so sorry! I didn't mean to do that."
A shy giggle comes from Adora, "It's okay. You did make it feel better."
Catra smiles nervously, "Uh, yeah." She rubs the back of her neck, "It's just something that I've always done whenever my friends got hurt."
The look in Adora's eyes is so soft that it makes Catra's heart melt, "That's really sweet."
"Guess it was always a good luck kind of thing." Catra reiterates, "I don't really have many friends…"
Adora's smile doesn't waver. She looks up, "What's the rope for?"
Catra finally snaps out of her thoughts, "Oh, yeah." She grabs the rope that she had lowered down before, "This is so I can pull you up to the top. Save your hands or whatever."
Adora isn't convinced. Catra doesn't look all that strong. Her arms are smaller in size than her own so instead she just gives Catra a confused look.
Catra chuckles, "I'm not done yet." Catra pulls out another two pulleys that are already connect and attaches it to the rope before clipping the end of it to Adora's rope harness, "Now, it's done."

Looking down at the contraption she's connected to, "…and what is this for?"
"It's to pull you up, dummy." Catra responds as she puts on some gloves, "You don't look light." Adora huffs at that before Catra continues, "And you don't look all that heavy either. So this five to one should do the trick to get you to the top. Reckon your legs still work?"
Adora scoffs a little as a smile plays on her lips, "I think they do." She demonstrates by bouncing up and down a little on her knees, "Yeah, definitely still work."
Catra rolls her eyes, "You're such a dork!"
Adora actually laughs at Catra's reaction. It's then there's a roar from below, the creature that was chasing her before appears from underneath, trying to jump up pathetically before giving up and circling below. "See." Adora taunts, "I told you it wasn't gone. It was just hiding."
Catra's ears twitch up, "Yeah. And it reacts to your laugh apparently." Her voice now serious, "Why is that thing after you?"
Adora shrugs, "I don't know."
"Where'd you come from?"
Adora looks around the tower then points towards the woods, "Over there. There's a small village just on the other side of the woods there. I was just collecting firewood when that creature started chasing me." She looks down at the creature that has now settled on the ground beneath them, "I didn't do anything to it."
"Alright." Catra accepts, "Ready to get hauled up?"
Adora nods, "What can I do to help?"
"Use your legs to take some of the weight?" Catra responds, "It's a long 25m haul if you want to be dead weight."
Adora smiles, "My hands don't feel too bad, so I can probably climb a bit too."
Mirroring Adora's smile, "Sure. Just don't hurt yourself more than you already have."

It takes around 30mins to finally get Adora to the top of the tower. Once she's at the top, she flops onto the platform panting. Catra climbs up after her, unclipping the rope off the harness and untying Adora so she's not uncomfortable. Once all the ropes are

cleared, Catra sits back, leaning against one of the crossbars at the top breathing in and out heavily, catching her breath.
"How do you feel Adora?" she pants out, wiping the sweat from her eyes as she stands up to neatly coil the rope back up.
Adora rolls over to her side and smiles, "That harness was really uncomfortable."
A moment passes and they both laugh, "Of course it was dummy. What did you expect? It was a harness made from rope."
"I don't know what's worse, my hands or where the ropes were digging into." Adora replies, rubbing her shoulders and under her armpits where the rope's pressure was on.
Catra rolls her eyes but smiles as she sits back down, "Well, beats falling to your death or getting mauled to death by whatever that thing down there is."
"Yeah." Adora breathes out. Catra scoots next to Adora, "What are you doing?" Adora asks, sitting up.
Catra takes Adora's hands into hers, looking at them, "Does this hurt?" Catra asks lightly prodding Adora's palms. Adora shakes her head, "Good. That's really good."
Adora takes her hands back from Catra slowly, pressing on the bandages, "I think it helps that you got all the splinters out."
"Uh, yeah." Catra replies, not sure what to do with her hands now that Adora has taken hers back, "Are you injured anywhere else that I should know about?"
"Mm," Adora ponders, "Don't think so. Why?" a smirk appearing on Adora's lips, "Do you want to give my scrapes more kisses?"
Catra blushes, her tail fluffs up and her ears flatten, "Very funny." She crosses her arms in front of her and huffs, "I was just making sure you weren't going to die."
"I wouldn't mind though…" Adora shyly says, Catra looks up at her incredulous, "more kisses…I mean."
Catra smiles, "Depends if you've got more scrapes." A smirk comes over Catra's face as her confidence returns, "Get some rest Adora. And then we can figure out what to do next."
Adora tries to get comfortable, but the metal grated platform is anything but idea, digging into her body and feeling like it's bruising her bones. Catra notices and pulls out a few blankets from a small storage box in the corner of the platform forming a

makeshift bed. She gestures for Adora to come over and lie on top of the blankets. Adora complies, moving slowly as her body aches with the effort of the day.
“How do you sleep up here?” Adora asks gently laying down on top of the blankets, “It’s so uncomfortable.”
Catra chuckles, “I don’t sleep the same way humans do. I only need to make sure I’m tied onto the tower, so I don’t accidentally fall from wherever I end up falling asleep.”
Adora giggles as it quickly morphs into an extended yawn, stretching her arms and legs out before her body flops down onto the makeshift bed. “That’s cute.” Adora mumbles with her eyes closed, not catching Catra’s eyes roll at the comment.
“Sleep, dummy.” Catra says affectionately, “I’ll be here when you wake up.”
“You’re not sleeping either?” Adora asks with her eyes closed.
“No.” Catra replies simply, “I’ll keep watch.”
“Mm.’ Is all Adora can muster up before the sound of soft snores take over and her breathing slows.

Facing the Beast

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora have to figure out a way to get back down without being killed by whatever is hunting Adora.
The first of the part of the map appears on Adora.

Chapter Notes

I was going to post this on Sunday but realised there's a good chance I'll forget...
Holidays and all, right?
Anyways, here's the next chapter nice and early.
Comments are always welcome :)
Enjoy the read.

Catra, true to her word keeps watch over Adora the entire time as the blonde sleeps. Looking down every so often to keep an eye on the creature below them. She noticed the creature had gotten up and walked away from the bottom of the tower not that long after Adora had fallen asleep. With her superior eyesight she could see the creature moving around the edge of the tree line. Every so often it would perk up, its horns penetrating the through the tree line giving away its location. Catra breathes out, rubbing her temples as she thinks of a strategy to get Adora out of this predicament. Well first thing was to figure out what was attracting this creature to the blonde. She looked over at the sleeping beauty on the platform close to her, sure, she was attractive in a damsel in distress kind of way, but that's not what she needed to figure out. There must be something about her that was drawing the creature to her. But what?
Snapping out of her thoughts suddenly, she sees Adora start to stir. The blonde's eyes fluttering open as she let out a squeak as she yawned. A soft smile on her lips as she her eyes focused on Catra who looked over at her with a smile of her own.
"Hey." Adora rasped out, "How long was I out for?"
"About an hour." Catra replied scooting over to sit next to Adora,

“Your friend is still lurking below us, on the edge of the tree line.” Adora slowly gets up, stretching out her arms and legs before leaning over the railing to look down towards the tree line. “I don’t know why it’s following me.” Adora whispers to herself before screaming down towards the creature, “Leave me alone!” The creature steps out from its hiding spot beneath the trees and growls up towards the blonde, “Okay Adora. Just remain calm. It’s not going to be able to get up to us here anytime soon.” Catra tries, “Let's just go over how this all started. Okay?”
Adora takes a long calming breath in and closes her eyes, “Alright.” She sits back down on the blankets and pulls her knees up to her chest, “Like I said, I was out in the woods collecting firewood when that creature started chasing me.”
Catra nods, “Good. Have you seen this creature before?” Adora shakes her head, “Okay. Well, it certainly has its focus on you. Something must have happened for it to come after you like this.” Adora pulls her knees even closer to her chest, “I had a dream last night.” The words are spoken so softly that only Catra’s hybrid cat ears could just pick up. Catra just nods in acknowledgement that she heard Adora’s statement. “It… it was so vivid. Like I was living it in real life.”
“What did you dream of? Do you remember?” Catra prods, coming close enough to lay her hands gently onto Adora’s knees. Adora nods as she closes her eyes tightly, “Can you tell me more?”
“I remember running through this field.” Adora starts, she opens her eyes, “Then I remember… you.”
“Me?” Catra’s voice raises slightly, “But you’ve never met me before until today.”
“I know.” Adora speaks into her knees, “I dreamt of everything that happened up until the point where you helped me onto the ladder.”
Catra nods. She’s sure that Adora isn’t lying, but what she’s said is incredulous. “It feels like we might be linked.”
Adora looks up into Catra’s eyes, “What do you mean?”
“I had a dream too.” Catra admits shakily, “But I only saw blue eyes. Your blue eyes.”
“How do you know it was mine?” Adora asks, lifting her head up a

little more, “You can’t be sure it was mine.”
Catra shakes her head, like she’s shaking the image of the dream eyes from her memory, but it doesn’t fade, “No.” she simply says, “I know those eyes belong to you.” She looks into Adora’s blue eyes intently, “I’ve dreamt of those eyes more times than I can count. And when I look into your eyes now. I’m sure they belong to you.”
Adora looks away with a blush on her face, “It’s your eyes too. It’s rare to find eyes like yours anywhere.” She lays her hand on top of Catra’s, which still happens to be on top of her knees, “I don’t know how to describe it. I think we were supposed to meet.”
“I think this is all coincidence.” Catra replies, sounding like she’s trying to convince herself as well, “I don’t believe in fate or any of that crap, honestly.”
Adora giggles at Catra’s statement, “How can you be so sure? Something has pushed us into meeting. And those dreams, I mean, how would you explain those?”
“Coincidence.” Catra repeats, “Anyways, from the sounds of things, that creature down there was just trying to stop you from meeting me.”
“Now who’s the one believing in fate?” Adora teases.
Catra rolls her eyes at Adora, “No. I still don’t believe in any of that crap. So, let’s just find a way to get you back to where you came from.”
Catra stands up abruptly, hands on her hips are she looks down to find the location of the creature. Adora stands up as well, moving shoulder to shoulder with Catra. She gently nudges Catra, expecting Catra to scowl or yell at her. Except, Catra just returns the nudge playfully.
“Catra?” Adora asks. Catra hums a response, “Thank you. For saving my life.”
Catra wraps an arm around Adora’s shoulder, pulling the blonde into her side. Adora leans her head on Catra’s shoulder, “It was my pleasure, Adora.” With a gentle squeeze, Catra continues, “I’m glad I could help. Now we just need to get you down safely and away from whatever it is down there.”
Adora doesn’t move, “Do we have to do it right now though?”
Catra breathes in Adora’s scent before sighing, “Yes, we do.” She

pulls the blonde into her, so they are now face to face, “We need to get down from here before the sun goes down.”
“Why?”
“We don’t want to be out in the open at night. Trust me.” Catra warns, “Come on.”
Catra breaks their connection and goes to pick up her backpack, rope and puts on her jacket over her long sleeve shirt, before swinging the backpack over her shoulders. Adora just watches, not really knowing what to do.
“So, how are we doing this?” Adora asks fidgeting with her fingers, “Do you even have a plan?”
Catra smirks, “Of course I do.” The smirk drops as it turns a little more serious, “How does your body feel?”
Completely misunderstanding what Catra is asking, Adora blushes as she stutters out an answer, “Uh, I don’t know…normal? Soft?”
Catra’s eyes widen at the double entendre, “No, sorry. I meant how’re your injuries?”
“Oh!” the blush on Adora’s face somehow gets redder, “Yeah, uh, it’s not, uh, it’s not too bad. See?” She holds her hands up, taking the bandage off, showing Catra. Upon seeing Adora’s palm, she promptly grabs the hand and inspects it further, “Catra? What are you doing?”
Catra turns Adora’s palm over so they can both see, “This wasn’t here before. Not when I pulled out those splinters.”
Adora takes a closer look at her palm, “I don’t know.”
“It looks like a map.” Catra runs her fingers along the lines of the image on Adora’s hand giving it a gentle rub, “It’s not coming off.”
“No?” Adora just looks at her hand.
“Does it hurt?” Catra is now cupping Adora’s palm in hers. Adora shakes her head, “Let me have another look? See what it really is?”
Adora holds her palm flat as Catra keeps it still in hers, “Do you know what it means?”
Catra looks closer, her eyes widen, “Yeah, I think I know where this is.” She points to a line on Adora’s palm, “This is a town not too far from here. I know it. We built a tower just outside of the town so they could get communication to the kingdom up and running.”

Adora smiles, “That’s amazing Catra!”
Catra can’t help but smile back, “Uh, yeah… anyways, I think that’s where we need to go.” Catra lets go of Adora’s hand as she starts making her way to the ladder. She starts down the ladder before turning her head up to see Adora, “Stay up here, okay? I’ll be right back.”
“Catra!” Adora yells as she watches Catra climb down the ladder faster, “What are you doing? The thing is still down there!”
“I’m going to slay your beast!” Catra yells back up the ladder.
“What? No!” Adora screams as she scrambles to get to the ladder, only to find that her hands still hurt and gripping the rungs makes it worse, “Stop! It’s going to kill you!”
“Don’t worry about me! I’ve got this!” Catra yells back up, her voice getting more distant, “Trust me!”
Adora stares down the ladder, biting her bottom lip and fearing for the worse as she sees Catra get to the bottom of the ladder and move across the bottom tower sections, sliding down the beams to the ground. Catra is in the centre of the tower, feet on the grass below, she stands her ground, her own claws out and her ears on high alert. In a second the beast rushes out and across the bottom of the tower. Catra isn’t there anymore. There’s no sign of her.
“Catra!” Adora screams, a sob breaking out, “Catra!” she screams out again when there’s no sign of Catra. “No…” Adora starts to sob. She collapses down onto the platform, unsure what to do with herself.
There’s a roar from beneath. It makes Adora shudder at the thought her new friend, Catra, who saved her life from that creature has been killed by the same. The tears still stream down her face as another roar is heard from the tree lined. It sounds like whatever it is in pain. And then a heavy thud, rattling a few trees and scaring off the birds that were perched in them, making them scatter into the sky above.
That’s when Adora sees her. Catra. She stumbles out from under the tree line and starts to make her way up the tower. Catra smiles, all fangs as she retracts her claws once she’s up on the platform. Adora rushes over and wraps her arms tightly around Catra.

“Hey Adora,” Catra rasps out, “I’m okay. I told you I’d take care of it, didn’t I?”
“Don’t do that to me ever again!” Adora angrily says as she grips Catra even tighter in her arms.
“I’m sorry.” Catra mumbles into Adora’s neck, “I didn’t mean to scare you.”
“Well, you did!” Catra can feel the tears on her face that have rolled down Adora’s cheeks, “I can’t lose you too!”
“Woah!” Catra pulls them apart, “What?”
Adora’s frowns at the forced separation, “I can’t lose you too!”
“What do you mean? Too?” Catra asks confused, “You’re not losing me.”
Catra pulls Adora back into her arms, “I’m sorry.” Adora sobs in Catra’s arms, “I was just so scared.”
Catra shushes her, trying to calm Adora down. Running her fingers through her blonde hair, “I’m sorry. But I’m not going anywhere. It’s okay.” Catra keeps talking until she feels Adora calm down, she takes Adora’s bruised hand and give the palm a soft kiss.
“Can you climb?” Catra asks into Adora’s palm.
“Not really.” Adora gets out, “My hands both really hurt.”
“Rope harness?” Catra asks, as Adora grimaces remember how uncomfortable it was last time, as Catra chuckles, “I’ve got an actual harness here for you.”
Catra pulls out a proper full body climbing harness and shows it to Adora who just raises and eyebrow at her, “You’ve had this all along?”
“Yeah?”
“And you still pulled me up in the rope harness?” Adora pouted.
“Yeah?”
“You know that the ropes hurt right?” Adora continued on her line of questioning.
“Yeah?”
“Really? Catra?” Adora whined.
“Adora.” Catra deadpanned, “I was really fucking tired after climbing up and down this 50m twice. Not to mention it would have been more dangerous for me to swap you out of what you were clearly safely secured to.”
Adora’s expression softened at the realisation that the rope that

Catra had tied around her had saved her life, so being angry with Catra wasn't really fair. She scoffed instead, "Fine. I'll use that harness. I'm not doing the rope one again."
Catra smiled, "Here, let me help you put this on.'
Once Catra had suited Adora up with the climbing harness she rigged a rope up and showed Adora how to use the descender to abseil down with.
"What about you?" Adora asked as she readied herself to go down the tower.
Catra grinned, "Are you worried about me?"
Adora frowned, "Yes. I am."
"You don't need to worry about me." Catra answered earnestly, "I'm going to climbing down the ladder next to you, just in case."
"Are you using a harness to climb down too?" Adora asked, then teased, "Maybe the rope harness?"
Catra chuckled as Adora giggled at her own joke, "No, I don't need a harness. I can climb up and down this tower all day if I had to." She paused, "As long as I'm not sprinting up and down this thing, it's really not a problem for me. I mean I did help building them after all." Catra looked deep into Adora's eyes for a second too long before she caught herself, "So, shall we?"
After about half an hour, they both made it safely to the ground. Catra pulled the end of the rope and with a flick the rope dropped to the ground. Once all their gear was packed up, they set off to the town that was indicated on Adora's splintered palm.

First Stop

Chapter Summary

They get to the first stop on Adora's map and meet up with Bow and Glimmer.

Chapter Notes

Happy new year! Almost...
So new chapter.
Enjoy!

“What happened to the creature that was chasing me?” Adora asks, her hands fidgeting on the hem of her shirt.
“I killed it.”
The way Catra said it sent shivers up Adora’s spine, “What do you mean, you killed it?”
“I killed it.” Catra repeats, “Slit its throat and pulled out its innards.”
“That was graphic.” Adora replies surprised and a little intimidated, “What was it?”
Catra shrugged her shoulders, “I don’t know. It was ugly looking and smelt really bad.” Catra paused before the next part, “But it looked crazed. Kind of like it was possessed. Its eyes glowed weirdly, like mirrors or like they were glazed over. When I killed it, the glow in its eyes disappeared and it looked like it was in peace.”
“Thank you again Catra.” Adora said wrapping her hand around Catra’s wrist, “No one’s ever looked out for me like that. I was kind of an oddity where I came from.”
Catra grinned and slipped her hand into Adora’s, “Yes, you are quite the oddity.”
Adora snorted a laugh, “Shut up!” Catra giggled as they continued to walk down the path to their next location, “Where are we going anyways?”
“We are going to a place called Bullivia. Like I said, Entrapta and I built a tower just outside of that town to improve their

communications capabilities.” Catra explained, “It’s a days travel from here. So, we’ll need to make camp or find a town with lodgings. Personally, I prefer to make camp. Cheaper.”
“You seem like someone that’s self-sufficient.” Adora observes her travel partner, “I think camp will suit me just fine as well. I don’t have much money on me, so I doubt I’d be able to pay for lodgings.”
“You wouldn’t be paying for lodging Adora, I would.” Catra flatly stated, “I want to help you.”
“Why? You don’t even know me.” Adora blushed as she loosened her fingers in Catra’s hand.
Catra squeezed back gently, “I know. It feels like I do, you know? Like I’ve known you all my life yet I’ve just met you.” Catra blurts out, “I don’t believe in fate or any of that crap. Pretty sure you already know that… But you make me feel like I’ve found... home.” She glances over at Adora, who’s face has now got even redder, “Sorry, that was too much. I just, well, there’s a reason I don’t have that many friends.”
“So, am I a friend?” A hopeful look on Adora’s face.
Catra holds up their connected hands, “I think this definitely counts as that. Perhaps something more?” A smirk comes over Catra’s face before falling to a nervous look just as quickly, “I didn’t mean to be so forward. Forgive me.”
Adora smiles, “It’s okay Catra. I’m flattered.”
Catra returns the smile, “Thank you. I’ll try to be a little more respectful moving forward.” Catra goes to release her hand, only for Adora to hold on this time.
“This is okay. For me.” Adora says softly, “It feels…safe.”
“Yeah?”
“Yeah, okay.”
They walk hand in hand until Catra lets go, blaming her sweaty palms and making Adora giggle as she watches Catra wipe her hands on her pants. They come up to a small town, the sign on the road says Kojun. It’s got a few places for lodging and a few places to eat. They head into a tavern about midway through the town call ‘The Golden Egg’. Once inside, they approach the bar.
“What can I get you lass?” The bar wench addresses Adora, eying Catra up and down, “No shoes, no service.”

Catra growls as Adora places her hand on Catra's shoulder to calm her down, it seems to work and Catra crosses her arms over her chest. "My friend and I were after some food, if that's possible."
"You," she points at Adora, "are welcome here. Your friend however, we do not serve their kind." The bar wench spits out, "So make yourself comfortable and I can bring some food out to you. Your friend will need to wait outside. I don't need her scaring away my customers."
Adora frowns. Before she can say or do anything she might regret, Catra pulls her outside, "It's not worth it. Just get something to eat and I'll meet you over by the town hall after."
"No." Adora resists, "I'm not spending any money here. If you are not welcome, then I am not welcome. We can find somewhere else."
Catra isn't sure what to say, she is used to being looked down upon, but for Adora to stand up for her is new. "It's fine. I'm used to it."
"It's not right though."
"Yeah." Catra agrees.
"Come on." Adora pulls on Catra's arm, "I think I saw a cart over there with food."
A smile tugs on Catra's lips as she's pulled along by Adora to the small cart on the far corner of the town. It's run by a lizard hybrid. Adora looks lost on what is on offer, so Catra takes over and orders enough food for the both of them, paying the lizardman a little more than the price. The lizardman waves them off with a smile.
They find a quiet spot to sit to eat their food. Adora takes a bite of the barbequed skewered meat on a stick and her face instantly shines approval for the meal choice, "Oh wow! This is so good! I've never had anything like this before!"
Catra chuckles, "Yeah, it is really good. Have you never travelled outside your village before?"
Adora shakes her head, "No. I always wanted to but I didn't have the means to. I mean, not that I have to the means to now…"
"Yeah, it's okay Adora." Catra reassured her friend, "I've got us covered. If you've finished eating, we should get back on the road. There's still a long way to go."

Adora nodded as she wiped her hands on her pants and stood up. She reached out for Catra's hand and it felt right. Catra didn't flinch. Just gave Adora's hand a gentle squeeze. "I'm ready. Let's go!"
The started on the trail again, finally leaving the town of Kojun and back to the well-travelled road. They greeted the few people they came across heading back into town but continued walking and talking, taking in the landscapes. About an hour into the trek, Adora hisses, clutching her right calf.
"What's wrong?" Catra stops and asks.
"Can we stop for a bit?" Adora clutches her calf with a grimace on her face, "It's just a little sore from running and climbing and whatever it was we did on the tower."
Catra nods in understanding, "You know what? I think we've gone far enough for today." She looks towards the woods, "I can see a clearing over there, we can set up camp there for tonight and you can rest up." Adora nods standing upright before hissing again. Catra quickly puts herself under Adora's arm so she can support the blonde up, "Reckon you can make it over there? I won't make you climb any trees."
Adora sees the mischievous grin on Catra's face, "Thanks. Besides I don't want to be hoisted up in that rope harness again." She nudges Catra with her hip as they both giggle, "Are we safe to camp so out in the open."
"Ah, I see you also never camped out before either." Catra's fangs on display as she smiles widely, "Didn't take you for such a princess."
"I am not a princess." Adora refutes defiantly, "I just haven't really done much."
"Sure…" Catra teases, "What did you used to do where you came from? You said you were a bit of an oddity?"
They stumble to the clearing and Catra sits Adora down on the soft grass and lets her lean against a tree stump, she moves to sit next to her, pulling out the cask of water and handing it over to the blonde. Adora takes a long drink before handing it back, wiping her mouth with her shirt sleeve before answering Catra's question, "I was on night watch. Lived on the border of town in a small tower. It was me and my mum, until she passed."

“I’m sorry to hear that Adora.” Catra says softly.
“Thanks. She just got really sick one day.” Adora sniffs, “Then it happened so quickly. She died a few days later. Her fever was just too much and she died in her sleep.”
Catra pulled Adora into her, clutching her tightly against her, “You’re alright.” Catra soothes, “I’m not going anywhere Adora.”
“That’s why…” Adora pauses, “That’s why I was so scared before when you disappeared into the trees and I thought the creature had killed you.”
“Yeah, not my brightest moment huh?” Catra tries to lighten the mood, it works a little before she continues, “I’ll uh, try to stop being so reckless.”
“Thank you.” Adora whispers.
“Rest up here for a bit while I set up camp, okay?” Catra gestures to Adora’s leg, “I won’t be too far away from you. Just call out if you need anything.”
Adora nods as Catra goes off into the woods to collect and forage for their camp.
It’s not long before Catra is back, helping the blonde up to the camp she’s just set up. There’s a fire roaring in the centre in front of a makeshift shelter that Catra has made. She’s laid down the blanket she’d brought with them from the tower and helps Adora to sit on it. The sun has started to set and the cool breeze sets in. Adora watches the fire as Catra continues moving around the camp.
“This is the first time I’ve camped.” Adora says to no one’s surprise.
“Of course, it is princess.” A cheeky grin on Catra’s face as Adora rolls her eyes, she’s too tired to snark back so she lets it go, “Hope you’re hungry.”
Adora’s eyes lights up as she smiles happily at Catra, “Always.”
“I caught some rabbits in the woods before whilst getting firewood.” Catra explains as she skewers the gutted animals onto the sticks she’s fashioned into cooking implements, “Hope that’s okay.”
“Yeah, that sounds really good actually.” Adora watches Catra set her catch over the fire to cook, “I’m sorry I’m not much help.”
“Oh, you help plenty.” A smirk on Catra’s face as Adora raises an

eyebrow at her, “I mean, you’re nice company. I mean, it’s nice to have good company or whatever.”
Adora just smiles softly back at Catra “You’re not so bad yourself.”
They watch the fire crackle and cook their food in silence. Once they’ve eaten Adora lies back in the makeshift shelter waiting for Catra to join her. When she doesn’t, she sits back up, “Aren’t you going to bed too?”
Catra clears her throat, looking bashful, “Uh, I don’t think that’ll be a good idea Adora.”
“What do you mean?” Adora’s eyebrows furrow in confusion.
“Sleeping together.” Catra simply says, “I don’t think it’s a good idea to do that.”
“Why not?” Adora fidget with the blanket bed under her, “It’s not like we are going to do anything but sleep.”
“I don’t trust myself around you.” Catra mutters embarrassed, “I think it’s better if I keep watch tonight just in case.” She says a louder to drown out her first sentence.
“Catra.” Adora’s voice stern, “Come here.” Catra shakes her head, “Please?”
“Okay.” Catra relents, she knows it’s almost impossible for her to say no to Adora.
“I’ll tell you if you do something that makes me uncomfortable alright?” Adora says, “But right now, I would really like if you cuddled me.”
Catra’s eyes widen, “Wait, like really?”
Adora giggles a little embarrassed from asking now, “Yeah?”
“You sure?”
“Oh my gosh! Yes, Catra!” Adora says flustered, “I’d feel better knowing you were holding me while I slept. If you’re okay with that.”
A smile creeps onto Catra’s face, “Yeah, I can do that.” It’s more for herself than Adora when she says it but the smile that Adora returns is just too sweet that Catra settled herself behind Adora, holding the blonde close to her chest and breathing in the scent of her hair, “Goodnight Adora.”
“Goodnight Catra.”

Catra awakens first, her arm is numb from something heavy laying on top of it. When the sleep finally clears from her eyes, she sees Adora still fast asleep in her arms. Her light snores warm Catra's heart. She could get used to this. She could get used to Adora falling asleep in her arms. She could get used to waking up to the blonde in her arms. But for now, she needs her arm back.
"Adora?" Catra softly says as she gently shakes the blonde lying on top of her arm. Adora's eyes flutter open, "Good morning princess."
"Hey." Adora manages to say.
Catra smirks, "Can I have my arm back please?"
Adora jolts up, "Oh, I'm so sorry! I didn't mean to…"
Catra chuckles at Adora's awkwardness, "It's fine Adora. It was actually pretty nice. I haven't been able to sleep through the night since…well, not since I can remember."
They exchange smiles as Catra gets up and shakes her arms out, getting the blood flow back into her limbs while Adora rubs her eyes and stretches from where she is. Catra grins at the blonde and holds out her hand, helping Adora up off the ground and onto her feet.
"How far from Bullivia are we?" Adora asks, picking up the blanket and rolling it up neatly and handing it over to Catra who ties it onto her backpack, "My leg feels a little better today."
Catra eyes Adora leg, staring a little too long at her friend before clearing her throat, "Uh, that's good." Running a hand through her shortened hair, "Just, uh, let me know if it gives you any more trouble, okay?"
Adora nods, "So…does that mean you'd carry me if it does give me more trouble?" a smirk comes across her face, "Not that I wouldn't mind being carried…"
"Princess." Adora blushes at the pet name, "If you want me to carry you anywhere, just say so. You don't need to be so cryptic about it." Catra grins at Adora's reaction, "But…if we want to get to Bullivia before sun down, we should get going now." Catra chuckles when she sees Adora actually pout, "Come on. Grab the rope and we can get back on the road."
After a little more banter they finally get back on the road. It's a fairly long walk to the next town, they pass the time kicking a rock

back and forth until Adora accidentally kicks it off the road and into some bushes. Catra rolls her eyes and goes to retrieve it, making Adora giggle.
"You don't have to Catra!" she says in mirth, "There's plenty of other rocks around. It doesn't have to be that one."
"It's the principle." Catra point out as she ducks off into the bush, "Almost…got…it. Yes!" Holding the rock up in her above her head proudly, "See? Told you. Worth it."
Adora rolls her eyes, "Fine. You must be so proud."
Catra just grins wider at her, nods and throws the rock back down in front of them and they start kicking it down the road again.
They walk another hour before Catra stops suddenly. Adora pauses slightly in front of Catra, before she can say anything, Catra's is digging through her backpack. She pulls out two apples and throws one to Adora, grinning widely.
Adora fumbles catching the apple but manages to without dropping it, this time she holds it proudly above her head to show Catra. Catra smiles as she watches Adora bite into the apple, wiping her mouth of the juice she says softly, "Thanks."
"No problems." Catra bites into her own apple and slings the backpack back on and they continue walking. Catra looks further ahead and tells Adora, "I can see the tower from here. So, it's not too far now."
Adora nods, "I can't see it." She squints her eyes off in the distance, "How can you see that far?"
Catra laughs, "Forget I'm not human already?"
"No!" Adora huffs, "I don't know what you can or can't see."
"There's a heap of things you don't know about me." Catra teases, "As I'm sure there's a heap of things I don't know about you."
"What do you want to know about me?" Adora shyly asks.
"Uh, I haven't really thought about it." Catra replies rubbing the back of her neck, "Anyways, if I think of something, I'll ask you."
Eventually they get to Bullivia, the sun is starting to set. Catra takes Adora's hand in hers and leads them to a building that looks like a bar. The sign reads, 'Stingers Tavern'. They go inside and there's a mix of people inside. Humans and hybrids mingle happily.
"What is this place, Catra?" Adora whispers into Catra's ear.

The warm breath over Catra's ears send a warm shiver down her spine and she swallows hard, "My friend Scorpia owns this bar. We'll be safe in here. Plus there's actually rooms with beds."
Adora's face lights up when she hears bed, "Thank goodness! I can't wait to sleep in an actual bed tonight."
"Plus they've got some pretty good food." Catra adds, "Lemme see if I can find Scorpia."
Not letting go of Adora's hand, Catra drags the blonde around the tavern until she spots her very large and very muscular friend. Scorpia looks up from where she's pouring a drink and her face immediately lights up with the biggest smile Adora has ever seen. Scorpia then sees Catra hand clutching Adora's and that smile turns smug. "Wildcat!" she yells, "What are you doing here?"
"Thought I'd just drop by." Catra replies, "Got any rooms available here?"
"Of course, Wildcat!" Scorpia replies happily, "We never rent out your room. Did you forget what I told you last time?" Catra rolls her eyes, "I told you, you would always have a place here. Free of charge."
Catra grins, then turns to Adora and then back at Scorpia, "Uh, how about a room for Adora here?" Catra just realised something, "Oh shoot! Scorpia, this is Adora. Adora this is Scorpia."
Letting go of Catra's hand, Adora shakes Scorpia hand. "It's nice to meet you Adora!"
"You too." Adora smiles, "Um, how do you guys know each other?"
"It was Catra that built the communication tower that put us on the map." Scorpia beams looking at Catra, "Her and Entrapta had this big plan and I did not think it would work. But, here we are now. Now this village can get updates on anything we need. We felt so out of the loop for so long."
Adora nods, a grin on her face as she looks at Catra, "I knew you were a softy!"
"I am not." Catra protests, putting her arms across her chest, "Scorp? Room for Adora?"
"Gosh! Sorry! Yes, let me check." Scorpia pulled out a big book and started flipping pages then she made a sour face, "Oh, I'm so sorry Wildcat! We are actually booked out this week."

“Oh, that’s okay. I’m sure I can find…” Adora started to say when Scorpia cut in.
“Why don’t you just stay with Catra?” Catra looked away as Scorpia continued, “The beds are pretty big so you wouldn’t even need to be touching. Plus there’s some extra blankets so you don’t have to share the one.”
Catra turned her back to the bar that Scorpia was leaning on, “I’m okay with that if you are.” She casually says to Adora, “Otherwise we can find another place.”
“Ooh, yeah, that’s not going to happen Wildcat…” Scorpia cut in again, “Everything is booked out in town for the big harvest festival.”
“Well, I guess that settles it.” Adora tries to say calmly, “I’m okay with sharing a bed with you.”
“Great!” Catra claps her hands together, “We can drop our stuff off in the room and then come back to grab some food.”
Adora nods and they head to the room to drop off their stuff. When they come back out, Scorpia has a table ready for them on the side wall of the tavern. They sit down across from each other as food and drink gets placed on the table in front of them. Catra gives Adora a smug look as Adora looks confused. “Go on.” Catra gestures to the food, “I know you’re hungry.”
Adora didn’t need to be told twice and they both start digging into the food and drink. Catra’s ears twitch along with her nose as she picks up on an unfamiliar scent in the tavern. Usually her senses aren’t overwhelmed with such rich smells, but it turns her attention to a couple sitting on the opposite side of the tavern doing their best to look nonchalant. A low growl sounds in Catra’s chest as Adora stops eating and leans in, “What’s wrong?”
Catra gets up without a word and walks over to the couple, her hand hovers over her pocket where she keeps her knife, “Who are you and why are you watching us?”
The couple are both surprised by Catra standing in front of them, the boy speaks up first, “Uh, hi! I’m Bow and this is Glimmer.”
Glimmer groans into her hands, “What are you doing Bow?!” she screams muffled into her hands before she looks up at Catra who now has her arms crossed, waiting for an answer, “We aren’t watching you. We were just…”

“Just?”
“Having a meal.” Bow cuts in, “Yeah, you know, because we’re hungry and all.”
Catra leans on the table, baring her teeth and clawing at the surface, “If you do anything to hurt me or my friends, I will end you. Both of you.” With that she steps back once she’s satisfied with the shock on their faces and heads back to her table with Adora.
“What was that about?” Adora asks munching on a potato piece.
“Nothing worth getting worried about.” Catra sighs, “Finish your meal and we can get some sleep.”
“Okay.” Adora smiles happily back as she continues to eat, “This is really good.”
Catra grins, “Yeah, I know.”
Once they’ve done eating, Catra notices the other couple has left. Catra grabs Adora by the hand and leads her back to the room. They fall into bed without getting changed. Catra pulls the blankets up over them and immediately cuddles in behind Adora.
“Is this okay?” Catra whispers into Adora’s hair.
Adora swallows loudly, nodding, “Yes. It’s nice.”
They fall asleep quickly.

Confrontations

Chapter Summary

Glimmer and Bow explain why they are really there.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra wakes up first again. Once again Adora has fallen asleep on her arm pinning Catra down under her. Catra sighs but can't help the smile that appears on her face. It's quickly replaced by the feeling of pins and needles in her arm as it starts to go numb under the blonde. Catra taps Adora lightly on the shoulder, trying to wake her up. Nothing. She tries again. Adora just turns over before moving her body back into Catra's. As much as Catra enjoys this, her arm is protesting very loudly. A brilliant idea comes to Catra's mind. She leans into the blonde's hair, brushes away a few strands from around her ear, exposing it. A wicked grin on Catra's face as she sticks her tongue into Adora's ear.
"What the?!" Adora jolts up, hand covering her ear as Catra cackles next to her now that her arm is free, "What was that?!"
"Sorry princess," Catra says between breaths, "you fell asleep on my arm again and it was the only way to wake you."
Rubbing her ear, Adora returns a shy smile, "Uh, sorry again."
"It's fine Adora." Catra waves it off, "Breakfast?"
Adora yawns, rubbing her eyes and stretching. Catra watches as her shirt rides up a little as Adora's arms stretch above her head. Adora settles back down on her back on the bed, "I could eat."
Catra gets off the bed and heads to get ready for the day as Adora turns onto her side and watches. Catra sees her looking and Adora looks away, "See something you like?" Catra teases.
"Maybe." Adora replies shyly.
Catra comes back to the bed, running her hand along Adora's arm. It sends a shiver up Adora's spine when Catra does it as her breath hitches. Catra eyes Adora intently, making the blonde blush. The moment is broken when Catra breaks eye content and

laughs. Adora huffs as she pushes Catra off the bed. Catra continues to laugh but quickly stops when she grabs Adora's right hand. The bruise is still there, but it's faded enough for Catra to see another piece of the map.
"You've got another piece of a map on this hand." Catra continues to inspect the dark lines on Adora's palm, "I think it's a continuation of the map on your other hand."
Carefully extracting her hand from Catra's grip, Adora takes a good look at the new line work, "I don't recognize this."
"I do, unfortunately…" Catra replies, "It's not a good place."
"Where is it?" Adora asks as she sits up.
"This is Talon. It's basically run by criminals. Really, really bad people." Catra answers running her a clawed hand through her hair, "It's not a place people go to just visit."
"Have you been there before?" Adora rests her hand on Catra's, trying to comfort her friend, "We don't have to go."
Catra tries to smile at Adora's attempt to comfort her, she puts her other hand on top of Adora's, sandwiching it in between hers, "I think we should get some breakfast and then go from there."
Adora nods and rolls off the bed and to the bathroom to get ready.

When they get to the tavern for breakfast, the couple from last night are there, busy chatting and eating their meals. Catra sees Glimmer and glares. Bow seeing the change in expression from his partner turns around and spots Catra. He waves happily to Catra and Adora, while Adora waves unsurely back.
"Aren't they the couple from last night?" Adora whispers into Catra's ear. Catra nods, "Do you know them? Oh, they're coming over…"
Catra rolls her eyes as the other couple comes up to the pair. Bow reaches out for a handshake that Adora hesitantly accepts. He beams excitedly when she does, "Hi! I'm Bow. This is Glimmer. It's so nice to meet you!"
"Uh, hi?" Adora replies with an uncertain smile, "Nice to meet you?"
Glimmer steps out in front of Bow. Catra moves herself between them and Adora. "Can we help you Glitter?" A low growl coming

from Catra, it subsides when Adora put a reassuring hand on Catra's shoulder.
"We didn't catch your names." Glimmer states, putting her hands on her hips expecting an answer.
Catra snarls, "What's it to you?"
"Just trying to be friendly." Bow pipes up.
"Are you guys following us?" Adora asks from behind Catra.
Bow looking anxious at having to lie turns to look at his partner to answer. Glimmer moves her arms and crosses them in front of her chest, "We weren't following you. We were following the beast chasing you." She looks at Adora when she says beast. "How did you get away from the one? The one that chased you from your village?"
"Ha!" Catra yells, "I knew they were following us!" Before Glimmer can even process what's happening, Catra has Glimmer pushed up and pinned against the far wall, her claws threatening Glimmer's face, "Tell me, Glitter. Why are you following blondie here?"
Bow runs over and stops a few steps short in case, while Adora follows promptly but stands close to Catra. Glimmer eyes Catra's claws that are close to her eyes, "Fine."
When Glimmer doesn't elaborate, Catra pushes Glimmer further into the wall, "Well?"
"She's the map!" Bow blurts out. Glimmer rolls her eyes at her partners admission.
Catra turns to look over her shoulder, still holding Glimmer tight against the wall, "Map? Explain."
"Can you let Glimmer go first?" He asks politely, "We can sit down and talk without anyone getting hurt."
Catra turns back to Glimmer whose face is still hardened with annoyance, "I'll let Glitter down as long as she doesn't try anything. Same thing goes for you."
Glimmer groans but grits out a response, "Fine." As Catra releases her, Glimmer adds, "We weren't going to do anything to Adora anyways."
"Wait. How do you know my name?" Adora asks standing behind Catra, "We never told you our names. Right?" Catra nods.
Glimmer makes a face of frustration, "I knew it! You were following me!"

“What’s going on Adora?” Catra asks without turning around, her claws waiting to come out. She eyes Glimmer, “Talk. Glitter.”
“Okay, seriously, my name is Glimmer. Glimmer!” Glimmer screeches, “Put me down! Now!”
“I don’t think so.” Catra lifts Glimmer up so her feet are now off the ground, “I don’t take orders from you.”
Glimmer huffs indignantly, “Fine. We’ve been following Adora because those monsters are after the map.”
“Okay. And what does this map lead to? And don’t lie to me.” Catra’s claws prick into Glimmers skin a little as a hiss of pain escapes Glimmer.
“It leads to the weapon that’s supposed to bring peace to the world! That’s all I know!” Glimmer struggles against Catra, “Now. Let me down!”
Adora hand gently squeezes on Catra’s shoulder. Catra sighs, “Okay.” She lets go of Glimmer, making her nearly topple over when she her feet hit the ground.
Bow helps Glimmer up. He gestures to a table with four seats, “Now that that’s out of the way… should we sit down and talk?”
Catra and Adora exchange glances before Catra pulls out a chair for Adora to sit, then sits next to her. They wait for Bow and Glimmer to join them. Catra waves to one of the servers and then clears her throat, “What do you two want with Adora?”
“We just want the maps.” Glimmer says with a glare, “That’s all.”
Adora looks to Catra, “Have you actually seen the maps?” Catra flicks her tail onto Adora’s lap so she can fidget with it instead of her hands where the couple can see.
The couple look sheepish as they shake their heads, Catra snickers, “So, let me get this straight.” She looked over at Adora, who was still patting her tail in her hands, “You’ve been following Adora for all this time, but you’ve never even seen this map?” The pair nod, “How do you even know she has the maps?”
It’s at this point, Bow pulls out a book that looked older than the three of them combined. He gracefully opens it up and turns it to face Catra and Adora. Adora’s eyes go wide, “Where did you get this?”
The page that Bow has turned to, has sketches of Adora. The first page is of her in happier times with her mother before she got

sick. The next page showed Adora crying as her mother was buried. More sketches appeared on each page from when she was being chased by the beast, to sleeping at the top of Catra's tower, eating the apple when they were walking to Bullivia and the last page is of Adora on her side in bed from this morning. There are no pictures of Catra in the book as Adora flips through the pages again to check. And sure enough, there aren't.
"My dads are librarians back in Bright Moon. This one caught my eye one day." He reached for the book again and closed it to show them the cover. "Can you read this?"
Adora squinted at the writing on the front, "It says; The Hero's Sword." She turns to Catra, "What does that mean?"
Bow's eyes widen as Adora read the cover, "How could you read that? It's in an old language from over a thousand years ago."
Adora just shrugged, "Okay… well this means that you're important. Do you have the maps? Can I see them?"
Catra growled, "Yeah, I don't think so."
Adora's hands were back on her lap, patting Catra's tail as the conversation looked to be getting heated again. But just as a full blown argument was about to erupt, Scorpia came round with their breakfasts.
"Oh Gosh, Wildcat and Adora! Good morning!" Scorpia greets so brightly that even Catra can't not be moved by it, "Here are your breakfasts. Enjoy!"
Glimmer raises an eyebrow at Scorpia greeting, "Wildcat huh?"
Catra looks up from her breakfast and glares at Glimmer, "I've heard about you." A smug smile on her lips as she thinks, "That's right. Wildcat. Leaves a trail of broken hearts wherever she goes."
"Shut up Sparkles." Catra growls.
"What?" Glimmer acts all innocent, "Didn't Adora know about that sordid reputation of yours?"
Adora stops eating and looks at Catra with new eyes before turning to Glimmer, "It's none of your business Glimmer."
"Just trying to warn a girl." A smirk on Glimmers face, feeling victorious, "I wouldn't want you to end up as another girl with a broken heart because of… Wildcat."
Catra pounces out of her chair and knocks Glimmer down to the floor, "I told you to shut up!"

Glimmer laughs, “I knew it!” She says through her laughter, “Of all the people that she comes across, you have to be the key.”
Catra stops herself from clawing out Glimmers eyes as she processes what the sparkly one had just said. Menacingly, Catra slowly lifts herself up and off Glimmer, retracting her claws, “Explain.”
“If you really are the key then you’ll be able to unlock the map from Adora.” Bow looked down at his feet for a moment then muttered, “That was a little bit of a weird sentence.”
Catra goes back to her chair and resumes eating breakfast. “And where exactly is this map from Adora?”
Bow’s face blushes a bit, “I was hoping the literature wasn’t so… literal.” He mumbles again before looking up to actually answer the question, “Apparently you can unlock the map from her… body…”
Glimmer rights her chair back up and retakes her seat, with a smug look on her face, “Guess all your practice will come in handy then?”
Adora blushed at the innuendo, as Bow cleared his throat, “So, the literature says that the key unlocks parts of the map by, um, bodily contact?” His voice went up an octave as he finished the sentence.
Glimmer feeling rather emotionless, “Adora. Where are the maps on your body?”
“Yeah, no. That’s not happening Glitter.” Catra cut in protectively as Adora’s blush deepened, “What do you get out of this?”
Bow puts his hands up defensively, “Nothing.” His eyes dart around to Glimmer and then back at Catra, “We just want to… uh… tag along?”
“Yes, but why?” Catra asked more irritated this time, “Why is this so important to you?”
Glimmer looked away, as did Bow. Then something struck Catra, “I know you.” Catra pointed to Glimmer. Glimmer just huffed in response as Catra tried to go back through her mind to find the link that was pulling at her. Snapping her fingers, startling her table mates, “Aha! I thought you looked familiar! You’re a princess!”
“Shush! Don’t yell it to everyone!” Glimmer hissed as Catra sat

back with a satisfied smirk on her face, “Fine! Whatever. I’m trying to prove to my mother that I can retrieve the sword and bring it back home so we can defeat our enemies.”
The table was silent. Bow and Glimmer sat staring at the table in front of them while Adora continued to eat, but at a much slower pace. Catra sat back in her chair, deep in thought. Finally Catra broke the silence.
“Okay.” Is all Catra said before resuming her breakfast.
Adora looked over at Catra with a questioning look as Bow squealed with glee, “Thank you! Thank you!” He almost jumped out of his chair with excitement. “We promise you won’t even know we are there!”
Catra snorted a laugh, “Yeah right!” When she collected herself, she gestured to the pair, “We aren’t leaving until tomorrow.”
“Where are we going?” Glimmer asked skeptically, “Since we haven’t even seen the maps.”
Adora blushed again, “Do you have to see the maps?”
Glimmer gave her a look that conveyed – isn’t it obvious, instead she went with, “It’d be nice. You know, sharing information.”
Catra leaned forward, “You didn’t exactly share information with us. I had to guess.” Catra looked at her empty plate and sighed, “Look, it’s up to Adora if she wants to show you.” They exchanged a quick look and Catra grinned wickedly, “Say. Since you’re a princess and all… what have you got in the means of transport?”
Adora leans forward like Catra had done, “Glimmer. Bow. Here.” Adora holds her hands out, palms up as Glimmer and Bow lean forward inspecting them. “The one of the left appeared first and then the one on the right recently. Catra thinks it goes to Talon.”
Glimmer and Bow exchange worried glances, “Talon is a scary place from what I’ve heard. It’s run by criminals…” Bow explains, “Are you sure?”
Catra rolls her eyes, “Yes. I am very sure.” She taps her claws against the tabletop, “So about that transport?”

They eventually figure out transport, which means that Glimmer gets them two horses for their trip and they agree to meet up at the tavern for breakfast tomorrow morning before heading off to Talon. Once all that is set, Catra and Adora decide to take the rest

of the day to explore Bullivia. It's a fairly small town, but it's one that Catra is quite familiar with. As they walk the around the streets, the occasional woman will wave or greet Catra, others would just glare and then turn away. Catra shrugged it off all the same but Adora's mood wasn't getting any better. Eventually Catra leads Adora to just outside of town and points out the huge communications tower. It's a four-legged tower made of grey steel about 60m high with a ladder going up one of the legs. There were quite a few antenna dishes on this tower, pointed in different directions and at different heights.
"You built this?" Adora asked amazed.
"Not by myself. Took a whole team of people and some machines. But yeah, the town built it." Catra answered nonchalantly, "I think I spent a good six month at Scorpia's tavern."
"All the dishes up there?" Adora pointed up, "What are they for?"
"Oh, Entrapta has a bunch up there for her own uses. I really don't know what she uses them for." Catra smiled, "And the other dishes are for the towns communications to talk to other towns or villages. We built it here as this town would be the first to sound the alarm if there were invaders on the front."
Adora smiled, "That's really cool Catra."
"Yeah." Catra replied trying not to boast, "So listen." Adora leans in, "The maps on your hands…"
"Mmhm?"
"I just realised they only appear after I've…uh…" Catra scratched the back of her neck feeling a little embarrassed, "After I've kissed you there."
"Oh!" Adora leaned back looking at her palms, "I didn't really think about it to be honest…"
"Do you think what Bow and Glitter said is true? The you're the map and I'm the, uh, key?" Catra shoved her hands into her pockets instead, "Because that book he had was really weird. It's like it was spying on you or something."
Adora nods, "I know. But at the same time, it kind of feels like we were supposed to meet them. You know?"
Catra agrees, "Yeah. But at least we won't have to walk the entire way to Talon and your calf won't give out again." Catra teases, "Plus we'll make good time to get there since I won't need to

carry you.”
Adora pouts at Catra’s teasing, “I’ll let that one slide, for now.” She points in Catra’s direction, “But you can’t make fun of me when I get to name our horse tomorrow.”
Catra laughs as Adora turns and crosses her arms trying to look serious before they both break out in laughter, “That's fine Adora. Name the beasts for all I care.”
“I will.” A smile comes across Adora’s face, brighter than before as she grabs Catra’s hand in hers, “Is it true? The whole…Wildcat thing?”
“Adora.” Catra says in a warning kind of tone mixed with teasing, “Don’t ask questions you really don’t want to know the answers to.”
The cheeky grin on Catra’s face is enough for Adora to drop the line of question as they head back into town. They take the rest of the day to rest up. Mostly sleeping as much as possible.
The trip to Talon will be interesting with some new companions.

Chapter End Notes

Thanks for reading!
I'm taking my time with this one instead of rushing like my other chaptered fics.
Hope you guys are still enjoying them though.

Over the Bridge

Chapter Summary

> The group travel to Talon and encounter a creature under a bridge.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

True to their word, Glimmer and Bow provide two horses for the to travel on to Talon. They've managed to get a black horse and a white horse. Adora immediately runs to the two horses, pausing in time to avoid scaring them before showering both horses with love.
"So Princess," Catra asks, "Not you Sparkles, I was talking to Adora."
Glimmer huffs, "My names Glimmer!"
Ignoring Glimmer she turns back to Adora and points to the two horses, "What are their names?"
Catra holds finger up to stop Bow before he can answer as Adora thinks. "I think this horse should be called… Swift Wind." She nuzzles against the white horse, "And this one I think should be called Melog."
"Melog huh?" Catra ponders, "I like it. So which horse do you want to ride?"
Adora looks at both horses undecidedly, "I don't know!"
Glimmer cuts in, "We'll take Melog."
"Cool. That's settled." Catra agrees and they load up their gear and saddle up. Adora gets up on the horse and gets settled whilst Bow and Glimmer climb onto theirs, "I'll walk first."
"What?" Adora asks surprised, "I thought the whole idea with the horses was so we didn't have to walk."
"No Adora," Catra rolls her eyes, "The idea of the horses is so they can carry the equipment. I'm happy with walking next to the horses. Besides you're going to need to rest your leg anyways. It'd be a lot easier without me cramping up behind you."

Adora looks a little disappointed but accepts it anyways as Catra leads them out of Bullivia and onto Talon. Glimmer and Bow chat quietly amongst themselves. Mostly bickering about little things.

"So…" Catra starts, "Are you two, like together?" Catra asks their new companions.
Bow beams and is eager to answer, "Yes. It took a long time for this to happen though with Glimmer being a princess and all."
"What's that supposed to mean?" Adora asks, "You two look like you've known each other for forever."
"We have." Bow answers, "It just took a lot longer to realise what we wanted. Then there was the whole telling the Queen and that was… a… lot."
Glimmer sighs, "I can't imagine not being with Bow. He's my best friend."
"Saps! When's the wedding?" Catra teases whilst chuckling to herself.
"We're married!" Glimmer huffs stunning Catra. Glimmer smirks at Catra's shock, "What? Nothing to say now?"
Catra glares at Glimmer then in earnest replies, "Congrats. I'm happy for you two to have found each other."
"Now who's the sap?" Adora laughs.
"What about you two? How long have you been together?" Bow asks with a smile.
"We're not together." Catra and Adora answer at the same time, which makes Glimmer laugh.
"You two are ridiculous!" Glimmers laughs even harder. "Could have fooled me!"
Bow joins Glimmer in her laughter as Catra and Adora both exchange flushed looks.
"Okay, easier question, how long have you know each other?" Bow asks.
"Uh, a few days?" Adora answers looking at Catra, "Catra saved me from one of those monsters."
"Oh yeah, like in my book." Bow replies thinking back the text, "You guys seem really close. I mean I've never been threatened until I nearly wet my pants by someone just protecting a friend."
"You did that?" Adora looks to Catra, "You threatened them?"

"Yeah, I did." Catra scoffs, "They were sketchy as fuck."
Adora laughs, "Thank you for defending my honour." Catra cracks a smile, "Ha! I knew I could make you smile!"
Catra doesn't care and just smiles even wider, "Well, what can I say? You make me happy."
"Aww!" Bow coos at the pair, "You guys are just so cute!"
"Shut it, Arrowboy." Catra grits, "We are not cute."

They continue to rile each other up until they reach everyone needs a break and a chance to stretch their legs. Adora, Bow and Glimmer dismount the horses and start walking next to them whilst Catra goes off ahead to check out the track. With Catra gone, the pair decide to interrogate Adora on her own.
"So, you and Catra huh?" Glimmer teases, "Have you two like, done anything yet?"
Adora blushes, "No."
"You don't have to be embarrassed Adora." Glimmer replies softly, "I'm just messing with you. You seem really nice. Unlike your friend."
"Yeah, she can be pretty scary." Bow adds, "But she seems super cool though."
"Catra's…" Adora starts and then gets distracted at how soft her friend can be, "Catra's really nice and brave and thoughtful…"
"Sounds like someone's in love." Glimmer stretches out the 'o' in love as she continues to tease Adora, "You should totally make a move."
"What? No." Adora replies, her blush getting redder and spreading down her neck, "It's just too soon. We haven't even known each other for that long."
"So?" Bow asks putting his hands in his pockets as he walks, "You like her, don't you?"
"Well, yeah." Adora practically snorts with certainty, "But it's not that easy. And I really don't want to talk about it."
"Talk about what?" Catra interrupts.
"Geez! Don't do that!" Glimmer curses as all three of them jump back, "Wear a bell or something!"
Catra actually laughs at that comment, "Kinda rude!" They all break out in laughter at Glimmer's words, "But, uh, what are you

guys talking about?”
Adora looks to the pair with pleading eyes. Glimmer rolls hers as she answers, “Nothing special. Just shooting the wind.”
“Sure you were.” Catra replies, “You know I have pretty good hearing.” She turns to Adora, “It’s fine. We don’t need to talk about whatever this is now.”
Adora nods and breathes out a breath she didn’t know she was holding as they continue walking next to their horses. Catra reaches out and takes Adora’s hand in hers, intertwining their fingers while they walk as Glimmer and Bow watch from behind them, shaking their heads.
Catra’s ears catch the movement behind her and she turns back and sticks her tongue out at the couple, making Adora giggle at her childish antics.
“How’s the leg?” Catra asks looking down as they walk, “Do you want to get back up on the horse?”
“No, I’m good for now.” She squeezes Catra’s hand, “I like walking next to you.”
Catra grins, “I like being with you.”
Adora looks away blushing, “Are you always this sweet?”
Catra hesitates as she now turns away, “Uh, no actually. This is kind of new.” She turns back to look at Adora, “I’ve never really been someone that lets people in. That’s why I don’t have a lot of friends.”
“I’m your friend.” Adora reassures, “I’ll always be your friend. No matter what.”
Catra smiles, “Thanks. The whole Wildcat thing was… just me being immature. I’d like to say it stopped a long time ago but, it wasn’t really that long. About six months ago, I found myself with another woman but feeling nothing. That’s not true. I did feel something… Lonely.” Catra looked into Adora’s eyes, “Sorry, I didn’t mean to bring up my past.”
“No, it’s fine.” Adora tries to push down the jealousy, instead she goes down a different path, “Are you, um, still feeling lonely?”
A small smile appeared on Catra’s face, “No Adora. I don’t. Not since I’ve met you.”
“Good.”
Catra took Adora’s hand and kissed the back of it, making Adora

giggle and blush a little more.
"How far are we from Talon?" Glimmer shouts, breaking up the tender moment, "I've had enough of this road."
Catra rolls her eyes, "Should be there before sunset." Turning to look at Glimmer, "Trust me when I say we don't want to be out in the open after sunset in Talon."
Glimmer and Bow both nod as they quicken their pace. Their fear makes Catra laugh as she helps Adora back onto the horse so they can get to their destination faster. Glimmer and Bow soon follow suit when they realise they were falling behind.

They come up to a narrow bridge. Catra signals for everyone to stop. Her ears and tail twitching like crazy as she moves ahead a little from the group.
"Hey! Where are you going?" Glimmer shouts.
Catra turns around and signals for her to shut up, she gets a glare back from the sparkly princess, "Shh!" Her ears twitch forward towards the bridge, "There's something up ahead."
Adora dismounts off Swift Wind and quietly comes up behind Catra, she whispers, "What is it?"
Without breaking her focus on the bridge in front, Catra shrugs, "I'm not sure. But my gut tells me it's not a good thing."
Bow and Glimmer appear behind Catra. Bow pulls his book out of his pack and starts flipping through it and sure enough there's a picture of the bridge ahead along with what looks like a monster hiding under the bridge. Catra's eyes go wide. Bow nudges Glimmer, "I don't like this." He turns to Catra, "What do we do?"
"It's after Adora." Catra answers, "We need to keep it away from her."
"Right! And how do we do that?" Glimmer whisper-yells.
Catra turns around and they form a loose huddle of sorts, Adora keeps watch up ahead in case the monster decides to ambush them.
"Sparkles, do you have some king of magic?" Catra asks.
"Yeah, I can teleport. Why?"
Catra nods, turning to Bow, "How good are you with that?" She points to his arrows, "Because I'm going to need you to cover me."

"I'm good. The best in Bright Moon." He proudly says.
"Adora?" the blonde nods, "Take this."
Catra hands over her knife, "What about you?"
"Don't need it. I've got these." Sliding her claws out, Catra smiles, "I'll go first. If it's friendly enough to let us pass we won't need to fight it. But just in case it isn't…"
Adora nods, "Okay. Just be careful."
"You're crazy, you know that right?" Glimmer tells Catra, "I respect that."
"Thanks Sparkles." Catra turns back to the bridge, "Watch my back."
The other three stay back at a safe distance as they watch Catra casually but cautiously walk towards the bridge, her claws retracted and her ears high on alert. Catra inspects the path towards the bridge. There are some tracks around the bridge but she can't see any on the bridge at all. Which makes her think that no one has crossed this bridge in a very long time. That's concerning.
"Hello?" She calls out towards the bridge.
A low growl from under the bridge is the only answer she gets, but it doesn't sound like whatever is under there is moving. So Catra walks closer to the bridge, stopping just before the start of the bridge.
"Are you coming out or can we pass?" Catra calmly asks. Out of the shadow of the cave comes a creature with long slender arms and legs, gangly looking is the best way to describe it. The creature has claws longer than Catra's as well as sharp teeth, fangs sticking out and eyes red, looking rabid. "Woah… dude."
The creature stands at full height, twice as tall as Catra as it looks down at the magicat snarling. Catra takes a step back and the creature takes a swipe at her. She manages to dodge the first swipe and then ducks under the second. However, the third strike from the creature throws Catra across the bridge, winding her. As Catra gets up from the ground, trying to catch her breath she sees her 3 companions running in and attacking the creature from all sides.
Glimmer is distracting the creature by teleporting behind it and whacking it with her staff whilst Bow shoots arrows into the

creatures body, only a few connect the rest miss the every moving creature. Adora swings the knife at the creature covering the front whilst Glimmer gets it back. The creature manages to grab Glimmer and throws her into Bow causing the couple to smash into the ground with an almighty thump. Adora swings the knife again but it's caught easily by the creature as lifts the blonde up by her wrist that's holding the sword. Adora tries to kick at the creature but it has her held just out of range by her kicks. The creatures red eyes focus intently on Adora and it opens it's mouth roars lifting it's other clawed hand up to finish the job.
Adora closes her eyes as the clawed hand comes down the creature roars again, but this time in pain. When she opens her eyes, the creature has released its grip on her and dropped her to the floor. Glimmer teleports in and gets Adora out of the way as the creature falls forward, grasping its bleeding throat. When the creature is on the ground, Glimmer and Adora are met with a panting Catra on the creatures back, claws firmly dug into its neck and a gash to her forehead. She pulls her claws out of the creature's neck and pulls it's head up, exposing its neck. Staring directly at Glimmer, Catra quickly slits the creature throat with her claws, vanquishing any thought that the creature is still alive before jumping off the creatures back.
"Was that really necessary?" Glimmer protests, "It was already down."
"Yep and now it's dead. For sure." Catra replies walking up to Adora, grabbing the blonde's hand, "Are you okay?"
"Yeah, Glimmer got me out just in time." Adora replies.
Catra turns to Glimmer, "Thanks for helping her."
"You're welcome, Wildcat." Glimmer smugly accepts the thanks. Looking around she sees Bow still on the ground groaning, "I think you better help your boy, Sparkles."
"Oh, right!" Glimmer quickly rushes back to Bow and cradles him in her arms.
He smiles up at her, "Wow, that was…amazing!"
Catra rolls her eyes, "You two are ridiculous."
"You're hurt." Adora says with a wince, looking at Catra's gash on her head, "It doesn't look too bad, but we should probably get the patched up."

"I'm fine Adora. It's just a scratch."
Catra is interrupted by Adora's hand over her mouth, "Don't brush this off Catra. It might be worse than you think. Let me help you."
Looking into Adora's eyes, Catra relents and nods, "Okay. Patch me up princess."
A gentle smile comes over Adora's face as she cups Catra's face affectionately, "Okay, let me grab the first aid kit."
Adora comes back with the kit and starts cleaning up Catra's forehead, whilst Catra fights the urge to wince in pain as Adora wipes some antiseptic over the wound and finishes it off with a bandage to stop any further bleeding. She looks over to Glimmer and Bow, "Do you guys need the first aid kit?"
Bow sticks his thumbs up, "No. We're all good. But thanks!"
Glimmer comes over to Catra, "Again, you are crazy."
"I know." Catra replies with a grin, "Thanks for having my back. I mean it."
A curt nod is all the acknowledgement Glimmer gives before heading back to Bow and readying both horses to get going to the next stop. "Are you guys ready to go?" Glimmer shouts from where their horses are.
Catra and Adora both laugh at Glimmer's impatience and move towards the other couple, "Yeah, lets go." Adora smiles as she answers Glimmer, "I'll be happy when we get to Talon."
"You say that now…" Catra smirks, earning her a whack on the shoulder from Adora, "Ow!"
"That did not hurt you." Adora deadpans.
"True." Catra replies with a grin, "Do you want to get on the horse again? Might be quicker if we ride the rest of the way to Talon. Don't really want to have to take down another creature."
Glimmer and Bow mount their horse as Catra helps Adora get onto Swift Wind. "Are you riding as well?"
"No, I'm going to go ahead, make sure there's nothing hiding out front." Catra replies, "I'm faster on the ground."
"I think it's more you don't like riding horses." Glimmer pipes in, "Right, Catra?"
Catra glares at the princess, "No… that's not why."
"Uh huh, totally believable." Glimmer chuckles to herself, "But fine, pretend you're keeping an eye out in front."

“I am.” Catra argues, “I’m faster on all fours than a horse is.”
Adora snorts, “You think you’re faster than a horse?”
“I am! Why doesn’t anyone believe me?” Catra balls her hands into fists, “Do I have to prove everything to you?”
“Want to race?”
“No.”
“Why? Scared you’ll lose?” Adora taunts playfully, “I mean there’s nothing wrong with losing a race to a horse.”
“I am not racing a horse, Adora.” Catra rolls her eyes, “Also, I don’t want you falling off because of this stupid race you think we need to have.”
“I’m not going to fall off.” Adora pouts, “I’ve ridden enough horses in my lifetime that I am not going to fall off.”
“Still, no. I’m not racing a horse. Especially after taking down whatever that creature under the bridge was.” Catra crosses her arms, “I think I’ve proven myself to you already princess.”
Adora blushes, “Fine.”
Catra smirks as she sees Adora blush, “Alright. Lets get going. Follow me.”

“Two rooms, please.” Catra asks at the inn just inside Talon, it’s one of the safer ones in town, despite most not being safe. She turns to Bow and Glimmer, “Since you guys are married and all.”
Bow beams with pride and Glimmer just wraps an arm around him, “That’s fine with us.” Glimmer squeezes Bow a little before asking Catra, “And you two are sharing a room?”
“Safer this way.” The blunt response from Catra doesn’t deter Glimmer.
“Sure it is…” Catra doesn’t pay any attention to Glimmers smugness, “Bet you’ll also be sharing a bed too.”
“We’ve been sharing a bed since before Bullivia.” Adora innocently chimes in, “Catra makes me feel safe.”
The statement warms Catra’s heart and without realising it, her face as well. She happy her fur covers it blush. The man at the inn hands over two sets of keys and points up the stairs.
“What time does dinner start?” Catra asks the innkeeper.
“Half hour from now.” The innkeeper gruffly says.
Catra nods to the man and the group head up to their rooms.

Glimmer and Bow's room is right next to Catra and Adora's which is convenient in case anything happens they'll be able to wake the other ones up faster than being further apart. Catra watches the other couple disappear into their room, telling them to meet downstairs for dinner in an hour. Meanwhile when Catra closes the door to her room she sees Adora already flopped on the bed on her back with her eyes closed, she's still got her boots on, but respectfully keeps them off the bed. Catra smiles at the sight of Adora so relaxed. She moves to kneel next to the bed and begins taking off Adora's boots, placing them next to the bed and then lifting Adora's legs onto the bed. Adora shifts slightly, getting into a more comfortable position now that her feet are on the bed. She makes grabby motions to Catra.
"Really Adora?" Catra teases.
Adora pouts like a child, "Please?"
A roll of Catra's eyes before she stands from her kneeling position, "Okay, fine."
"Yay!" Adora celebrates as she wraps her arms around Catra's body, "Thank you."
"Anything for you princess." Catra replies melting into Adora's warmth, "Get some rest before we head down for dinner."
"Okay." Yawning as she answers, "Mm, you're so soft."
Catra doesn't reply, instead she lets her purr rumble in her chest as Adora squeezes her just a little tighter in her arms. Before Catra closes her eyes, she starts to see faint lines on the back of Adora's hand from when she had kissed it yesterday. Deciding it's not worth worrying about yet, she lets it go until after they nap.

The hour goes by quicker than they both expected as Catra nudges Adora to wake up. Adora groans at being awaken and tries to pull Catra in closer.
Catra chuckles, "Come on, get up princess."
"5 more minutes…" Adora pleads sleepily, "I'm too comfy right now."
"I'm not missing dinner because you want to sleep longer." Catra warns.
Adora groans again, but this time lets go of Catra and stretches her arms. "Fine." She huffs.

There's a loud knock on their door. "Quit fucking around guys, I'm hungry!" Glimmer shouts through the door.
Adora blushes and hides her face in the pillow as Catra smiles fondly at her. "We'll meet you down there, Sparkles!"
"Hurry up!" Glimmer shrieks as they loudly make their way downstairs.
Catra helps Adora put her boots back on and they head downstairs for dinner. It's pretty quiet in the tavern tonight with only a handful of other tables being occupied. Looking around, the patrons inside all seem pretty decent, most of them have tattoos, but nothing gang related so Catra can relax on that front. Their tattoos mostly deter others to stay away from them. This makes Catra's group stand out, none of them have visible tattoos, but Catra makes sure that her knife is on display along with her claws as she taps them on the table while they wait for their dinner.
"Adora, your hand." Bow points out to the darker lines formed on the back of Adora's hand, "It's another piece of the map."
They all glance down at Adora's hand on the table. Glimmer looks at Catra, "Aren't you the Casanova?" she teases, "Smooth."
"Shut up Sparkles." There's no bite in the comeback as Catra examines the map on the back of Adora's hand, "I don't know this one."
"Oh, I know this one!" Bow says excitedly, he goes to hold Adora's hand as Catra growls at the action making Bow flinch and retract his hand, "Sorry!"
Adora smirks at Catra, "A bit possessive over there aren't we?"
Catra just growls in response as Adora giggles.
Bow moves to get a closer look at the map on the hand to confirm where he thinks it is, "This is the town of Bates. There's something else on here, it looks like a cave of some sort."
"How can you tell?" Glimmer squints at the map, "It's all just squiggly lines as far as I'm concerned."
Bow points to the lines in the middle of Adora's hand, "See that, this line represents the outline of the town. Over here, just off the centre, this is the cave systems. So whatever the map is leading us to, has to be in one of these caves."
"Do you think it's the location of the sword?" Glimmer asks excitedly, "Because that would be so cool!"

“Calm down Sparkles.” Catra motions for Glimmer to sit back down, “If I remember right, Bates is only accessible by boat.”
“Yes.” Bow agrees, “We’ll need to hire a boat or ship to get there.”
Catra shifts nervously in her seat, “I don’t think I can afford a boat let alone a ship to get us there.”
“Are you sure that’s the only thing worrying you?” Glimmer taunts,
“It’s not the fact that you’ll be on the water, is it?” Catra growls again, “Because I can pay for the boat.”
“It’s fine.” Catra tries to brush it off, “Just make sure the boat doesn’t sink. I’m not keen on getting water in my ears.”
Glimmer laughs at Catra’s admission, slapping her playfully on the back, “Okay. I’ll ask around town tomorrow to see if we can hire a boat.”
“Do you know how to sail?” Adora asks just as their food arrives and is set on the table in front of them, “I’ve never actually been on a boat.”
“Shocking.” Glimmer deadpans, “It’ll be fine. I’m sure we’ll be able to get someone to sail it for us as well.”
“I wonder why the map brought us to Talon though?” Bow asks.
“Don’t know. But I’m sure we’ll find out.” Catra answers biting into her food, “Hopefully it’s not to pick up on more…companions.”
The rest of them laugh at Catra’s plea as they finish the rest of their dinners and head back up to their rooms to rest. They agree to meet in the morning for breakfast before heading off to find somewhere to hire a boat.

Back in their room, Adora and Catra lie next to each other on the bed, both staring up at the ceiling. The light is off and they are both tucked under the shared blanket. Catra turns over and stares at Adora. Feeling the movement, Adora does the same.
“You said that you’ve been here before?” Adora whispers.
Catra shifted a little bit closer to Adora, “Yeah, I have.”
“Can you tell me about it?”
“Why do you want to know Adora?” Catra rested her hand on Adora’s waist.
“Why were you here last time?” Adora’s breath hitches as Catra runs her hand up and down Adora’s side, “Stop avoiding the question Catra.”

Catra's hand keeps moving up and down Adora's side as her face changes into something more pensive, "I was here on a project of sorts." Adora waits for Catra to elaborate, but she doesn't get the hint.
"Well?"
"Well what?" Catra asks back.
"What was the project?" Adora asks with a little more forcefully and raising an eyebrow.
Catra sighed, "Fine. Last time I was assisting Entrapta in breaking in and hacking into some of the satellite systems around Talon."
Adora wasn't quite understanding, "Uh, in other words, I was picking locks, breaking into buildings and assisting Entrapta in illegal activities. But for the greater good though…"
"Illegal activities…" Adora lingered on those words as Catra turned to go lie on her back again.
"Yeah.." Catra breathed out, "Entrapta needed to hack into the satellite systems so we could thwart the communication signals from Prime. Without that happening, the war would still be going on. We just weren't allowed to talk about it…to anyone really. It'd make us a huge target if we did go public with how the end of the war really happened."
Adora was silent for a minute, "That actually makes sense."
"Huh?"
"Catra, it really does make sense now that you told me." Adora's eyes lit up, "I remember one day the clones were kicking our butts on the battlefields and then the next day Prime's army was just so uncoordinated and leaderless. It was no wonder that Prime was taken down so quickly when his troops looked so lost."
Turning over back on her side, Catra had a relieved smile on her face, "You can't tell anyone. Promise me."
"I promise." Adora replied confidently, "I'm not putting your safety at risk."
"Thank you." Catra replies sincerely, "I've never told anyone that. It's usually only been a secret between me and Entrapta. But thank you." Staring into Adora's eyes made Catra melt, "Look, get some sleep princess. It's been a long day."
Adora nods. "Catra?"
"Mm?"

“I’m glad that you’re here with me.” Whispered Adora.
Catra reaches her hand out, gently stroking Adora’s cheek with her thumb, “Me too.”
“Goodnight Catra.”
“Goodnight Adora.”

Chapter End Notes

Next up, they look for a boat to take them to their next destination.
Thanks for taking the time to read this.
This fic is making me spend time writing with a week deadline for each chapter.
So... yeah, I'm still updating this one weekly :)

Exploring Talon

Chapter Summary

The group go out to find transport to Bates.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Morning comes and they go through their strangely domesticated morning rituals of Adora sleeping on Catra's arm and Catra finding ways to wake Adora up, this morning Catra decides to lick Adora's cheek, waking the blonde girl groan at the feeling of Catra's tongue on her cheek. Glimmer and Bow meet the pair for breakfast in the tavern downstairs before Glimmer and Bow go asking around for a boat and a captain willing to sail them to Bates. Catra doesn't like the idea of the other couple going off on their own and insists they go as a group so as not to be swindled by the locals. Much to Glimmer's annoyance, the sparkly girl agrees when Bow points out that they are in a pretty sketchy place and it would be safer to be travelling in a bigger group. Catra speaks to the tavern owner and asks them to hold their rooms for one more night in the meantime.
Once that's all settled, they all head out together.
"Okay Wildcat." Glimmer taunts, "Where can we find a boat and someone to sail for us?"
Catra growls back at the taunt, "It's been a while since I've been here, Sparkles." Emphasising the nickname that makes Glimmer huff.
"Okay… how about we try to work together instead of getting at each other's throats?" Bow intervenes, "Catra, lead the way please."
Catra sighs and then signals for them to follow her. She leads them to a shack on the edge of town, it looks rundown and uncared for. Catra turns around and grins at her companions.
"Listen up." Catra draws them in for a huddle, "I haven't been here for a while… so if anyone decides they want to take a swipe

at me," She eyes Adora, "do not and I repeat, do not step in. Got it?"
"What? Why?" Adora asks confused, "I'm not letting you get hurt."
Catra takes Adora's hand and squeezes, "Some people may have taken offense to, well, some of my past… adventures. Most with their girlfriend, sister or wife."
Glimmer bursts out laughing, "What? No mothers?"
Catra returns to Glimmer smirking, "Fortunately not in this town. No mother would want to be here in Talon." Glimmer promptly stops laughing, "Yeah, I don't want to go into that either."
Glimmer just nods and they all head inside. It turns out the shack is just a front for what can only be described as a mix of riff-raff and debauchery. Catra grins as she makes her way to the bar and orders drinks for her group.
Catra gestures for her group to sit at one of the tables and she passes their drinks to them.
Adora is noticeable a lot more reserved in this establishment as she watches Catra casually walk around talking to pretty much everyone in the room. Some of the females more handsy than others. Adora watches as Catra politely removes hands from her shoulders or waist from those females, but still keeping their attention as she moves around the room.
"Are you okay there, Adora?" Bow asks seeing the change in Adora's demeanour.
Adora takes a sip of the drink Catra got them, "Yuck!" sticking out her tongue and pushing her drink away, "What is this?"
Bow sniffs it and makes a similar face, pushing the drink away. "I like it." Glimmer declares as she claims the extra 2 drinks, "I'll take yours if you don't want them."
"It's all yours." Adora offers willingly, "It's gross."
"I think, the words you looking for is an 'acquired taste'." Glimmer pretends to be fancy, "Whatever, it's free." She takes drinks the rest of her drink and slams it down on the table. "Ah! Next one!"
Catra returns and sees Glimmer putting away the drinks she got them, "Not a fan of the local drink huh?" She asks Bow and Adora, they both shakes their heads as Catra picks up her own drink and takes a gulp, "It takes a bit of getting used to. Buit after a while, it's not so bad."

“Mmm, no thanks. I don’t think I want to get used to that.” Adora replies looking around trying not to frown, “You seem to know a lot of people here.”
Catra knows this look. She’s seen it before at the last town they were at. Time for Catra to do some damage control before stops talking to all together, “Yeah, I do.” Catra moves behind the blonde and wraps her arms around her waist so her chest is flush against Adora’s back, “Trust me. You have nothing to worry about.”
Adora leans back into Catra and sighs, “I know, I know… It’s just, seeing them…touch you…”
Sensing Adora’s worry, Catra nips the side of Adora’s neck playfully, eliciting a surprised gasp, “What?”
“Sorry.” Catra whispers into her ear as she breathes in Adora’s hair, “But I felt like I needed to do that. Make it clear that we are together in here.”
Adora nods slowly, not sure what to do with herself. Glimmer’s is snickering as Bow tries to calm her down by taking away the third drink from his wife.
“Are we…together?” Adora asks weakly.
Catra laughs from behind her, gently gripping her waist, “I’d like to be.” Adora relaxes into Catra’s arms, “Besides, I don’t like the looks some of the others here are giving you.”
“What looks?” Adora says surprised, glancing around the room trying to catch on.
Catra nods her head in the direction at the bar where a group of women are sitting and trying not to stare in their direction, “I mean, I get why though. You are… quite exquisite. Rare among these parts.”
Adora snorts back a laugh, “What does that mean? I’m nothing special.”
Cupping her jaw in her hand so Catra can turn Adora’s head towards her, “I think your body begs to differ.” Adora blushes, before Catra chuckles at Adora’s headspace, “I meant the map appearing on your body, not whatever you’re thinking about.”
Catra smirks as Adora just huffs playfully back, “Whatever…”
Rolling her eyes, Catra leans back in and whispers into Adora’s ear, “Okay, maybe it’s not just the map appearing on your body

that makes you special."
"Ugh!" Glimmer groans, "Get a room would you two! We're here to find transport, remember?"
Catra glares at Glimmer and reluctantly releases Adora, causing the blonde to whine a little, "Fine, Sparkles."
"Do you actually even know who we can talk to here?" Glimmer puts her hands on her hips, "Because it just looks like you are talking to all your… conquests."
Catra growls, "I'm getting information."
"Yeah, right." Glimmers smirks.
"Besides, I thought you were the one sorting this boat thing out."
Catra smirks back, "Oh, that's right." She snaps her fingers like she just remembered something, "You don't actually know anyone here."
Bow laughs, earning himself a scowling look from Glimmer, "Sorry. But she's right." They look at each other, "That felt weird to say…"
Adora turns to Catra, "So? Do you know anyone that might be able to help us?"
Grinning, Catra nods to the far corner, "Yeah. She can."
They all turn to see who Catra is pointing to. Instantly jealousy rises up in Adora's chest, "How do you know her?"
"If you're thinking whether I slept with her," Catra starts smugly before reeling it back, "then no. I haven't. She's got a boyfriend or something."
"Oh, so you do have some restraint after all." Glimmer teased, "And here I was thinking you didn't."
Catra smiles at Glimmers joke, "I have restraint. I haven't jumped this one yet." Gesturing to Adora.
"What?" Adora innocently replies.
"Uh, nothing…" Catra looks away, "Anyways, Sparkles, you and me can go chat with Merm's. Adora and Bow can just chill. Maybe order some drinks they'll like or whatever."
They all agree as Glimmer follows behind Catra towards the woman in question. The get to the woman who has dark blue hair and a snazzy suit on looking bored.
"Hey Merm's." Catra greets to a still very bored looking Mermista, "Got a minute?"
"For you?" Mermista looks Catra up and down, scanning her body

before picking up her drink and sipping it, “Sure. What’s up and who’s your new… friend?”
“Okay, first of all, ew.” Catra replies, earning a slap to the back of the head from Glimmer, “This is Sparkles.”
“I’m Glimmer!” The sparkly princess corrects forcefully, “Glimmer!”
“Okay Sparkles.” Mermista joins in on the teasing, “Name’s Mermista.”
Mermista sticks out her hand, palm down like she expects Glimmer to kiss it, “Yeah, I’m not kissing your hand.”
“Oh, not even for the Princess of Salineas?” Mermista quirks an eyebrow up to Glimmer.
“In case you didn’t know, I’m Princess Glimmer of Bright Moon. You might have heard of me.” Glimmer puts her hands on her hips, “I’ve heard of you though.”
Mermista looks to Catra, her hand still out waiting to be kissed when Catra rolls her eyes and leans in to place a chaste kiss on the back of Mermista’s hand, “You’re so needy.” Catra tells her.
A smirk comes across Mermista’s face at having Catra kiss her hand as she looks over back to Catra’s current company sitting and staring from across the room with new drinks in their hands, “That blondie over there looks like she’s about to pop a blood vessel.” Mermista casually throws, “Does Wildcat have a lover now?”
Glimmers laughs at how flustered Catra gets, the magicat just glaring back at Mermista.
“Wildcat here said that you might be able to help us with transport to Bates?” Glimmer asks over Catra’s low growl, “Is that something you can help us with?”
“Why do you need to get to Bates?” Mermista drawls, sipping on the last of her drink in her hand before placing it back down, “Not too mention, it won’t be cheap. I’m assuming you also need a captain?”
“Yes, we will need a captain.” Glimmers responds, “And why do we need a reason to go to Bates?”
“Just asking. Geez, don’t jump down my throat or anything.” Mermista rolls her eyes.
“Where’s that boyfriend of yours anyways?” Catra asks looking around.

“He is not, and I repeat, not my boyfriend.” Huffing and crossing her arms at the insinuation as Catra snorts back a laugh, “He’s just my ride.”
“You ride him a lot, Merm’s?” Catra smirks.
“What would you know about riding, Wildcat?” Mermista snaps back, “Has that blonde ridden you?”
“Okay…” Glimmer cuts in , “About that boat…?”
“Oh, yeah.” Mermista cuts back her tease from Catra, “We leave tomorrow. I’ll let Sea Hawk know. The boats moored by the docks about half a days walk from here. How many of you will be coming?”
“The four of us.” Glimmers answers, “Me, Bow, Adora and Wildcat.”
“Would you stop calling me that, Sparkles?” Catra growls lowly, “Should we say, meet outside the tavern at sunrise. We can get breakfast to go.”
“Fine.” Mermista agrees, “Now leave me be. I’m enjoying the attention I’m getting from around this place and you two are currently ruining that for me.” Mermista waves them off, “Oh and Wildcat?”
“What?
“Are you with the blondie or is she free game?” The angry growl from Catra gives Mermista all the answer she needs, “Okay, I get it. She’s with you. Are you not up sharing?”
“I don’t share.” Catra replies bluntly, “And neither do you if I remember correctly.”
“Eh.” Mermista shrugs, “I’ll see you guys tomorrow.”
Catra and Glimmer walk back to the rest of their group and sit back in their respective chairs.
“So, how did it go?” Bow asks cheerfully, “Have you got transport?”
“Yep.” Glimmer replies matching Bow’s enthusiasm, “We set off for the docks at sunrise.”
“Why is that woman staring at me?” Adora asks uncomfortably, “And why did you kiss her?”
“I kissed her hand, Adora.” Catra states, “It’s just a greeting. And she’s just shit-stirring right now.”
Adora doesn’t seem happy with that answer and pouts,

“Whatever.”
They sit in the venue for a while longer as Glimmer and Catra have a few more drinks and carry on. Adora rests her head on her arms in front of her, feeling a little tipsy from her one drink that Bow had bought for them. Bow was happily watching the patrons inside the venue mingle and chat with each other. Occasionally a fight broke out, but once they were kicked out, things went back to normal quite quickly.
“Hey Catra!” Bow whisper-yelled across the table, he had clearly had one too many and couldn’t control the volume of his voice, “Why did you say that you might bet into a few fights in here? No one has even approached you looking…viscous or angry.”
“Just wait.” Catra replies into her half empty glass, “But, I guess we should head out before I start some shit for no reason…”
Glimmer laughs loudly, earning their table a few glances from other patrons. “Yeah, I think we should go.” She declares just as loud as her laugh.
Catra helps Adora onto her feet, Bow doing the same for Glimmer and they head out and back to the tavern where they are staying. As they make their way back to their accommodation they are confronted with a small gang.
“Give us all your money!” The leader of the gang demands, “Now!”
“Yeah, that’s not happening buddy.” Catra tries to push her way through with Adora clutched in her arms, “Move!”
“Yeah, no.” He brandishes a knife he’s pulled out from the sheath on his belt, “Money. Now!”
Catra sighs, “Bow, can you hold onto Adora please?”
“Sure.” Bow takes hold of Adora and they move off to the side.
“Sparkles? Wanna have some fun?” Catra asks with a mischievous grin, “These guys won’t know what hit them.”
Drunk Glimmer is surprisingly fun and badass, “Hell yes!” Catra laughs at Glimmers eagerness to get into a fight, “Let’s do this!” Glimmer shouts getting into a fighting stance.
Catra and Glimmer stand back-to-back, Catra’s claws and fangs out on display while Glimmer starts creating energy balls in her hands. “Ready?”
The gang move in only to be caught by sparkly energy balls from

Glimmer mixed in with the fiery girls fists, punching indiscriminately, while the other are met with Catra's claws and fangs. It's not long before the duo have knocked out the gang and stand over the top of their would be robbers with victorious grins on the faces. Catra walks over to the leader and starts searching his pockets.
"What are you doing?" Glimmer asks, sobered up from the fight.
"Collecting my reward. Why?"
"We don't steal. Not even from those that tried to rob us." Glimmer scolds, putting her hands on her hips, cocking her hip out.
"Why not? It's the thing to do in Talon. You know? Like dog eat dog?" Catra raises an eyebrow to Glimmer who just glares back standing firm. "Besides, they probably stole whatever they have on them from someone else. We're just doing the community a favour…"
Glimmer scoffs, "That would be true, if you were actually planning on returning any of it to their rightful owners."
Catra rolls her eyes, "Fine. I wasn't going to grab anything apart from money anyways…"
"If you steal from them, Adora isn't going to be happy." Glimmer chastises.
"Oh, that is low." Catra grunts as she stands back up empty handed, "Fine. I won't take from this worm."
"Good." Glimmer smugly says, happy with herself, "Now, lets go before these guys wake up."
Catra agrees as they return to their respective partners. Catra pulls Adora arm over her own and they make their way back to the tavern. The blonde slumps into Catra's body, as she lazily walks back. Bow and Glimmer snicker behind them, watching and chatting amongst themselves.
"You okay there?" Catra asks Adora, who's got her eyes closed with a grin on her face.
"Mhm." The blonde responds, leaning further into Catra's body, "Mm…good. Just sleepy…"
Catra chuckles, "Okay, we'll be back at the tavern soon. I think we should get some food into you though. Definitely water. Help you sober up."

"M'fine." Adora slurs, "I only," she pauses trying to think, "I only, had, uh, one. And besides I think I want something else in me…"
Another chuckle from the magicat as she tries to hide her fluster and changes the subject, "Should have known you'd be a lightweight."
"I am not." Adora tries to straighten up only to stumble back into Catra's arms, "See!"
"Yeah, I see." Catra agrees with a grin, "Come on, drunky."

They get back to the tavern as Catra helps Adora sit down at one of the chairs at the tables, "Stay." She orders, "I'm going to get us some lunch and water for you. Okay?"
"Okay." Adora replies with a happy smile, before resting her head on her arms on the table.
Catra smiles down at the blonde as Glimmer and Bow join the blonde at the table. "Keep an eye on her, would you?"
Bow nods as Catra heads to the tavern to order them some food and drinks. She comes back with four glasses of water and places them on the table. "Here you go."
"Thanks." Glimmer grabs one of the glasses and chugs down the water greedily, "Oof, I really needed that!"
"No problems, Sparkles." Catra accepts, "Hey, Adora? Drink some water."
Adora looks up, her hair a mess from sleeping on her arms on the table, "Thank you." She sits up and gulps down the water, before sending Catra a winning smile which is quickly returned by Catra.
"I'm never drinking again…"
"You only had the one." Catra deadpanned.
"Yeah, but still." Adora makes a point with her finger in the air.
Their food arrives quickly and once they've finished lunch, Bow and Glimmer decide to retreat back to their room for some rest after this morning's adventure while Catra decides she want to show Adora around a few safer places in Talon.

"Where are we going?" Adora asks, grabbing hold of Catra's arm and looping her own around it, "Why can't we just nap? I know you like to nap…"
Catra smiles genuinely back at Adora, "I love to nap. And I love that you know that I like to nap. But," Catra bumps Adora slightly,

“I also want to show you around Talon.”
“I thought you said it wasn’t really a touristy spot.” Adora cocks an eyebrow up at Catra.
“It’s not. Definitely not for tourists.” A toothy grin returned, “But, I want to show you something.”
Giving in, Adora rolls her eyes, “Fine. Show me.”
“That’s what I’m doing.” Catra huffs with a grin, “It’s one of my favourite spots in this place. And there aren’t that many special spots in this place.”
Catra leads Adora to an abandoned building with a telecommunications tower on top of it. The inside of the building is completely derelict, with windows broken and graffiti everywhere.
“What are we doing here Catra? This place isn’t really what I was picturing when you said it was one of your favourite places.” Adora admits.
“Don’t judge a book by its cover Adora.” Catra replies as she smashes the glass on the front door, shattering it a little more, “Just watch out for the glass on the floor.”
Dropping her grip on Adora to her hand, Catra leads Adora into the abandoned building. It’s so dark inside that Adora forced to rely solely on Catra’s eyesight. The inside of the building smells worse than the outside, due to no air being ventilated out.
“We’re nearly there.” Catra says as they continue to go deeper into the dark building. Catra stops in front of an elevator and pushes the button. Surprisingly the elevator dings and lights up. The door opening for them, but still dark. Catra pulls Adora inside before clicking a few buttons on the keypad inside the elevator for it to reveal a secret door inside. It’s still dark as Catra pushes the secret door open and they both pass through with the door shutting behind them. Catra flicks on a light and a whole corridor opens up. Clean and tidy. Like it nobody has been in there for a while. “There we go.”
“What is this place?” Adora’s eyes widen at seeing the interior look so different from the outside. It even smelt cleaner in there, “Is this your favourite spot?”
Catra laughs, “This corridor? No. We need to take the other elevator to get to that.” They walk towards the end of the corridor

and reach a secondary elevator. Catra presses the call button and they both step inside as Catra pushes the button for the top floor. They don't speak in the elevator. Just standing side by side until the doors open at the top floor. Catra gestures for Adora to step out first then follows her out after. She leads the blonde through one last door and that's out on the rooftop. "Here we are."
Adora looks around with a questioning look in her eyes, "Okay…"
"Usually I'd climb to the top of the tower," Catra gestures to the telecommunications tower behind her, "But, I don't want you to fall and hurt yourself so we can just chill up here on the rooftop instead. Take a look at the view."
Stepping out further towards the wall ledge, she places her hand on top of the ledge and looks out, "Woah… this is amazing. I can see the ocean from here."
"Yeah, it is pretty nice." Catra sighs, leaning back against one of the legs of the tower, "That ocean view makes the trek all worth it."
Adora doesn't move or turn her gaze away from the views from the rooftop. She doesn't even seem to realise that Catra has come up behind her and wrapped her arms around the blonde's waist again. Reflexively, Adora lets her body lean into Catra's embrace.
"This is nice." Adora whispers, "Thanks for showing me."
"No problems." Catra replies softly into Adora's ear, "I'm glad you like it."
Adora closes her eyes, "I kind of like you too…"
"I know."
Adora turns around as Catra takes a step back, "What are we doing Catra?"
"What do you mean?" A grin on Catra's face, acting as innocently as she can.
"You were acting kind of possessive back at the bar or whatever it was." Adora pushes some hair back behind her ear, "And then you…uh," She touches the spot where Catra had nipped her neck, "You know…"
"You didn't like it?"
"I just…" Adora flusters, "You aren't just trying to sleep with me, are you?"
"Adora." Catra says sternly, "We already sleep together."

“You know what I mean.” Adora glares a little at Catra, “I mean the other way of sleeping together.”
“Oh, do you mean, sex?” Catra laughs, “You know you can say sex, right?”
“Fine.” Adora huffs, “Is that what you want?”
“I’m not opposed to it.”
“Catra!” Adora whines at Catra’s non-answers.
Another chuckle as Catra draws Adora closer, “It would be an honour when we did.”
“When?”
“Yeah. Whenever you’re ready.” Catra replies sweetly, “I can wait.”
“Why is it up to me?”
“Because you’re special.” Catra replies like it’s obvious.
“We are not doing it here though.” Adora says with a serious face, “It’s way too public.”
Catra laughs, “Wherever and whenever you want, princess.”
“Can we stay up here a little longer?” Adora rests her chin on Catra’s shoulder.
“Sure, Adora. Whatever you want.” Catra whispers into Adora’s ear as she rubs her face against the blonde’s cheek. “I wonder what would happen if I kissed you.” Catra ponders, “Do you think there’ll be a map on your lips or your tongue.”
Adora pushes Catra playfully, “Why don’t you kiss me and find out?”
“You sure?” Catra asks seriously as Adora nods into her shoulder, “Right now?”
Another nod as Catra pulls them apart so they can lean their foreheads together, “What are you waiting for Catra?” Adora goads as Catra pulls them even closer together making Adora’s breath hitch.
“Okay…” Catra leans in all the way as their lips connect finally. Adora practically melts into Catra’s lips before her body follows suit and Catra has to practically hold her up on shaky legs. Catra can’t help but smile into their first kiss, her eyes half open as she watches Adora’s face move close to hers. And when they part, Adora still chases after Catra’s lips, making the magicat chuckle.
“Mmm…wow.” Is all Adora can say before they Adora’s buries her

face into Catra’s neck while Catra purrs away, holding each other closely.

Chapter End Notes

Thanks for reading!
The gang next chapter will head off with Mermista and Sea Hawk to Bates.
And will Adora get new ink on her face after kissing Catra???

Of Sea Monsters

Chapter Summary

Onwards to Bates!

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra and Adora return back to the tavern, giddy and giggling happily as they meet up with Bow and Glimmer for dinner. The other couple give a knowing look at each other as they all sit down around the table.
"So…where have you been?" Glimmer asks not at all subtly.
"Oh, Catra showed me the tower Entrapta had commissioned to be built on top of one of the buildings." Adora happily replies holding onto Catra's hand, intertwining their fingers, "The view was so amazing."
"Yeah, it was pretty good." Catra agreed with a smile, "What did you guys get up to?"
"We," Glimmer emphasized, "took a nap."
"Yeah, nothing exciting happening here." Bow chimed in, "What about you two?"
"What about us?" Adora asks with hearts in her eyes as she looks at Catra.
"Did anything, I don't know, happen between you guys?" Glimmer smirks, "Something has definitely changed with you guys."
"I don't know what you are talking about Sparkles." Catra nonchalantly answers, grinning mischievously, "I just showed Adora the view from the top."
"Uh huh." Glimmer rolled her eyes at the two of them, "Okay, fine whatever. But you guys better keep it down tonight. We have to get up early tomorrow and I don't want to hear you two go at it all night."
"Glimmer…" Bow softly scolded before turning back to the other couple, "What she means is…"
"Nope. We are not going there." Catra puts her hand up as Adora

starts giggling, “Whatever you two think we are doing, stop it. It’s bad enough our rooms are right next to each other.”
Thankfully the conversation is dropped when their meals arrive and they busy themselves with eating and drinking to care too much. Instead the conversation steers to their transport to Bates.
“How do you know Mermista?” Bow asks sitting back in his chair happily now that he is full, “You two seemed awfully friendly.”
“Yeah, she’s cool.” Catra just brushes off the question, “Her boyfriend’s a bit of a menace though.”
“She has a boyfriend?” Adora’s question surprising Catra, “Because the way she was acting in the bar made me think different…”
“She was definitely hitting on you Adora.” Glimmer points out, “Full on staring and everything. That woman has no shame.”
Catra laughs, “She definitely does not.”
“She was not hitting on me.” Adora protests, crossing her arms, “I would have known.” Her 3 companions look at each other with their own questioning looks, “Okay fine. Maybe I wouldn’t have.”
“Don’t worry princess, she wasn’t gonna make a move on you.” Catra reassures, “She was waiting for you to make a move on her. But since you weren’t even aware of it, well, no harm I guess.”
Adora moves closer to Catra and whispers into the magicat’s ear, “I thought the whole nipping at me was so everyone knew we were together.”
Catra grinned as she turned to face Adora directly and softly answered, “It may have been more of an excuse to get close to you.”
“Oh.” Adora gasped a little, “Well, you didn’t need an excuse.”
“Ahem!” Glimmer loudly interrupts, “Getting back to topic… Can we really trust Mermista and Sea Hawk?”
“Aren’t you like, a real princess, princess?” Catra returns, “I thought you of all people would be able to recognise one of your own.”
Glimmer huffs, “This is the first time I’ve been out of Bright Moon without a royal guard around me.” She glares back at Catra, “Besides I’ve never met any of the other princesses before, okay?”
Catra laughs at that admission, “Seriously? Are you saying that I’ve met more princesses than an actual princess?”

“Shut up, Wildcat!” Glimmer scowls, “Getting back to my question… can we trust them?!”
“Yeah, Catra?” Bow joins in, “How do we know they aren’t just pulling our legs or something? I mean, isn’t it strange that she didn’t ask where we were going?”
“Not really. That’s how they roll.” Catra relaxes back into her chair, squeezing Adora’s hand, “And besides, she hasn’t even named a price either.”
“Again, is that not strange?” Bow repeats.
“No. I’m sure whatever she wants won’t be too hard to get.” Her leg starts bouncing up and down under the table, “Last time I did a job for her, she wanted me to distract Sea Hawk so she could ‘mingle’ with other people, if you get what I mean.”
“Does she… mingle, a lot?” Adora asks, “I mean, have you?”
“Have I what?” Catra rasps, knowing full well what Adora was asking, “Mingle?”
Adora nods as Catra laughs, “No, Adora. I have not ‘mingled’ with Mermista.” Catra smirked, “Why?”
“No reason.” Adora answered quickly.

They all sit back in their seats as the table is cleared and last drinks are called and they all head back up to their rooms. Bow and Glimmer send Catra a knowing look before disappearing into their room. Adora opens their door and goes in first. Catra hangs back, leaning on the door frame as she watches Adora move about the room.
“What?” Looking up after pulling the blankets back on the bed, “What are you looking at, Catra?”
“Just waiting to see whether new ink will appear on your lips now that I’ve kissed them.” A smirk on Catra’s face as Adora blushes at the thought of kissing Catra again. “Nothing yet.”
“Are you coming to bed or not?” Adora huffs.
“Of course I am, princess.” Catra saunters over, snuffing out the lights and sliding under the blankets next to Adora, “Are you ready to do to Bates tomorrow?”
Adora nods, “As long as you’re there with me, I’m ready for anything.” The declaration brings a pang of pride into Catra’s chest as the magicat wraps her arm over Adora’s side, “And as

long as you hold me at night, I'll get a good night's sleep."
Catra chuckles, "Then, in that case, I believe I must fulfil my duty to ensure you get a good night's sleep."
"Damn straight!" Adora laughs, "Also…you better not be 'mingling' with anyone else!"
"Ooh, a threat!" Catra mocks before leaning into Adora's ear, "I doubt anyone else could compare to you now that I've met you."
Adora shuffles closer into Catra's front, holding Catra's arm that is draped over her to her chest, "Promise?"
"Yes."

Catra wakes up first as normal, untangling herself out of Adora's limbs without waking the blonde this time. She gets ready, letting Adora the extra half hour to sleep before she has to get up too. She stares a little too long at Adora's feature, surprised that there's no new ink on her lips. Maybe it's a location thing. The ink only appearing once they get to the next location. She hears the blonde rouse from their bed, her eyes flickering open.
"It's still dark." Adora's voice hoarse from sleep, "Why aren't you in here with me still?"
Catra chuckles at Adora's attempt at a pout, "Because princess, I'm getting us ready for today."
"Mmm…" Adora smiles, "Are you done? Can you come back and keep me warm for a little longer?"
Quickly checking that the sun was still not rising for another 15 minutes, Catra climbs back in, "Just 5 minutes. You need to get ready too."
Adora nods as she lets Catra wrap her arms around her and the relax for a few minutes.

The sun has just risen, the group are waiting outside the tavern. All of them bar Catra are yawning and rubbing their eyes as Catra checks over their gear on the horses.
"Where are they?" Glimmer grunts out, annoyed at having to be awake so early. "They said sunrise didn't they?"
"Geez, Sparkles. Don't wake up the whole town or anything." The lazy voice of Mermista answers Glimmers question, "Are you guys, like, ready?"
"Yeah." Catra answers for all of them, "Where's Sea Hawk?"

“He’s went back to the docks to get prepped. Looks like it’ll be you guys and me.” Mermista replied looking bored, that is until she notices the blonde again, “And… who might you be?”
Catra steps between the blonde and Mermista, “This is Adora. Don’t get any ideas.”
“Okay, okay.” Mermista rolls her eyes like she didn’t have any intentions, “Let’s get going. We can talk about payment on the way.”
They lead their horses to the edge of town as the sun illuminates the lands around them the higher it rises. Glimmer, Bow and Adora all mount their horses whilst Mermista and Catra walk behind.
“So… payment?” Catra asks, “What do you want?”
Mermista hums teasingly, “A night with your blonde friend would be a good start.” The growl from Catra’s chest says it all before Mermista laughs at the reaction, “Wow. Wildcat really has it bad, huh?”
“Shut up.” Catra mumbles.
“No?” Mermista raises an eyebrow, “So, is she like, fair game then?”
“You asked that yesterday…” Catra gritted out, “You know the answer to that.”
Mermista looks over to Adora. Her eyes roam the blonde’s body up and down, “I see, you haven’t marked her yet…” Another growl as Mermista laughs again, “You know the rules.”
“She’s not fair game. She’s not game at all.” Catra feels herself get possessive, “You can take whatever else you want. Just, not Adora.”
“Tell you what, Wildcat.” Mermista cockily smirks, “If she doesn’t want to go with me, I won’t force the issue. Deal?”
“This is sick.” Catra groans, “I’m not bartering with Adora. Find something else.”
“Mmm…” Mermista hums, “Fine. How about you?”
“What about me?”
“You show me why they call you Wildcat and I’ll take that as payment.” Mermista grin turns wicked, “Unless you’ve gone… soft?”
“That is not happening.” Catra replies sternly, “You’re too late.

Those days are over now."
"Well, in that case…" Mermista huffs, "What else have you got to offer? If I'm not getting you or Adora?"
"Protection." Is all Catra says.
"Protection from what?" Mermista groans, "I know everyone in this backwater place. Who do I need protection from?"
"It's not a who." Catra turns her head to make eye contact with Mermista, "It's a what. Ever since I've met Adora, she's been a magnet for beasts and creatures trying to kill her."
"Oh, that sounds fun." Mermista actually sounds intrigued, "And what of these beasts? Think I can't take care of myself?"
Tilting her head at Mermista, Catra smirks, "We aren't anywhere close to water Merms. So your powers aren't exactly going to be effective out here." They continue to walk, "Trust me, you'll be thankful there are 5 of us, instead of 1."
"Fine." Mermista waves her wrist to agree, "But, if we do not come across any sort of beast before we hit Bates, I get Adora for a night."
"No deal." Catra growls, "She's off limits. As am I."
"Ugh! How about I get an hour with Adora and see if I can change her mind?" Mermista grins, "She might even like the extra attention."
"Your efforts at the bar yesterday went unnoticed." Catra deadpanned, "How about… I make sure you and Sea Hawk get to spend an uninterrupted hour below deck each day we are on the ship?"
"And how are you going to make that happen with all your… companions?"
"I can make it happen." Catra gives Mermista a toothy grin.
"Fine. Deal. Whatever." Mermista groans. "Also, give me one of your horses. I'm sick of walking."
"That. I can do." Catra grins as she eyes Adora's horse.

With Mermista now on top of Swift Wind, Adora has taken to walking alongside Catra behind the 2 horses. Glimmer and Bow had offered Melog, but Mermista feeling smug about the whole situation where she would bed neither Adora nor Catra, decided spite would be more effective. Not that Glimmer or Bow or even

Adora were aware of why Mermista was so insistent to take the white horse for herself. Luckily, she was not so spiteful to take off Catra and Adora's gear from the horse.
"So… what were you 2 discussing that made me lose my ride?" Walking comfortably behind Swift Wind, Adora asks as she intertwines her fingers in Catra's, "Is that what she wanted as payment for taking us to Bates?"
Catra chuckled at Adora's innocence and tossed up whether to tell her the truth or feed her a convenient lie, she chose the former, "Merms initially wanted to bed you."
Adora choked on air as she heard Catra's answer, "What!?"
Another chuckle, "Don't worry princess. I wasn't about to sell you out."
"So… you traded my horse for her to ride instead of… me?" Adora blushed, "You know what I mean…"
Catra couldn't stop herself from laughing at how uncomfortable this conversation was making Adora, "I'm pretty sure Merm would prefer to have you riding her." Adora turned and looked away, "She even bedding me. Which I refused. Obviously."
"Oh." Adora's voice soft but surprised, "I thought… nothing."
"You thought what?"
"I thought…" Adora looked down at the ground before continuing, "What I said last night, about not, mingling with other people…"
"I meant it Adora." Catra replied sincerely, "I told Merms that my Wildcat days are over. Which brings us to why you and I are currently walking and at some point during our trip to Bates on the ship, Merms and Sea Hawk will need us to be as far away as possible on a ship from their bedroom for an hour a day."
"Oh my gods…" Adora looked up shyly, "That's just…"
"Yeah."
"Okay, I don't care that I'm walking right now then." Adora declared, "But, thank you. For not trading me."
"Of course." Catra replies, "I believe that I have dibs on that now." A mischievous grin on Catra's face as she playfully swings their connected hands back and forth between them.
Adora pushes a few stray hairs back behind her ears as they continue to walk behind the horses, she nudges Catra playfully with her shoulder before whispering into her ear, "I can't wait."

Catra stops in her tracks, swallowing hard as Adora tugs her forwards with their interlocked hands. The smirk on Adora's face says it all as Catra looks like a deer in the headlights. Catra by no means is not up to the task, but the way Adora makes her feel when the blonde throws suggestive words and looks, there's no hiding her sweaty palms or the dryness in her mouth. All she can muster up is a dopey smile as she lets Adora pull her along while her brain tries to catch up.
Adora giggles at Catra's reaction, pulling the magicat in for a brief kiss.
"Cut it out you two!" Mermista shouts from in front of them, "Save it for Bates!"
"What?" Catra whines, "I have to wait until Bates to get laid?"
Adora shoves Catra playfully as Mermista rolls her eyes, "You are not having sex on my ship."
Catra huffs, "Fine. I guess we'll just have to listen to you and Sea Hawk have sex then."
"Damn right you are." Mermista returns with a wink, "And you better not complain either or I'm dumping your asses in the middle of the ocean."
The look of shock on Glimmer and Bow's faces makes even Mermista laugh, "Lighten up." She tells the couple on the horse, "The sex rule goes for you two as well."
The couple are both blushing furiously as Bow tries to change the subject, "So… what's Bates like?"
"I thought you knew about Bates, Bow." Adora walking a little faster to be side by side with Melog, "I mean you said you knew it from the map."
"Er, well, I've seen in a couple of books back at my dad's library." Bow replies. "I mean, I've never been. This is the first trip I've been on outside of Bright Moon. Like Glimmer."
"Bow! You're not supposed to tell everyone that!" Glimmer whispered-yelled at Bow as he put his hands up to apologise for letting that information slip.
"Pfft! I can't believe I'm travelling with amateurs." Mermista grumbled, "You're lucky you are a princess, Sparkles. Otherwise, I wouldn't take your asses anywhere. If it wasn't for our kingdoms getting along and not having to start a war or whatever."

“What? I was not going to start a war if you didn’t take us!” Glimmer screeched while Catra suppressed the urge to breakout in a laugh behind, “Why would that even matter!?”
“Duh, because if you weren’t a princess, I’d probably just take your money and just leave you back at Talon.” Mermista states plainly, “Pretty sure that was obvious.”
Mermista and the couple argued the rest of the way to the docks, while Catra and Adora walked leisurely behind them, stealing glances every now and then. Catra had never felt this content with anyone before in her life and she was wasn’t going to give this girl up without a fight. She would fight every monster, beast, creature or whatever was out to get Adora because of the map appearing on her body. She did however feel guilty at being the one that made those lines appear on her skin. Not that Adora seemed to care or mind at all. The blonde maintained such a happy outlook that it brought Catra’s mood up with her.

“Welcome!” Sea Hawk greeted his new crew mates, “I believe you are my new crew.”
Mermista rolled her eyes, “Sea Hawk, this is everyone. Everyone, Sea Hawk.”
“It is such a pleasure to meet you all.” Sea Hawk declared, “I’m sure my dear Mermista has told you wonderful things about me and our finest ship.”
“I think you mean our only ship.” Mermista corrected, “I swear, if you set this one on fire, I will chain you down with the ship.”
“But my dear Mer…” Mermista raised her hand to stop Sea Hawk from talking and it strangely worked as he quickly went silent.
“Okay, get on.” Mermista waved to the travellers, “Hurry up, we don’t have all day.”
The 4 travellers and 2 horses all boarded the ship and were given a quick tour by Sea Hawk before setting sail once the captain had gone through and checked everything was good to go. As they set off, he proudly shouted to the direction they were sailing in, “Adventure!”
After dumping their things below deck, Catra and Adora stood looking out over the water as the ship built up speed. Sea Hawk

had dropped the main sail once they had made it into deeper waters and was now standing at the wheel, lazily steering away while he made googly eyes at Mermista. Bow and Glimmer emerged from below deck, taking a deep breath of the sea breeze and stretching out their arms as they yawned in unison.
"You guys look tired." Adora said, "Maybe you should get some rest."
"Nah, we're fine." Bow patted Glimmer on the shoulder, "We wanted to check out the views anyways."
Catra snorted back a laugh, "There's nothing to see but water. We've just gone far enough that we now also can't see land. Which is just great… isn't it?" The annoyance in Catra's voice became apparent as Adora squeezed her hand to ground her, "Sorry. I just don't like water, okay?"
"Too bad Wildcat." Drawled Mermista from next to Sea Hawk, "Look up."
"You are kidding me!" Catra cussed, "A storm? Seriously?"
"Hey." Adora whispered in Catra's ear and then pulling her into a hug, "It'll be okay."
"How can you be so sure?" She knew she was being more paranoid than usual, but she really did not like getting her fur wet, "I mean, look at those clouds…"
Adora doesn't turn her head, instead she keeps her eyes focused on Catra, "Hey, look at me." Catra finally locks her eyes with the blonde, "We've been through worse things than a rain storm."
"I know…"
"Plus, Mermista is the Princess of the Sea, so even if something was to happen, who better than Mermista to pull us out."
Mermista straightens up when she hears Adora talk her up, "Also Glimmer can teleport us to safety if we need it."
Catra took a few deep breaths, "Yeah, okay… thanks."
A soft smile on Adora's face calmed the magicat down immensely as they went back to looking out to sea again. Catra's tail wrapped around Adora's waist as a thank you as Adora leaned into Catra's side, happily accepting Catra's arms coming around to wrap around her.
"You two are so disgustingly sweet." Glimmer scoffed.
"Jealous, Sparkles?" Catra jibed, "Doesn't Bow do this for you

too?”
Glimmer looked around for Bow and saw he was standing next to Sea Hawk with a look of adoration on his face while the captain told stories and sang a few shanties. She could practically see the hearts in his eyes as he stared at him. Glimmer huffed and stomped over to Bow, practically pulling him away from his man-crush and back to her side. Bow seemed confused by the whole thing but went along with it anyways. Eventually understanding what Glimmer wanted and he wrapped his arms around his wife and kissed the top of her head lovingly.
“Now, that’s sappy.” Catra teased, “You two are way worse than we are!”
Adora closed her eyes as Catra and Glimmer teased and mocked each other, she was tired from all the walking to the docks and her eyes were starting to droop. Catra noticed and hugged her a little tighter, “Tired? Need a nap?”
Adora hummed in response confirming that she did want to nap, her body starting to weigh heavier into Catra’s arms as Adora started to fall asleep. Catra smiled at the blonde, kissing her forehead. She quickly swept her up in her arms and led her to one of the 4 hammocks set up below deck. She gently placed Adora into the hammock farthest away from the door as she lowered herself into the one next to blonde and gently swung her own hammock side to side. Catra closed her eyes as she listened to Adora breathing in and out calmly as she slept.

The storm was bad. Really bad. At one point, it felt like the ship was going to capsize. Mermista did her best with the waves, but ultimately nature could not be controlled. Sea Hawk had shouted orders around the ship, Glimmer and Bow did their best, despite not knowing what the hell Sea Hawk was yelling. Eventually he sent them below deck for safety. Adora was busy with Mermista tying loose cargo down while Catra climbed up and down the rigs as per Sea Hawks orders. Even though she didn’t like this captain or know him too well, it was evident that he actually knew what he was doing. She was soaked through all the way to her skin under her fur. Her hands and claws were hurting from the number of times she climbed up and down, holding on for dear life when

the wind picked up or a rogue wave hit the ship from an odd angle. Still, she had a job to do, even if it wasn't one she had agreed to. Finally the storm started to ease up and the rain became a drizzle.
"Well done, everyone!" Cheered Sea Hawk, "We made it through!"
Catra climbed leapt down from where she was holding onto on the main mast, opting to leap down than slide down. Her claws needed a break anyways. "That. Sucked." Catra deadpanned as she shook out her fur away from everyone. It didn't make a difference right now as the drizzle would just penetrate through anyways the longer she stood in the rain.
"Good work Wildcat." Mermista patted the magicat on the shoulder, "For someone that hates water, you sure do thrive in it."
Catra rolled her eyes as she spots Bow and Glimmer emerging from below deck.
"Can we go inside now?" Catra whined.
"Yes. Go get cleaned up. Mermista and I will stay on deck." Sea Hawk happily informed everyone.
Catra and Adora don't need to be told twice as they both hurry below deck and out of the rain. Once safely out of the rain, Catra threw a dry towel to Adora and grabbed one for herself and they both started to dry off. Catra turned around and started to strip out of her wet clothes much to the surprise of Adora.
"What are you doing?" Adora nervously asked.
"I can't get my fur dry if I'm covered in wet clothes." Catra simply said as she removed her shirt, yanking over her head and throwing it down on the floor, wrapping the towel around her torso as she dried her top half off, "You should take off your wet clothes too. You'll get sick if you don't."
Adora hesitated and Catra sensed it, turning around to give Adora a bit of privacy, "Sorry." Catra apologised softly, not really sure why she was saying sorry in the first place, "I can go somewhere else if it makes you more comfortable."
"No…" Adora replied just as softly before taking off her top and copying Catra in wrapping the towel around her torso, "Stay."
Catra nodded as she patted her chest and arms down with the towel. "I'll grab us some dry clothes. I'll be back." Catra says as she moves to her bag and pulls out a shirt. She didn't exactly

have a change of clothes in her bag as she wasn't expecting to be travelling at all, but she did happen to have an extra shirt. It'd be big enough for Adora to fit into. Pants however, not so much.
Adora covered her chest with the towel when Catra returned with a dry shirt in her hand, "Here. Should fit you."
Adora accepted the shirt and turned around as she slipped it over her head. Catra moved off to the opposite corner of the room and shook out her fur of water as much as she could. She didn't even realise Adora had slipped in behind her until the blonde's front was plastered to the magicat's back.
"What are you doing?" Catra asked with a small smile, "I'm still wet."
"Let me help." Adora pulled the towel out from Catra's hands and started to gently pat dry her fur, "Better?"
"Yeah. Thanks." Catra takes the towel back and covers her front, fully aware that Adora wasn't comfortable with seeing so much of Catra so quickly, "The shirt fits huh?"
"Mmhm." Adora beams, "Thank you for it."
Catra picks up their wet shirts and hangs them up to dry, "Uh, I'm gonna need to take my pants off too, as are you. So…" Catra looked to the hammock, "I'll turn around so you can take them off and then get under the blanket on the hammock. Just, leave them on the floor so I can hang them up."
Adora nods and Catra turns around. The magicat ears pick up on the movement of Adora undressing and then getting under the blanket of her hammock. "Done."
Catra turns around and grins as she sees Adora wrapped up in the blanket, looking warm and comfortable with a content smile on her face. "Good." Catra picks up Adora's sea-soaked pants and towel, hanging them with their shirts. "It's been a while since I've slept naked." Catra just throws out there, "Hope Bow and Glimmer aren't prudes."
Adora made a noise that sounded a little like a low growl, "Hmph."
"What?" Catra looked confused for a moment, "Oh, right. Hang on."
Adora watches as Catra wraps the towel tightly around her torso and head out the door. It's a few minutes before Catra returns with a brimming smile on her face, "Don't worry princess. Bow

and Glimmer will use the second room down here, so we'll have this spot all to ourselves tonight."
"Okay."
Catra chuckled as she shucked off the towel and hung it up. Removing the last of her wet garment last, her pants. She squeezed the last of the water out of it and also hung it up. Then moved to the far corner again and shook off the fur on her lower half. She half expected Adora to maybe be peeking over to see, but when she glanced back to the blonde, Adora had already fallen asleep. After turning out the lights, Catra walked over to Adora's hammock and kissed her on the forehead, "Goodnight Adora."
This would be the first night they didn't share a bed.

The next morning, everyone emerged from their rooms to the deck for breakfast. Sea Hawk retold his version of events from last night with great enthusiasm as well as exaggeration. The sun had come out and the breeze was calm and refreshing. After breakfast, Catra and Sea Hawk were standing next to each other, gazing at their own version of princesses.
"Tell me, Wildcat. How did you and Adora meet?" Sea Hawk asked curiously.
"Uh, I was taking a nap on top of a tower and heard her screaming. She was being chased by some kind of beast or animal. Long story short, I killed it." Catra replied.
Sea Hawk grins widely, about to break into another tale of his adventures when the ship start rocking violently.
"What was that?" Catra shouted to Sea Hawk.
"I'm not sure." He looked over to Mermista who looked just as confused and a little scared, "I mean, there are sea monsters in these waters after all…"
Adora makes her way over to Catra as Bow and Glimmer both pop up onto the main deck.
"What is going on?" Glimmer screeched, Bow taps Glimmer on the shoulder to turn around to see what is rocking the ship, "What is that?!"
"That, would be a sea monster." Mermista states plainly but

definitely not calmly.
“Can’t you like communicate with it or something?” Catra pulls Adora behind her as they back away from the massive head of the sea creature that has popped up next to the ship, it looked like a prehistoric water serpent, a plesiosaur. “Stay behind me Adora.” Catra ordered as the blonde grabbed the back of Catra’s shirt.
Mermista groaned, “No, I can’t communicate with it!”
“Why not?” Glimmer shouted back, they were all moving to the opposite side of the ship to be as far from the sea monster as possible, “Can’t you talk to all the sea creatures?”
“This isn’t responding!” Mermista yelled back, “It’s like it’s possessed or something!”
“Not again…” Glimmer groaned, “Get ready to fight then!”
Adora pulls out the knife Catra had given her previously while the others all got ready with their own weapons. The sea monster growled loudly as it opened it’s massive jaws and went to bite down at the occupants of the ship, not going for anyone in particular. The strike smashed through the ships deck, causing a massive hole in the middle of the ship. Mermista and Glimmer used their magic to try and ward off the sea monster, but nothing seemed to be working. Adora had managed to slice at its face a few times, but it was completely ineffective.
“Bow, aim for its eyes!” Catra yelled as she leapt out of the way from another strike from the creature's jaws. “The eyes!”
Bow concentrates and fires multiple arrows at the sea monster, 3 out of 8 arrows hit their target, making the sea monster roar in pain as it flung its head side to side trying to dislodge the arrows in its eyes.
It finally comes down one more time, smacking Sea Hawk overboard and into the water. Mermista turned her attention to the captain and used her magic to pull him out safely only for her to be swept into the water as well. With one eye, the creature aimed it’s massive jaws at Catra. In a second, the head of the massive sea monster had engulfed Catra and when it lifted its head up from the hole in the deck, Catra was gone.
“Catra!” Adora screamed when she couldn’t see the magicat on the now sinking vessel.

Catra was gone.

Chapter End Notes

Thanks for reading!

Marooned

Chapter Summary

Fighting sea monsters and making it to shore.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The sea monster lifted its head up from the deck, Catra was nowhere to be found. Adora screamed and screamed Catra's name, but there was no response.
"No…" Adora was about to break down when the sea monster appeared again, ready to eat her too she thought. She stood frozen in place as the massive head of the sea monster rose up. This time the sea monster stalled at its peak height.
The sea monster's eyes flinched in pain. But it wasn't from the arrows in its eye. There was a definite pulsating movement from within the sea monster's neck. The beast shook its head trying again to dislodge something in its neck when it growled loudly at nothing. 4 claws slashed through the sea monsters' neck from the inside as the sea monster shook more violently. It was too late for the sea monster. Its body being ripped and slashed from the inside until its neck was cut clean off. As the top of its head and neck slid off and splashed loudly back into the sea, Catra appeared from the newly slashed open neck and leapt out before the sea monsters body sank down back into the water. From the exertion of literally fighting her way out of the belly of the best, Catra lands awkwardly onto the sinking vessel before her body gave out and fell sideways into the water that had come up to her hips.
Glimmer grabbed a nearly unconscious Catra from the water and teleported her to the little makeshift floatation device the others had pulled together from the sinking ship. Glimmer and Adora grunted and pulled Catra on top of the broken wooden boards as Bow and Sea Hawk continued to gather and tie as many bits of wood together before they were too exhausted and climbed on

top of the makeshift raft.
“Your girlfriend is crazy, Adora.” Glimmer groans as she flops down next to Catra on the raft.
Adora moves to frantically cup her hands around Catra’s face, “Catra!”
Catra opens her eyes briefly enough to say, “Hey Adora.”
Adora kisses Catra lightly on the lips as Catra’s eyes close again.
With Catra out of it, Adora turns to Glimmer, “Thank you for saving her.”
Glimmer just waves her hand, brushing it off as nothing to worry about while she recovers on her back.
“Give me a few minutes guys.” Mermista tells her friends, “Once I’ve got my strength back, I can get us to shore quicker.”
“Take your time darling.” Sea Hawk comforts his princess, “We all should rest for a moment to gather our strength.”
“What happened to our horses?” Adora asks looking around the water.
Bow points behind her. Their 2 horses were struggling in the water, trying to keep their heads above it when Mermista rolls her eyes at the land beasts and waves her hand creating a temporary floating platform for the 2 horses to keep them from drowning. It was quite a sight, considering Mermista was still quite drained of her power but still cared enough to save the 2 horses.
Adora sent a sincere thank you to Mermista before she lay exhausted next to Catra on the raft.

“Where have we landed?” Bow asks helping the 2 horses onto the beach, “Is this Bates?”
Sea Hawk looks around the beach, trying to find any signs or landmarks that might tell him where they were. The rest of their party were lying on the beach now, happy to be out of the water.
“No. I’m afraid this is not Bates.” Sea Hawk replies when he gets a good look at the coastline, “But we are close.”
Bow made a noise to confirm that he understood as Glimmer lay on her back on the sand, happy to be out of the water. Adora was wrapped up in Catra’s arms on the beach as they lay on the sand, just out of reach from the waves. Catra had recovered enough to help paddle the raft to the shore and was now a little annoyed

with the amount of sand and water that had collected in her fur. But having Adora in her arms helped a little.
"Hey Adora, are you okay?" Catra's voice was raspier than usual, the result of being inside the throat of a sea monster Catra guesses as she gently rubs Adora's arms up and down.
"You have to stop scaring me." Adora whispers into Catra's chest, "That monster literally ate you…"
"I know…" Catra concedes as she pulls Adora into her a little tighter, "I'm sorry. It's not like I was planning on that happening…" Catra chuckles at her next sentence before she even says it, "I definitely was not planning on being lunch for some sea monster."
Adora punches Catra's shoulder lightly for making light of the situation they had just barely escaped from, "That's not funny."
"I'm sorry princess." Catra repeats sincerely, "I'll try harder not to scare you by almost dying."
Adora looks up and grabs Catra by the collar, "You better!"
A mischievous grin on Catra's face as she leans in and kisses the blonde. Not a moment too soon they hear Glimmer clear her throat, "Hey Sparkles." Catra greets without breaking eye contact from Adora's lips, "Thanks for having my back."
Glimmer huffs, "Well, you're lucky I was close by."
Catra turns to look at Glimmer, "Well, I'm glad that you were."
"You are crazy, you know that?" Glimmer has her hands on her hips again, "We thought you were dead!"
Rubbing the back of her neck sheepishly, Catra just nods.
Glimmer sighed and dropped her arms to her side, "You guys ready to go?"
Catra got up and helped Adora onto her feet too, "Yeah, we're ready."

The island they ended up on, was uninhabited. Sea Hawk thought they were close to Bates, but upon further inspection and investigation, it turns out the sea monster and their little ruckus with the sea monster had blown them off course by quite a bit.
"Where are we?" Adora asked towards anyone in the group, "If we got blown off course, where are we now?"
They had stuck close to the beach while they trekked around the island. Mermista waded into the water and used her magic to try

and figure out that very question. She had her eyes closed as the rest of the group sat on the beach and watched the Sea Princess. Catra lay on her back, her eyes closed as she tried not to look into the sun, she noticed Glimmer was doing the same thing next to her.
"You all good there, Sparkles?" Catra asked turning her head.
"I'm so tired." Glimmer responded, her eyes drooping, "I just want to sleep."
"Go ahead." Catra put her arm over her arms, "I doubt we are going anywhere for a while."
Bow flopped down next to Glimmer and groaned, "It's so hot!"
Catra and Glimmer both laughed at Bow's dramatics as Adora joined them, flopping herself down next to Catra, groaning the same sentiment, "It's so hot!"
"You two are ridiculous!" Glimmer scolded, "It's not even that bad."
"Yeah, for you!" Bow whined, "How are we going to get off this island?"
Sea Hawk and Mermista joined the group, except they resisted the urge to flop down on the sand. Mermista had one hand on her cocked hip, "Ugh! I need to recharge. I can't do my magic when I spent so much time keeping those 2 horses of yours afloat."
"Mermista!" Sea Hawk put his arms around her, "You did a very good job and I, for one, am very proud of you."
"Shut it!" Mermista snapped at the captain though it wasn't said in a mean spirited way and he understood that, "I just need to rest for a bit."
"Of course." Sea Hawk nodded.
"So… does this mean we aren't getting off this island today?" Bow sat up, "If that's the case, we should probably make camp."
Catra got up off the sand, brushing off bits that got stuck to her, "Do you guys have any idea where we are?"
Mermista and Sea Hawk both shook their heads.
"Okay…" Catra looked around the island and then up at the sky, "Well, we will stay about 5hrs or so of daylight. I'm going to take a look around and see if this island has anything we can use."
"I'll come with you!' Sea Hawk declared loudly.
Glimmer groaned, "I better go too." Catra arched an eyebrow, "If

there's anything out there, that wants to hurt us, I can teleport us to safety. Duh!"
"Fine." Catra replies, "I'm guessing none of our gear made it to shore, huh?"
The question was met with silence as Catra sighed, "Okay… great." Turning to the blonde, "Adora? Can I grab my knife off you please?"
Adora reaches around and pulls the knife out from her belt, holding it out handle first as she stayed laying on the sand, "Here."
"Thank you." Taking the knife from Adora, the blonde pulls Catra down on top of her, "Uh, careful… I'm still holding the knife, remember?"
Adora props her head up so their foreheads are touching, "Don't do anything stupid, like getting hurt or dying."
A grin comes across Catra's face as she leans in and places a quick kiss on Adora's lips, "Don't worry. We'll be back before you know it."
"You better." Adora said with a face of seriousness.
"What's with all the threats today, princess?" Catra questioned while still on top of the blonde, the knife safely tucked into the sand.
Softly the blonde spoke, "I just… you can't leave me, okay?"
"Leave you? Why would I want to do that?" Catra mused.
"I'm not saying you're going to do it deliberately… but, I don't know what I'd do if something happened to you." Adora bit her lip as her eyes teared up, "I know, it's stupid…"
"Adora." Catra cupped Adora's cheek with one hand, "I'm not going anywhere. I'm stubborn and hard to kill, remember?"
Adora nodded but she was still concerned, "Doesn't mean you can't be…"
Catra sighed, "I've got Sparkles and the sea captain with me." Looking over at her 2 awaiting companions, "You've got nothing to worry about. We'll be back soon enough. Hopefully with more information and a way to get off this island."
Adora reached up and kissed Catra once more before giving her a small smile to let the magicat know that she was okay now. "You better get going." Adora whispered into Catra's lips.

Rolling her eyes, Catra pecked Adora's lips once more, collected the knife and got up. "I'll be back."
The trio started walking inland into the tree line and before long, they had disappeared from view from the other 3 waiting on the beach.
"Do you think we should have gone together?" Bow asked as Mermista sat between Adora and Bow.
"Sea Hawk, despite appearances, is actually a really good navigator." Mermista replied, "They'll be fine. Your sparkly wife had a point, you know?"
Bow nodded, "Yeah, she's amazing."
"Not that." Mermista drawled, "I meant she can teleport them out of trouble if they come across any."
"Oh, right." Bow grinned proudly, "But, she is still amazing. Right, Adora?"
Too tired to answer, Adora throws a thumbs up in Bow's direction. They all lay back on the sand and closed their eyes, waiting for their scouting group to bring back good news.

"This way!" Sea Hawk happily directed the trio, "We need to get to higher ground, that way we can see what this island has and if there are any other inhabitants here."
"You mean, the speaking type?" Glimmer taunted, "Maybe we'll find a talking bird that can help us off this island."
Catra snorted back a laugh, "You, Sparkles, need to lighten up."
Glimmer glared back at Catra who was bringing up the rear, "Shut it, Wildcat!"
Catra lifted her hands up in surrender as they followed Sea Hawk up the trail, "Hey, Sea Hawk! I think I see something over there."
"Where?" Sea Hawk looked over to where Catra was pointing.
"There." Catra pointed harder, "Looks like a waterfall. Let's go!"
They hurried over and were relieved to hear the sounds of falling water, "Thank goodness!" Glimmer smiled as she made her way towards the water, "Think we can drink this water?"
"Well, it is fresh." Catra shrugged, "But, I wouldn't."
"Why not?" Glimmer asks, frowning at the water in front of her.
"We gotta boil it first." Catra gets down on all fours and sniffs the water, "Yeah, I'm not getting a stomach bug from drinking dodgy

water.”
Sea Hawk nodded, “Glimmer, would you be so kind to let the others know we have found a source of fresh water?”
“Ask them to bring something we can boil it in too.” Catra called over her shoulder as her and Sea Hawk headed back to the trail, “You know how to get back here, right?”
Glimmer scowled at Catra’s question, “We haven’t even gotten that far! Of course I know how to get back here.”
“Good.” Catra grinned, “Me and the captain are going to keep heading up to the top. We’ll be back before nightfall.”
“Are you sure?” Glimmer asked nervously.
Catra nods, “I can see in the dark, Sparkles.” She notices Glimmer hesitating for a moment, “Let Adora know, we’ll be fine. And not to worry.”
“Hmpf, easy for you to say.” Glimmer rolled her eyes but agreed anyways. “Don’t let her down, you hear me?”
“I hear you.” Catra replied. Glimmer disappeared, leaving a trail of glitter. The magicat turns to Sea Hawk, “Come on, let’s get going before it gets too dark.”
Sea Hawk agrees and they continue their trek up to the top.

The trek took about an hour, as there was not clear path up. Catra had moved ahead of the captain through the trees, every so often she’d drop back down to the forest floor and waves for him to catch up. The view from the top was breathtaking. They could see the entire outline of the island. Unfortunately, that also meant seeing that there was no other form of human or hybrid civilization out here. The sun was moving further over the horizon, threatening to set before they could get back down to the beach where the rest of their company were. Just as they were about to head back, Catra notices something on the far side of the island.
“Over there!” Catra points, “That looks like something we can use.”
Sea Hawk squints in the direction that Catra points in, “I can’t see anything…”
“That’s because you got crappy human eyes!’ Catra taunts, “I can see, it looks like an old boat on the shore, close to the tree line.”
He squinted again, “Ah! I think I see it!” He put his hands on his

hips triumphantly, “I think we can definitely use it. With the help of my dear Mermista, we should be in Bates in no time.”
“Speaking of Bates, do you even know where we are?” Catra tilted her head as she asked the question.
“I’ve never been on this island before.” Sea Hawk replied, “But! But, I have seen this on my maps. This island is part of a group of 6 small islands that make up the Ardon Isles. The other 5 islands only appear at certain times when the water recedes enough to see them.”
“Right…” Catra nods, “So, you’re telling me the other 5 islands are currently, under water?”
Sea Hawk nods with a wide grin, “Yes. You are correct. This island that we are on, is the biggest of the 6. Which is probably why it is also the only one that doesn’t get submerged underwater.”
“Hold up.” Catra starts to climb the tallest tree she could find. Shouting down to the captain, “If there’s an old boat here… that means there would have been people here at some point, right?”
“Yes…” Sea Hawk answered, “But, the boat looks quite old…”
“Do you think whoever got marooned out here made it back?” Catra asked just loud enough for Sea Hawk to hear, the hint of worry in her voice not going unnoticed.
“Do not worry, my dear Sea-Cat.” Sea Hawk comforted from the forest floor as he looked up into the trees for Catra’s silhouette, “We will not be stuck her. We will get off this island.”
Rolling her eyes, Catra took a mental image of its location before climbing back down and gesturing to Sea Hawk for them to head back down to meet up with the rest of their crew.

“You found a boat?” Bow shouted in surprise, “That’s amazing!”
“Calm down, Arrowboy.” Catra brushed off his enthusiasm, “I only just saw it. We don’t even know what kind of condition it’s in until we get to the other side of the island.”
“Sea-Cat has amazing eyesight!” Sea Hawk proudly declared.
“Don’t call me that.” Catra muttered under her breath at Sea Hawk, who gave her an apologising look, “Anyways, I thought we could check it out at first light.”
Mermista sat up, “It won’t matter if the boats not in the best condition, once I’m rested enough and have my powers back, I’ll

be able to work my magic to get us to Bates.”
“Uh… should you be using your powers like that? Doesn’t it drain you out?” Bow asked with concern in his voice, “How long does it take for you to, uh, recharge?”
“What is this? 20 questions?!” Mermista snapped, “Do you want to get off this island or not?”
“Yeah, but not if we are going to get stranded in the middle of the ocean because you’ve run out of magic.” Glimmer replied a little irritated, “Even I know my limitations.”
“Fine!” Mermista concedes, “Then what would you suggest?!”
“We check it out in the morning.” Adora interrupts, “And then go from there.”
“I’m good with that plan.” Catra agreed moving next to Adora, “Now… how about some food?”
The others looked at each other sheepishly, “Seriously?” Glimmer huffed, “So all we got is water?”
Bow nodded.
Catra squeezed Adora’s side and started walking into the waves,
“Hey! Where are you going?” Adora called.
“To get us some dinner!” Catra shouts back without turning her head.
The water was cold as Catra stood knee deep in it, luckily the sun hadn’t fully set yet and she could still see fish swimming around her ankles. She quickly unsheathes her claws and in one quick swipe pulls out a fish. “Ha!” Catra cheered to herself as she flung the fish towards the beach, “Set a fire. We are eating tonight!”
Adora got to work, collecting firewood with the help of Bow and Glimmer while Sea Hawk gutted and cleaned the fish Catra was pulling out of the water. Eventually Catra came out of the ocean, drenched but with a satisfied grin on her face and stood at next to the fire.
“You. Are. Amazing.” Adora pulled Catra into her, pressing their lips together.
“I know.” Catra smirked before reluctantly pulling away, “I’ve just got to shake off this excess water out of my fur.”
“Okay.” Adora spoke softly into Catra’s cheek as the magicat pulled away.
Catra walked far enough from everyone so she could shake out

her fur. Adora kept watch over her while she did it, not caring if anyone saw them keep an eye on each other. Once Catra had shaken off 3 times, she made her way back to the group and stood by the fire again, sticking her hands out to warm them up. Bow had fashioned a few sticks for them to prop the fish on to cook so they wouldn't need to constantly hold them, while Glimmer teleported back and forth with fresh water to boil.
"Where'd you find something to boil the water, Sparkles?" Catra asked looking very surprised.
"The horses." Glimmer pointed her finger at Swift Wind, "Or did you forget that our stuff was still strapped to them?"
"Nice one." Catra nodded, "Are there any… spare clothes in there?"
Glimmer pulls out some clothes that are completely soaked, "Yeah, but I don't think you want them."
Catra sighs, "I guess, I'll be sleeping in these tonight then." Gesturing to her own wet clothes."
"Well, you can always sleep without clothes, Wildcat." Mermista suggestively mentions. Catra glares at her, "What? It's not like you to be shy about that sort of thing."
"I'll think about it." Catra grits out.
"I don't mind." Adora whispers into Catra's ear, "At least you'll be able to dry your clothes overnight."
Catra smirks over at Adora, "I will if you will."
The blonde is thankful that the sun has now set and the fire doesn't show her red cheeks. She can't even come up with a comeback so she just huffs and crosses her arms in front of her, "We'll see."
Pulling the blonde into her, Catra chuckles as she presses a kiss to Adora's forehead, "It's okay. We don't have to do anything. I'm too tired anyways. All I want to do after we eat is sleep with you in my arms."
"Wet arms." Adora points out.
"I'll get them dry by the fire, alright?"
Adora agrees and they sit around the fire, watching as their food cooks and sharing stories. With full stomachs, the group separate to sleep.
Adora's mouth drops as she watches Catra start stripping off her

still damp clothes, “What are you doing?”
“Sleeping naked. Why?” Catra doesn’t even turn around when she drops her pants, they are far enough from the group and with moonless night sky, it’s not easy to see anything at all, “I thought you’d join me?”
The hesitation in Adora’s body is indication enough that Adora is clearly not ready for this, “It’s fine Adora,” Catra tells the blonde while hanging her damp clothes on a branch, “You don’t need to undress. You don’t have damp clothes, so, it’s fine.”
“Okay.” Adora agrees, “Are you ready?”
“Yeah.” Catra moves onto the soft sand and lays sideways, facing Adora. “Come here.”
Adora scooted over next to Catra, falling effortlessly into their nightly routine, “Goodnight Catra. If I get up earlier than you, I’ll grab your clothes.”
An amused sound came from behind Adora, “You have never gotten up before me. What makes you think it’ll be any different tomorrow, princess?”
A yawn escaped from Adora as she shifted back into Catra’s embrace, “Mmm, I like being in your arms…”
The mumbled thought made Catra’s ears peak, “I like it too.” Catra whispered into Adora’s hair as she held her tighter against her bare fur, “Go to sleep now, princess.”
Another loud yawn from the blonde as Catra felt Adora relax into her hold. It didn’t take long for Catra to follow suit.

Adora woke up in Catra’s lap. The blonde’s eyes opened and she saw that Catra had gotten dressed and was gently stroking Adora’s arm while watching the waves.
“Morning princess.” Catra rasped without looking down, “Sleep well?”
Adora smiled as she buried her face into Catra’s stomach, “It’s too early for you to be this cheerful…”
“Can you blame me?” Catra’s words came through a wide smile, “I’ve got a beautiful woman laying in my lap who kisses me whenever I want.”
“Sap!” Adora chuckles as she unburied herself and sat up, placing a gently kiss on Catra’s neck.

“The others are still asleep.” Catra pointed to the others, “So, lie back down if you want.”
Adora looked around, the sun had just started to rise, “No, I want to watch this.”
Catra wrapped her arm around Adora’s shoulder as they watched the sunrise together in silence. Once the beach slowly lit up, Catra turns to Adora, “Hey Adora.”
The blonde smiles back and yawns, “You are far too happy to be up this early.”
“Can’t help it.” Catra stands, “Time to wake the others. We have a boat to scavenge.”
The mischievous look in Catra's eyes brings a smile to Adora's face, "You're not going to do anything crazy, are you?"
"Whatever do you mean?" Catra replies approaching the others on all fours getting ready to pounce on them as a wake up call.

Chapter End Notes

They'll get to Bates eventually...
Thanks for reading.

It's a Paddling

Chapter Summary

The crew figure out a way off the island and onto Bates.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The early wake up call from the magicat was very not appreciated from their fellow crew, as mentioned by a very tired and angry Glimmer and an even angrier and more sweary Mermista. After a few death threats towards the magicat, the rest of the crew finally get up and get ready to head to the old boat Sea Hawk and Catra had found yesterday.
The 2 horses are fitted with what's left of their gear and they start making their way to the other side of the island. Glimmer and Mermista are on top of each of the horses while the others walk alongside.
"How far is it to the other side of the island?" Bow asks towards the group, "Is it worth it going all this way for this old boat?"
Sea Hawk smiles back at Bow, "It's not too far of a walk. The old boat might still be salvageable. We may be able to get it afloat again using whatever has washed up from our previous vessel. We could easily patch up this old boat if we need to." Sea Hawk glances up to Mermista, "Plus, my dear Mermista once fully recovered will be able to help us in getting to Bates once we get back onto the water in a vessel that is buoyant for long enough."
"Sea Hawk!" Mermista scolds, "There is no way I am going to be able to float all of us to Bates in the state I'm currently in."
"What state is that?" Glimmer probes, "You look okay to me right now."
"Yeah, thanks Glitter Princess." Mermista huffs, "My magic still isn't 100% back yet. I basically drained all of it keeping these beasts afloat."
"How much time do you need?" Glimmer asks trying not to sound too agitated by how grumpy Mermista is, "My powers regenerate

after a few hours."
"Well, we all aren't as lucky as you, are we?" Mermista drawled while rolling her eyes, "You of all people should know that magic doesn't work the same for everybody."
Glimmer scoffs, "Of course I know."
"Okay…" Adora breaks the tension between the two princesses, "Lets just get to the boat first before we start assuming things, okay?"
Reluctantly both women nod and turn away from each other. Catra puts her arm around Adora's waist and gently pulls them closer in together, "Nice one, princess."
Adora grins back Catra as they drop a few steps behind the group to get a little privacy, "I don't think I could watch those two at each other's throats so early in the morning."
"It was very admirable." Catra replies wrapping her tail around Adora's thigh, "How are you?"
Adora smiles back at Catra, feeling the tail around her leg, "I'm good."
"Yeah?"
"Yeah." Adora puts her hand over Catra's that is around her waist as she leans into the magicat's ear, "I'd be better if we had a bit more privacy, our own room and bed…"
"That would be nice, wouldn't it?" Catra replies, "It's been a while since we shared a bed together."
"It's not the same on the beach, out in the open." Adora whispers again, "I kind of just want you all for myself."
Catra shudders at Adora's suggestion, "I want you all to myself too."
They giggle behind the group as Glimmer clears her throat loudly, "Ahem! If you two can quit flirting with each other… Bow and Sea Hawk could use some help out front."
Catra groans, "What's wrong?"
"We need to clear a path for the horses." Bow shouts back to the group, "We just need a few more hands to move some of these downed trees."
"Why can't the horses just walk around them?" Catra points out, "They can walk in the water, can't they?"
"No. We are not walking them over the rocks." Glimmer grunts

back to Catra, “There’s no grip and they’ll get washed off. With us on them!”
“Yeah, Wildcat.” Mermista agrees boredly, “I don’t have the power right now to save these two horses and Glitter here if they fall in because you’re too stubborn to help the guys move a few trees.”
“Are you going to help?” Catra returns with a wicked grin.
Mermista rolls her eyes, “What do you think?” Catra shakes her head, “There you go. Now, get to work.”
Catra laughs and pulls Adora with her towards Bow and Sea Hawk while Glimmer and Mermista stay on their horses like the princesses they are. Adora and Bow move the smaller pieces off, while Sea Hawk chops haphazardly at the fallen trees into smaller pieces. Catra slashes her claws doing the same and then hauling the pieces off back into the tree line. Once they’ve cleared enough of a path, they continue forward with Bow and Sea Hawk guiding the horses through, carefully bringing their partners through the clearing while Catra and Adora waited up ahead on the other side.
They eventually make it to the old boat. Catra walks over to the boat first, inspecting it with Sea Hawk close behind her.
“Well, what do you think?” Catra asks Sea Hawk as they both stand a few steps from the old boat, “She doesn’t look too bad, does she?”
“Who are you talking about?” Adora asks leaning her chin on Catra’s shoulder, “Who exactly is ‘she’?”
Catra turns to Adora, “Why? Are you jealous of this old boat?”
The smirk on Catra’s face makes Adora blush, “No. Why would I be jealous of an old boat?” The blonde wraps her arms around Catra from behind, “Besides, ‘she’ can’t give you what I can.”
“Oh yeah, and what can you give me?” Catra whispers into Adora’s ear as her tail curls around the blonde’s leg again.
“Me.”
Catra chuckles deeply as she leans back into Adora’s chest, “That, would be nice.”
“Seriously, you two are too bloody cute.” Glimmer scoffs, “Remind me not to be in the room next to you two when we get to Bates.”
“When we get to Bates.” Catra emphasizes, “So, Sea Hawk. What do you think?”
Sea Hawks plays with his moustache a little bit, thinking, “I think

she can be salvaged."
He walks over, runs his hand over the old wooden boat and hisses when a splinter jobs him in the finger, "Ouch!"
"Gotta watch for them splinters." Bow comes over to inspect Sea Hawks hand, "I can get that out for you. Just hold still."
Sea Hawk flinches as Bow pinches the splinter out of the captain's hand, tossing the little wooden piece away as soon as he gets it out of his hand. "Thank you." Sea Hawk said proudly once his hand was rid of the splinter.
"It was no problem." Bow beamed back at the captain.
Mermista rolls her eyes as she dismounts the horse, "The boat looks fine. It's old. But she'll float."
"Okay, good." Glimmer claps her hands together, "It's settled then."
"What's settled?" Bow asks confused with Glimmer's declaration.
"The boat floats, so we'll have a way off this island." Glimmer explains, "Mermista just said, it'll float."
"Yeah, for like a minute." Mermista scoffed, "We need to do some repairs on it first."
"We?" Glimmer runs her hands down her face.
"Yeah, Sparkles." Catra throws back, "Get off the horse would you? We need to go back and grab the extra bits of wood from Sea Hawks old ship."
Glimmer grunts as she gets off the horse, "Fine."
Catra turns back to the group, "Alright, A few of us will head back to where we were before and gather up as many supplies as we can carry while the others can set up camp here for the night." She looks over at Adora, "I don't think we'll be in our own bed tonight princess."
Adora rolls her eyes at Catra before smiling, "Can I go with you?"
"Yeah, you can take Swift Wind back." Catra suggests, "So, who's staying here while we go grab stuff?"
Sea Hawk puts his hand up, "I'll stay and start working on the boat. I think Bow should go with you two."
"Yeah, okay." Bow agrees, "Do you want the Melog?"
"I don't like being on horses." Catra replies, "So, he's all yours."
Adora and Bow get up on top of the horses as Catra walks in front of them, leading them back to their former camp. They get back

there faster, Bow and Adora engage in some small talk about their pasts and a few stories from before as Catra keeps an eye and ear out in front. Once they are back, Adora and Bow dismount and help Catra collect the bits of wood that washed up onto shore from their previous vessel.
Catra signals for the other two to pull the pieces of wood just next to the tree line while she goes into the trees and grabs a few vines to make into rope. When she gets back, Bow and Adora are on their backs in the sand, exhausted from hauling the bits of wood onto the shore.
Catra snorts when she sees them, "You two doing alright?"
"We did all the hard work!" Adora whines, "Where did you go?"
Holding up her vine ropes up, Catra smirks at the pair, "You guys gonna help me tie up the bits of wood or just lie there?"
"I think I'm just going to lie here for a bit." Bow breathes out, "I'm exhausted. I need water."
Bow yelps as Catra throws a water bottle toward him, "Drink up."
She looks at Adora, "How are you doing?"
"So tired…" Adora whines again with a smile, turning over onto her side so she can get a better view of Catra, "Do you even need us to help?"
Getting to work, Catra sets the vine ropes down onto the sand next to stacked up piles of wood and starts piling them on top of the ropes, making it easier to bundle, "No. But I thought I'd ask anyways." Catra grins at the blonde, fangs on display, "You rest up there princess, I'll get you guys to help me put it on the horses later."
Flopping back onto the sand, Adora hums happily, "Okay."
Bow passes the water bottle to Adora and flops back down next to her, "I'm so hungry…"
Catra laughs at his plight, "Then catch some fish."
"But you're so good at it…" He whines playfully, making Adora snort at his attempts to get Catra to fish for him, "We all sucked trying to get fish yesterday."
"Yeah, I know." Catra replies looking up from stacking the wood, "I'll fish when we get back to the others."
The pair make defeated noises as they slump back down again as Catra continues to work, shaking her head at the pair. "You two

are unbelievable.” She mumbles under her breath, a smile on her face as she bundles up a stack.
After about an hour, Catra rubs the sweat off her brow and she notices snoring from her 2 companions. Rolling her eyes as she brings the horses over to the now tied bundles she swings the bundles over the saddles of the horses and ties them on. She moves over to grab the water bottle that’s now next to Adora’s leg and takes a well deserved drink before nudging the pair with her foot.
“Hey, wake up!” she yells at the pair sleeping in the sand.
Bow makes groans and turns over while Adora just furrows her brow a little. Catra sighs at the pair before she bends down and gently rubs her thumb over Adora’s cheek, before leaning in and kissing her softly on the lips. “Wake up Adora. We need to get going.”
“Mmm…” Adora moans unconsciously, making Catra chuckles lowly, “Okay.”
As Adora’s eye flicker open Catra moves over to Bow and gives him a hard shove in the shoulder, “Get up!”
“Okay, okay!” Bow grunts loudly as he sits up, “I’m up. Stop kicking me!”
“You guys didn’t even help me load up the horses. So don’t give me lip.” Catra chastises, “So, get up and get moving.”
Adora wraps her arms Catra making the magicat calm down, “Thank you.”
Catra turns around int Adora arms, “It’s fine. Both horses are loaded up, so we’ll be walking back.”
Bow breathes out disappointedly, “Okay, well, lets get back then. Lead the way.”

Sea Hawk has managed to take out all the rotted and really bad pieces of timber off the boat and is sitting on the beach weaving his own set of ropes when the other trio return with the rest of the boards. Glimmer glanced up from where she was sitting, looking bored, “They’re back!”
Glimmer runs full sprint into Bow’s arms, “Hey Glim. We were only gone for a couple of hours.”

“I missed you!” Glimmer whispers into Bow’s ear, “What took you guys so long?”
Before Catra could say anything, Adora cut her off, “We’re back.”
The blonde says with a smile, “How’s the boat looking?”
From where Sea Hawk and Mermista are sitting, Sea Hawk grins back and replies, “She’s looking very good. And once we patch her up, she’ll be even better.”
“Will the horses fit in too?” Adora concern for the horses makes Catra smile, “We can’t leave them here.”
Sea Hawk thinks to himself, doing some kind of calculations in his head, “Yes. It may be old, but I think we can make it sturdy enough for all of us plus 2 horses.”
They all look at each other in disbelief, “Uh, how do you plan on making it sturdier? The horses weigh a lot.” Glimmer retorts.
Sea Hawk starts rambling about something in regards to more wooden planks positioned in certain places and with the help of Mermista’s magic, he is happy with the plan. Everyone else? Not so much. Mermista is already dreading having to drain her magic again to save two beasts.
“So, in conclusion, yes Adora, the horses will fit on the boat with all of us.” Sea Hawk finally concludes.
“Great.” Catra returns as she motions for Bow to help get the bundles of wood off the horse's backs, “You guys collect any food while we were gone?”
Glimmer shakes her head, “We only managed to get fresh water.”
“Okay.” Catra sighs looking at Adora, “Guess I’m going fishing again…”
Adora pulls the magicat into her, “Yes, please! You want some company?”
“No, I think you should keep dry. Don’t want you scaring off the fish.” Catra replies truthfully, no malice in her voice, “Besides, if I catch, Bow can gut them and you can cook them.”
“Sounds like a fair deal.” Adora presses her lips onto Catra’s, “Go get them, tiger!”
Catra growls playfully as she turns towards the waves and walks in up to her knees and waits. Adora watches Catra move around stealthily in the water, waiting patiently looking down into the water, claws out and her tongue sticking out in concentration. In

fairly quick succession of slashes and strikes into the water, Catra has managed to throw 3 fishes onto the shore. Bow and Glimmer run around frantically making sure the fish don't end up back in the water. Catra stays in the water a little longer, managing to catch enough for the entire group before trudging back onto dry land. As requested, Bow guts and cleans the catch and Adora with the help of Glimmer cook the fish. Catra, Sea Hawk and Mermista work on getting the old boat seaworthy again. Eventually Mermista storms off in a huff when Catra and Sea Hawk disagree on how to repair the old boat. The afternoon breeze comes through as they eat their dinner and make camp for one more night.

"Reckon we'll be able to set sail first thing in the morning, Captain?" Bow asks hopefully.

Sea Hawk who is lying on his back with his eyes closed, still licking his lips from dinner eventually replies, "Yes. I believe so. As long as the weather holds out."

They all look up into the clear night sky, "What does that mean?" Glimmer poses, "The weather seems alright."

Sea Hawk points straight down towards his boots, "Those clouds over there might beg to differ."

Catra sniffs the air, "Ah crap."

"What?" Glimmer groans.

"Rains coming." Catra replies digging into the sand for her and Adora to sleep in, "Probably won't hit us until midday, if we are lucky."

Mermista turns her head slightly to glance over at Catra digging, "Wildcat, since when did you became a meteorologist?"

"Shut up!" Catra returns, "Besides, you have to know when to get off a steel structure before lighting burns you out."

"Hmm, true." Mermista nods before flopping back down onto Sea Hawks chest, "Well, my powers should be fully recharged tomorrow so we'll make it in good time to get to Bates."

"Fantastic." Bow beams as he pulls Glimmer into him to get ready to sleep, "Oh and Catra?"

"Yeah?"

"If you are going to wake us up again tomorrow morning, maybe just a gentle nudge instead of a full blown attack on our sleeping

bodies would be better?" Bow suggest nervously, "Please?"
Catra smirks back at him, "Sure. I'll tone it down."
They all eventually settle down for the night, paired up as per usual, and just far away from each other that they couldn't hear each pair whisper to one another. It was nice.
"Hey." Adora whispers into Catra's ears, "Spoon me?"
Catra chuckles lightly and turns over, wrapping her arms around the blonde, "Definitely." The magicat breathes in Adora's hair, it's losing the smell of the shampoo from the last shower she had, but it still smells intoxicatingly arousing for the magicat. Shaking those thoughts out of her head, Catra leans in, "Are you warm enough?"
Adora nods, "Yeah. Very. Now that you're hugging me."
Catra purrs into Adora's back, "You are very warm. So, no complaints from my end."
They both fall asleep in their now very routine position.

Catra wakes up first again. It's still dark but her arm is crushed and numb under Adora's weight. The blonde is fast asleep still, snoring lightly as Catra pulls the blonde in closer to herself and off her numbed arm. She rests Adora's face on her chest as she opens and closes her fist to get the blood circulating through it again. Closing her eyes again, she listens to Adora's gentle breaths and feels the blonde's fingers twitch into her shirt every now again. Every so often, Catra presses a kiss on Adora's forehead or the top of her head. The magicat waits until the sun starts to break through the horizon before carefully waking Adora up.

Once everyone is awake, Glimmer, Adora and Mermista clamber onto the boat as soon as it's deep enough. The horses loaded on first with Adora making sure they stayed calm and didn't tip the boat. Bow and Catra are on the sides of the boat, pushing off until their feet don't touch the sea floor anymore before scrambling on board with paddles in their hands while Sea Hawk brings up the rear. Pulling himself up and taking control of the rudder.
"To Adventure!" Sea Hawk shouts as Mermista groans.
"To Bates!" Bow shouts with just as much enthusiasm, "This is so exciting!"
"Keep paddling Bow!" Catra yells over to him, "We need to get

clear of the choppy waves before we get in the clear."
Bow quickly shuts up and starts paddling in time with Catra.
Glimmer watches Mermista with intensity, "Can't you do something?"
"What would you have me do, Sparkles?" Mermista's eyes narrow at Glimmer, "I'm already keeping us afloat with the added weight of 2 horses. So unless you want us to definitely sink, I'd say zip it."
Glimmer huffs but does as she's told, holding onto the sides of the boat, watching Adora calm the horses down. Catra and Bow both grit their teeth, paddling harder to get into the calmer waters. The boat rocks side to side, Mermista using her magic to correct it and groaning to the fact that she had to expend more energy than was necessary.
"Nearly there!" Sea Hawk announces, "Just a few more waves and we'll be in the clear."
Catra curses under her breath, her muscles are fatigues and her hands ache from gripping the paddle so hard in case she accidentally let go of it. Bow's gritting his teeth too. They know they'll tire out soon but also know that the final push is more important than burning lungs, aching muscles and sore hands.
"Keep going Bow!" Catra shouts in her own exhaustion, "We're nearly there!"
Bow grunts loudly, gritting his teeth harder as he continues to paddle. Glimmer cheers them on, "You can do it guys!"
"We've made it!" Sea Hawk declares as Catra and Bow both flop back into the boat after pulling their paddles out, "Good work crew!"
Through Bow's huffing and puffing he manages to say, "I think my arms are going to fall off…"
"Mine too." Catra looks over with a tired grin on her face as they both break out in laughter.
Catra closes her eyes as she tries to recover, she's kind of jealous that Glimmer is by Bow's side right now, while Adora is at the front of the boat keeping their horses calm.
"Catra?" Adora's voice seems distant, "Are you okay?"
"Yeah. I'm good." Catra manages to pant out, "Just need to get the feeling back into my arms…"

“You did good. You and Bow both did.” She says with pride, “I wish I could have helped…”
Catra tries to sit up but decides against it when her arms wobble behind her, “You did. You kept the horses calm.”
Adora smiles back at Catra, “They’re good horses.”
“Yeah, I know.”
“How far until we get to Bates?” Adora asks now that they are currently on calmer waters.
Sea Hawk looks to the sun to gauge their position, “We should be there in a few hours.”
“That fast, huh?”
Sea Hawk nods, “We didn’t get pushed off track as far as I thought we did after all. So as long as we can keep the pace, we’ll be there hopefully just after midday.” Sea Hawk clears his throat, “My dear Mermista, how are you going?”
“I’m fine, Sea Hawk.” She grunts out, “Just don’t go expecting me to move us quicker. My magic is currently only reserved for emergencies.”
“Duly noted my dear.” Sea Hawk grins, “Those clouds seem to have moved off in the other direction. Guess the wind is in our favour.”
“Wake me when we get there.” Catra declares as decides she’s had enough for now, “Also wake me if another sea monster comes out of nowhere or if I somehow end up in the water.”
Adora chuckles at Catra’s statements, “Don’t worry Catra, I’m not going anywhere without you.”
Catra smiles to herself and drifts off.

They arrive at Bates as predicted by Sea Hawk. The winds had been kind to them after all. As soon as they step onto dry land and unload all their gear from the boat, Catra takes Adora by the hand and tugs her away from the crew, quickly shouting, “We’ll be right back!”
“What are you doing, Catra?” Adora giggles as Catra drags her away from their friends.
“Your face, Adora.” Catra says seriously, “I guess I was right. The map appears once we get the next destination.”
Adora looks at her hands, the map ink has disappeared, leaving

no marks on Adora's skin. Except for now, Adora's face, lips, forehead and neck show more pieces of the map. "Is it bad?"
Catra shakes her head, "No, but we need to cover it."
Looking around, Catra grabs a cloak off a fence and wraps it around Adora, popping the hood up over Adora's head, "There. That should get us out of trouble for now."
All of a sudden, the skies open up and the rain starts pouring. Catra smirks at Adora, "Well, at least now you don't need a reason to have a hood on."

Chapter End Notes

Thanks for reading!

Back on Dry Land

Chapter Summary

A bit of R&R in Bates - kind of.

Chapter Notes

New Chapter - enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The group said their goodbyes to Sea Hawk and Mermista and went their separate ways. The captain and the sea princess started arguing as soon as they turned their backs on the group of 4 and walked around the docks looking for another ship to take on. Catra and Adora went to get them accommodation for the night before heading off the next day to wherever the map on Adora's face and lips took them. The magicat figured, the faster they get to the next destination, the faster the ink will fade on the blonde's face. But before they could get to the next destination, they had to figure out where that was.
Catra led Adora into their room and the blonde stripped off to her smalls and was about to flop onto the bed when Catra growled at her in warning.
"What?" Adora turns around.
"Shower first." Catra orders, "You're not getting into our bed dirty and sandy."
Adora smiles as she slips out of her smalls in front of the magicat and into the bathroom, deliberately leaving the door open, "Okay. I'll be right back."
Catra smirks at the blonde as she walks away, "Want some company?"
Adora hums back an answer as she turns on the shower and letting out a relieved sigh once the water hits her body, "Mmm, I missed this so much."
Catra starts to strip off her clothes too and follows Adora to the bathroom when there's a knock on the door as she takes a step

inside and only gets a quick glance at the bathing blonde. The magicat is about to take another step when the knocking becomes more persistent as Catra groans. Adora giggles at Catra's reaction and subsequently turning back around and out the door to put her clothes back on and shutting the door to the bathroom so no one else gets to see Adora bathing.
Catra stomps her way to the door as the knocking continues. She swings it open angrily, "What?!"
Glimmer's fist is still mid air in knocking as she smirks back at the magicat, "Oh, are we interrupting something?" she asks as her and Bow push past Catra and into their room, "Where's Adora?"
Bow's eyes catches Adora's clothes scattered on the floor leading up to the bathroom and he quickly turns his head away in a blush, "Um, Glim… maybe we should give them a little time… to… uh…"
Glimmer brushes off his concern, clearly on caring, "They can have sex after we talk figure out where we need to go next."
Catra's ears flick towards the bathroom, hearing the water shut off, "Excuse me." The magicat grabs a few clean clothes and undergarments for Adora and knocks on the door, "Adora?"
The door opens a little and Catra catches Adora's smiling eyes, "Coming in?"
"We have company…" Catra grunts out annoyed as she holds out fresh clothes for Adora, "Maybe another time?"
"I'll hold you to that." Adora smiles taking the clothes from Catra's hand, she can see the magicat desperately trying not to look and that gives Adora the confidence to open the door just enough for the magicat to get a full view of her body before she promptly closes the door to get dressed.
Catra breathes out an unsteady breath, what is this girl doing to her. She rubs her face with her hands and heads back to the other couple sitting down on the guest chairs in the room. Catra stands with her arms crossed as she stares down her companions, "She'll be out soon."
Bow and Glimmer chatted amongst themselves as Catra watch the bathroom door, waiting for Adora to come out. Adora comes out fully dressed and during her hair with the towel as she smiles at Catra. "Oh, hey guys." Adora greets Glimmer and Bow.
"Your face…" Bow stares as Adora looks away embarrassed,

“Sorry, I didn’t mean to…”
“No, it’s okay.” Catra takes Adora’s hand and gives it a squeeze as the blonde replies, “I can’t exactly cover it up.”
Catra grinned at her handiwork on Adora’s face, all the places she’d kissed Adora had a piece of the map inked on her skin, but then she also felt guilty that Adora would have this on her face until they got to their next destination.
Glimmer grabbed Adora by the face and examined her closely, the blonde’s eyes went wide open at how close Glimmers face was to hers. From the side, she could hear the low growl from Catra which is completely ignored by the sparkly princess. As Catra is about to pull Glimmer off Adora, the sparkle princess lets go on her own accord and jumps back excitedly, “I know where we are going next!”
The declaration stuns everyone in the room, “Since when do you know where anything is?” Bow questions surprisingly, “You can’t even find your own city on a map.”
Glimmer blew a raspberry at Bow and then pointed to a spot on Adora’s cheek, “I might not be able to find Bright Moon, but I definitely know where this is.”
“Please, enlighten us.” Catra taunts as she pulls Adora away from Glimmer, “Where are we going next?”
“Mystacor.” Glimmer answers with confidence.
“Mystacor?” Catra repeats, “As in the place in the clouds?”
Glimmer nods with a grin, “How the fuck are we supposed to get up there?”
“My Aunt actually owns a place up there, a retreat of sorts.”
Glimmer waves her arm like it was common knowledge, “Do you remember how to get there, Bow?”
Bow thinks about it for a moment, “I’ll need to get acquire a map tomorrow.” He answers, “Once I get my bearings, we can go from there.”
“Okay, well, now that that is settled, would you two kindly head back to your own room?” Catra asks through gritted teeth, “Unless there’s something else?”
“I was thinking we could grab some dinner together…or we can go down and get some dinner and bring it back up here to eat so Adora’ doesn’t have to cover her face the entire time we are

downstairs in public.” Bow suggests.
Adora smiles at Bow, “That, actually sounds really good.”
Catra huffs but relents, “Fine. Do it.”
“We’ll be right back!” Glimmer grabs Bow by the arm and leads him out, “I don’t want to catch you 2 mid sex when we get back, so keep it in your pants until after dinner!”
Adora blushes at Glimmers words while Catra’s tail thumps from side to side in annoyance, “Fine. We won’t do anything while you’re gone. Okay?”
“Great!” Glimmer claps her hands, “Make out all you want though.” She throws in as consolation before her and Bow are gone and out of sight.
“Those two are frustrating.” Catra groans as she slumps down in one of the newly vacated chairs, “Are you sure we can’t just ditch them and continue on without them?”
Adora rolls her eyes, “No. We are not leaving our friends.”
“Your friends.” Catra corrects, “They are only my friends when you are around.”
“They are your friends too, Catra.” Adora scolds the magicat, “Now, go get cleaned up.”
“By myself?” Catra whines with a mischievous look on her face.
“I’m already clean.” Adora grins back at Catra, “Unless… you want some help?”
“Hell yeah!” Catra grinned back as she jumped up from her seat and started to strip off and ran into the bathroom, Adora giggling behind as she followed the magicat back into the bathroom and shut the door, “You’ll need to take your dress off Adora. Or it’ll get wet.”
“I was thinking of just watching…” Adora leaned against the door as Catra stood underneath the shower, wetting her hair and the fur across her body.
Catra looked back over her shoulder with a smirk, “Watching isn’t helping, princess.”
Adora blushes back at Catra, her confidence from before now dissipated as she froze under Catra’s gaze, “Uh…”
Catra laughed and turned back to the shower and let the water run over her face, before wiping her face and turning back to Adora, “It’s okay Adora. You don’t have to do anything.”

“Okay.” Adora leans against the door, “My hair is still wet… I’m just going to go back out…”
“Okay Adora.” Catra replies as she runs her hand through her wet hair, “I’ll be out soon. You can wait for Sparkles and Bow to come back with food.”
“That, I can do.” Adora beams back, “I’ll see you soon?”
“Of course.” Catra replies, “Now, get out of here if you aren’t going to help.”
Adora giggles and exits the bathroom while Catra finishes cleaning herself off of all the dirt, sea water and sand from their island stay.

Bow and Glimmer return with a mountain of food, filling the table in Catra and Adora’s room all the way to the edge. They grab two chairs from their own room and pull up to the table ready for dinner.
“Drinks?” Catra asks.
Glimmer rolls her eyes, “Well duh!” Standing up and rolling in the barrel of ale into the room with a smirk on her face, “Let's see if you can outdrink me.”
“You wish!” Catra accepts the challenge happily.
“Uh, are you sure you want to get drunk tonight? I mean, we still need to go to Mystacor…” Bow tries to convince the other 2 not to participate in drinking games, “It is a fairly long way away…”
Glimmer glares back at Bow for a moment before opening her mouth, “We aren’t leaving until the day after.”
“What do you mean?” Adora asks a little pensive, “I thought we were planning to get to the next destination as fast as possible…”
“You can’t just go to Mystacor anytime you want.” Glimmer explains popping a piece of bread into her mouth, “The opening is only a few days a month and since we aren’t actually that far from Mystacor, the next opening is 2 days from today. So we might as well chill out and relax until then.”
“2 days?” Adora repeats, a little groan in her voice, “I can’t walk around town like this.” She points to her face, “And do you expect me to be cooped up in this room until we leave?”
Catra wraps an arm around Adora’s waist and whispers into the blonde’s ear, “I’m sure we can think of something to occupy

ourselves for a day or 2…”
Adora eyes close and she shivers at the thought.
“Quit it, you two!” Glimmer scolds, “Still trying to eat here.”
Catra chuckles as Adora tries to hide the face in her hands, “Sorry Sparkles, but you are in our room after all…”
Glimmer hands Catra a full mug of ale and holds her own out to the magicat, “Cheers!”
“Cheers!”
The pair scull their drinks before slamming their mugs onto the table and laughing.
“How long does it take to get to Mystacor?” Adora decides to ask Bow instead.
“Not too long from Bates.” Bow replies after swallowing a mouthful of food, “It’s probably just over half a days hike from here.”
Adora nods before turning to Catra, “Is there anything else to do here?”
Catra smiles back to the blonde, “Yeah, if you want, there’s a few places I can take you.”
“That’d be nice.” Adora answers.
“Don’t worry about your face, princess.” Catra rubs her thumb lightly over her cheek, “No one in this town will bother us. Okay?”
“Yeah. Okay. I trust you.” Adora replies honestly, “I doubt anyone would mess with you.”
Catra laughed as Glimmer handed her another drink.

The night ended with Bow carrying a very drunk Glimmer back to their room and Catra laughing victoriously at bearing the smaller sparkly princess in their drinking games.
Adora shuts the door once she checks to see that Bow has made it to their room a few doors down and then leans against it, eyeing Catra with a small smile, “You know, that wasn’t fair.”
“I have no idea what you are talking about, princess.” Catra waves off.
Stepping forward so she’s standing in front of a seated Catra, she puts her hands on her hips, “You know human tolerance for alcohol is a lot lower than it is for you.”

“I am aware.” Catra grins with a fang sticking out, “Not my fault Sparkles didn’t know that before challenging me.”
“Are you even affected at all?” Adora asks.
In response, Catra wraps her arms around the blonde's waist and rests her forehead on Adora’s stomach, slowly rubbing her cheek against the blonde, “A little, maybe…”
Adora giggles at the feeling of ticklish sensation of Catra rubbing against her as she rests her hands on top of Catra’s head, one hand scratching one of Catra’s ear and the other massaging through the magicats short hair. She smiles when Catra begins to purr into her stomach as Catra pets her ears. The blonde’s breath hitches when she feels Catra press soft kisses around her stomach and sides while the magicat’s hands start to move soothingly up and down Adora’s legs.
“Mmm, bed?” Catra mumbles between kisses.
Adora nods furiously as Catra presses one more kiss on the blonde’s stomach before standing up from her seat and taking Adora’s hand, leading her to the bed. Before settling Adora on the bed, Catra’s hands run over Adora’s dress, “Hmm, this dress will need to come off.”
Before Adora can say or do anything, Catra has ripped through it with her claws. The blonde pants into a heated kiss with the magicat, “I never liked that dress anyways…”
“Good. I can get you some clothes tomorrow.” Catra grins, “What would you prefer? Another dress?”
Catra removes the now destroyed dress off Adora’s frame and pushes the blonde down onto the bed and begins to kiss the blonde impatiently. Adora pants out, “Pants… pants would be… good.”
“What else?” Catra asks as she continues to kiss Adora’s lips and then moves to her neck.
“A shirt… shirt.” Adora manages to get out as she feels Catra’s hands run up and down her body.
“Is this okay?” Catra whispers as she comes back to face Adora, “I don’t want to rush you.”
Adora’s eyes darken as she pulls Catra back down to her lips, “I want you Catra.”
Catra smiles at Adora’s confession, “I want you too.”

“And I want this.” Adora adds, her voice wavering a little under Catra’s intense stare, “And I want to do this with you.”
A predatory smirk comes across Catra’s face before softening back again as she presses a long and slow kiss on Adora’s lips, making the blonde moan, “I’m going to kiss you all over.”
Adora giggles, “Then do it.”
And that is exactly what Catra does until Adora’s legs are shaking and her throat is dry.

They wake up wrapped naked in each other's arms as the sun comes up. Catra smiles watching Adora sleep on her chest. Her blonde hair disheveled and there are distinctive bite marks on Adora’s body from where Catra marked her. It’s the first time in a long time that she hasn’t been woken up by her arm going numb and it’s a good feeling. She runs her finger along the map lines on Adora’s face gently as the blonde in her arms smiles at the sensation and then eventually stirs.
Ducking her face into Catra’s chest she whispers happily, “Good morning.”
“Morning princess.” Catra replies with a wide grin on her face, “How are you feeling?”
Adora shuffles a little and winces, “A little sore, but good.”
“Want me to kiss it better?” Catra asks teasingly, earning herself a shove in the face by Adora’s hand, “So? No?”
“Mmm, as much as I would love for you to do that again…” Adora smiles into the magicat’s chest, “I think I better go to the bathroom first.”
Catra groans and Adora giggles as the blonde rolls over to get up, “Fine.”
“I’ll be right back.” Adora assures as she walks naked to the bathroom, “Brr… it’s cold in here!”
Cackling from the bed and watching Adora quicken her pace to the bathroom, “I don’t know… it’s pretty warm in bed.”
Adora glares at her playfully before shutting the bathroom door. Catra lies back in bed, a grin on her face as she waits for the blonde to return. It’s not long that Adora dashes back and under the blanket and into Catra’s warm and waiting arms.
“So, do you want me to kiss it better?” Catra repeats her question

from earlier.
The blonde blushes as she feels Catra's hands trail down her body, "It's up to you." Adora teases the magicat back, "I'm not stopping you if you really want to."
Catra grinned and then ducked under the covers to do as she promised. Adora lay back and closed her eyes, a smile on her face as she tried to control her breathing. She giggled as the magicat settled between her legs, the fur tickling her inner thighs as Catra made herself comfortable under the sheets.
They spent most of the morning this way up until there was a knock on the door.
Reluctantly Catra got out of bed, threw Adora's cloak over her body and waited until Adora was covered before answering the door.
"Sparkles. What do you want?" Catra growled at the interruption, "We're kind of busy you know?"
Glimmer rolled her eyes at Catra, "Yeah, I definitely know. You might want to open a window or something."
Catra grinned as she held the cloak closed around herself, "So? What brings you here on our day off?"
"There's a commotion in town and everyone is scared." Glimmer crossed her arms, "From the description I got from the locals, it sounds like one of the creatures that have been coming after Adora."
"Fuck." Catra muttered under her breath before turning back to Glimmer, "Let us clean up and we'll meet you downstairs in 20."
Before Glimmer could walk away, Catra calls out, "Hang on! I need to get some clothes for Adora…"
Glimmer smirked and raised an eyebrow, "Unbelievable…"
"I know I am." Catra grinned, "Uh, let me get ready and go out and get some clothes for Adora first."
"Fine. Whatever." Glimmer started walking back to her room, "We'll see you downstairs together in an hour."
"Okay." Catra replies shutting the door.
"What did Glimmer say?" Adora asks sitting up, exposing her top half as the blankets pool around her waist, "It sounded serious."
"We need to get ready." Catra replied, removing the cloak, "There's a monster in town, like the ones we've encountered

before."
"Oh." Adora looked around for her clothes, "I'm going to need some clothes…"
Catra chuckles, "Yeah, I'm on it." She eyes the blonde, "Let me get ready and I head down and grab some clothes for you. My clothes aren't going to fit you and you can't walk around in just a cloak."
"I can in this room." Adora smirks, "But, fine. Go get ready. We need to help these people. Especially if it's because of me."
"We will." Catra kisses Adora on the lips slowly before the blonde taps the magicat on the butt.
"Get going!" Adora scolds, "You still need to get me clothes!"
Catra laughs as she heads off to the bathroom to clean up and get dressed.

As promised, Catra has managed to get cleaned up, grab clothes for Adora and have the blonde ready and downstairs in half an hour. Glimmer and Bow are sitting lazily in the chairs by the bar, Glimmer has her feet up on Bow's lap as Bow rubs her thighs.
"Been waiting long?" Catra walks up to the couple, who just look up tiredly, "What's up with you guys? You look like shit."
Glimmer frowns as Bow answers for the both of them, "We spent most of the morning trying to track this creature. I am exhausted."
"Where is it now?" Adora asks hiding under the cloaks hood, "And how big is it?"
"Not sure." Bow replies stretching his arms out, "No one can say what or how big it is."
"So… you lost it?" Catra comes to the conclusion, "And now, we have to find it."
Glimmer just groans as she shifts her legs off Bow and back onto the floor, "I think we take the horses this time."
Catra snorts, "Wait, you didn't take the horses before?"
"Shut up!" Glimmer returns, "We weren't planning to be running around all morning while you two were busy with each other."
Adora shifts, Catra can tell the blonde is flustered from Glimmers comment, quickly wrapping a reassuring arm around the blonde's waist, "Yeah? And what's it to you what we do in the confines of

our room?"
"Nothing." Bow cuts in, "Right, Glim?"
"Whatever." Glimmer waves her arm before abruptly standing and poking a finger into Catra's chest, "You better not return to your Wildcat days."
"Fuck off, Sparkles." Catra grabs Glimmer's finger, "This is endgame for me."
"Wait? Really?" Adora turns to Catra so fast her hood nearly falls back, "You're not just saying that?"
Catra narrows her eyes at the blonde, "Really? You're really asking me that?"
"Well…" Adora bites her lip feeling a little embarrassed, "I kind of hoped…"
"It's true, princess." Catra declares, "Until I die or you can no longer stand to be with me, you are my endgame."
"Don't die." Adora tells her seriously, "And I doubt I'll ever not want to be with you. If anything, you'll get bored with me…"
"Nah." Catra grins, "What about me?"
"You already know." Adora rolls her eyes with a smile.
"Gross. Are you two done? Can we get going?" Glimmer groans, "Let find this thing and kill it before it causes more havoc in this place."

It doesn't take long for the creature to be found, since it's drawn to Adora. Catra was surprised that it hadn't gate-crashed their alone time last night, but this creature was big. It looked like an Ankylosaurus except its horns were more bull like than stubby. And it had teeth. Sharp teeth. On top that, it was covered by a hard shell with bumps, lucky for them, it was just flesh underneath it. SO as long as they could flip it onto it back, they would be able to kill it.
The creature charged at the group on their horses, and they were able to lead the creature out of town and into one of the valleys outside to avoid bystanders getting caught up. Adora led the creature out on the horseback while Catra followed behind on foot, getting high to get a better advantage to attack. The creature lunged at the horses, making the riders call off as the horses ran off to safety. After the ship incident, they didn't have

many weapons, or really any at all apart from Catra's knife, that was held firmly in Adora's hand, Catra's claws and Glimmers teleporting abilities.
"Why didn't you get a weapon in town?!" Catra shouted at Bow as they dodged a biting lunge from the creature, "What were you thinking?!"
"This. Is. Not. The time to be…woah… talking about this!" Bow returns rolling away from the creature, "Besides, I'm picky."
Glimmer laughed, "That's true. Woah!" She was almost struck by the creatures swinging tail, "What does it want?!"
"What do you think it wants?" Catra growls back as the creature sets its sight on Adora, "They all want Adora!"
Adora swings the knife at the creature as it growls louder and bares its teeth, before it jerks back feeling Catra on its back. It bucks wildly, trying to get the magicat off it's back, eventually rolling onto its side. Catra has just enough time to move out the way of being crushed as she scampers across the creature's exposed underbelly. As she slices down through the soft flesh of the belly the creature starts to thrash about, throwing the magicat off in the process. As it rights itself, blood and entrails begin to spill out of its stomach from the gaping hole Catra has just cut into it, gravity pulling out more and more of its insides as it lunges one last time catching Glimmer by the foot as it collapses partially onto of the sparkly princess.
"Glimmer!" Bow yells and runs to her aid trying to pull her out from under the creature.
The creature grunts a few more times before it dies as Catra and Adora rush over to help Bow try and pull Glimmer's leg out from under the creature.
"Argh!" Glimmer screams in pain at her foot being crushed and her friends trying to pull her out, "It hurts!"
"I know it does, Glim." Bow tries to calm her and himself down, "But we need to get you out from under it."
"Don't pull!" She screams out in pain as they try again.
"Can't you teleport out from under it?" Catra suggests.
Glimmer closes her eyes to try to teleport but is met by the pain running up her leg, "I can't concentrate…"
"Okay." Catra stands back to think. Bow and Adora stay crouched

next to Glimmer trying to keep her as comfortable as possible, “I have an idea.”
“What?” Glimmer hisses.
“You’re probably not going to like it…”
“I don’t care. Just do it!” she yells as Bow squeezes her shoulder.
Catra walks up to Glimmer and pauses. And takes a good look at where the creature has landing on Glimmer and then mentally pictures the creature's anatomy in her head whilst looking at it. As fast as she can, Catra’s claws come out and makes near surgical slices across the creature's leg, completely decapitating it from its body, as blood splatters across all of them from where she’s made the slices.
The limb drops off from the creature's body as Glimmer, Bow and Adora all squeal at the blood covering them from the arterial spray from the creature's leg. Catra laughs at their reaction after she single handedly pushes the limb off Glimmer.
“Did you have to do that?” Glimmer groans wiping the blood off her face, “Gross!”
“I did tell you, you probably wouldn’t like it.” Catra preens as she wipes the blood from her claws onto her pants, not caring about the blood on her fur currently, “It worked, right?”
“As much as I hate to admit it, it did.” Bow agrees, “Plus, I mean, now we can take a proper look at the damage.”
Adora glares at Catra, “You could have warned us.”
“I could have.” Catra nudges the blonde, “But, it wouldn’t be fair if only Glimmer got the full brunt of it.”
“Still…” Adora rolls her eyes, “I would have liked the option.”
“You wouldn’t have moved, Adora.” Catra tells her flatly, “Like you’d let Sparkles here go through that alone.”
“Fine.” Adora relents, “Just maybe a warning next time?”
Grinning, Catra nods, “Okay.”
Bow examines Glimmers leg and she winces in pain at the slightest touch, “Ow! Fuck that hurts!”
“Yeah, because it was crushed under that fucking dinosaur.” Catra replies teasingly, “Reckon you can teleport now?”
Glimmer shakes her head, “No. All I can think about it how fucking painful this is.”
“We need to get you to a doctor, Glim.” Bow tells her, “I’ll wrangle

up the horses and we can get back to town and get some help."
"Actually, why don't you two stay here?" Adora suggests, "We'll get the horses. You just rest up for now."
"Are you sure?" Bow asks.
"Yes." Catra answers for Adora, "Keep her here." Catra takes off her cloak and throws it to him, "Make her comfortable."
"Thanks." Bow replies gratefully, annoyed at himself for not having one.
Adora pulls Catra towards where the direction the horses had bolted off, "That was nice of you." Catra grunts in response to the compliment, but a smile comes across her face when Adora presses a kiss to her cheek as well, "Thank you."
"You're welcome." Catra replies bashfully, "Let's find those horses."

They get back to town, drawing strange looks from the locals as they saunter back in, covered in blood. They head back to their rooms to quickly clean off all the blood before heading back down to find a medical aid for Glimmer's leg. Glimmer's leg pain is so bad that they end up sending for a doctor up to their room to see to her. As predicted, it's not good but nothing is broken. Apart from bruising and a possible fracture, she'll be out of action for at least 6 weeks. News that she groans at.
"Sorry guys, I don't think I can come with you to Mystacor." Glimmer tells them annoyed, "I really wanted to go."
"I know you do." Bow squeezes her hand from the bedside, "But you need to heal or your leg isn't going to get any better."
"I know." Glimmer whines, "Stupid monster!"
"Is your aunt going to be okay with us staying with her if you guys aren't there? We don't want to intrude…" Adora asks nervously, "I'm sure Catra and I can…"
"It's fine Adora." Glimmer tells her, "I'll write you a note so you can give it to her that'll explain everything, alright?"
Adora nods hesitantly, "I really don't want to intrude…"
"Adora!" Glimmer scolds, "It'll be fine."

The next day, Catra and Adora headed off to Mystacor. Bow followed them to the edge of town and hugged Adora tightly as they said goodbye, Adora cried when Bow could no longer be seen at the edge of town as they went further away.

“Are you okay?” Catra squeezed Adora’s hand, “They’ll be alright.”
“I know.” Adora sniffed, “I’m just going to miss them.”
“Yeah…” Catra agrees, “But the sooner we get to Mystacor, the sooner that ink will be off your face.”
Adora nods as they continue on, “Do you know the way?”
Catra snorts, “Yeah, of course I do. I wouldn’t be out here if I didn’t.”
“Okay.” Adora relaxes holding Catra’s hand, “I’m glad that you’re here with me.”
“Me too.”

The walk to the edge of the valley and look down.
“Through the clouds.” Catra muttered.
“What was that?” Adora asked.
Clearing her throat, “Through the clouds.” Catra said more clearly, much to the confused look on Adora’s face, “We have to go through the clouds. That’s what Glimmer said to me.”
They both look down at the edge of the valley, no ground to be seen below them. Only clouds. Adora gripped Catra’s hand tightly in hers as they both stepped off the edge.

Chapter End Notes

I've been busy with stuff, but I'm still trying to keep this fic posted every Sunday...
Thanks for reading!

Finding Casta

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora arrive at Mystacor.
But finding Casta is not the only thing they come across.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Oof!" Adora lands on top of Catra was they crash onto the soft grass on Mystacor after stepping off the ledge, "Sorry…"
The blonde scrambles to get off Catra, who's laughing as Adora accidently steps on her stomach as she tries to get up, "Careful!"
"Sorry!" Adora stands up and offers a hand to the magicat, "I didn't mean to… uh, land on top of you."
A smirk on Catra's lips as she takes Adora's offered hand and allows herself to be pulled up.
"Hey." Catra smiles at Adora, "The map on your face is fading."
Catra's smile turns into a smug look as she looks Adora up and down, "I bet I know where the rest of the map is covering, right now."
Adora does a quick look under her shirt and gasps, "Oh!"
Catra cackles upon seeing Adora red in the face, knowing all the places she had kissed the blonde when they had some time to themselves in Bates. "I can't wait to see it."
Adora rolls her eyes before smirking back at the magicat, "Well, you're the only one that'll be seeing it. So you better know where it's… directing us next."
"Is that a threat? Princess?" Catra raises her eyebrow. They hold each other gazes for a moment before Catra breaks and laughs, "Come on, we gotta go find Sparkles aunt Casta or whatever."
Adora looks around at their surroundings, "I hope you know which way to go."
Replying with a shrug, Catra takes Adora's hand and starts walking towards what looks like a well-trodden path. "This looks like a good place to start."

They begin walking down the path, hoping it's the right way to Casta's place.

"So…" Adora asks tentatively as she playfully swings Catra's hand in hers, "What are you going to do once this is all over?"
Catra's ears perk up in surprise, "What do you mean?"
"Like, when we find out where this map leads to and find the sword or whatever Bow was talking about." Adora stops the swinging, "What then?"
"I don't know." Catra answers as she stares forward, "I kind of thought…" Catra glances over at Adora who just stares right back, "Uh, I thought that, maybe you'd want to keep… travelling together?"
"Are you asking me?" Adora asks with a smile.
"I mean… if you want to…" Catra squeezes Adora's hand, "No pressure. If it's not what you want, I can just take you home at the end of this."
"Don't you get it?" Adora stops walking and pulls Catra to stop with her, "You are my home."
"Yeah?"
"Of course." Adora certainty and confidence in those words brings a smile to Catra's face, "You said I was your endgame, right?"
Catra nods, "So… what's the plan after all this is over?"
"Don't have a plan." Catra shrugs with a toothy grin, "I'm happy to do whatever you want to do. Actually, scratch that. There is one thing I want to do when all this is over."
"Mm?"
"But, I'm not telling you that until it's over." Adora huffs, "It's a surprise."
"Well, it better be a good one."
"It'll be the best." Another toothy grin from Catra as they resume walking. There's a disturbance in the bushes up ahead and Catra puts her arm out to stop, "Did you see that?"
Adora stares ahead shaking her head, "What was it?"
"I don't know." Catra whispers, "Just, stay here while I check it out."
"What? No!" Adora whisper scolds the magicat, "You're not going in alone. I'm coming with you."

“Adora.” Catra whispers sternly, “Stay back!”
“I’m not letting you fight whatever it is alone!” Adora returns, “Wherever you go, I go.”
Realising she wasn’t going to win this argument, Catra sighs in defeat, “Fine. But, just stay behind me.”
Adora nods as they cautiously approach the disturbance up ahead. Catra’s claws coming out while Adora pulls out the small knife Catra had given her. They get about 20 steps away from the bushes when they both freeze when the whatever was in the bushes reveals itself.
“It’s a… bug?” Adora whispers into Catra’s ear, gripping the knife tighter, “Do you think…”
“It’s not a bug. It’s a spider.” Catra swallows hard, “A really fucking big spider. And it’s got something or someone in the bushes with it.”
“How can you tell?”
Catra points down at the floor of the bushes, “I see feet.”
The blonde’s eyes look down and sure enough, there are feet wrapped in webs, unmoving. “Fuck…” Adora gripped tightly on Catra’s hip, “What do we do?”
“Kill it.” Catra growled back, “Stay back.”
“Catra, no!” Adora pleads, “Don’t. You’ll get killed!”
“No, I won’t.” Catra turns and kisses Adora’s lips, “I’ll be fine. Always am. Just, watch my back. In case there’s more.”
Before Adora can stop her, Catra is sprinting off towards the massive spider, “Hey!” Catra shouts, hoping the spider will turn around and focus on her than its meal, “Over here you big bug!”
The spider doesn’t respond. Catra decides to take the offensive and pounce on the spiders back in a surprise attack. As soon as she does the spider instantly scatters, taking Catra with it.
“Catra!” Adora shouts as she watches the spider scurry off deeper into the bushes and further into the trees, “Catra!” The blonde runs to where the victim is lying on the ground, wrapped completely in the spider's web from head to toe. She looks around, hoping for Catra or someone to help. But everything goes silent. Slowly, she bends down and slices the sticky webbing with her knife, revealing a man. He looks to be dead judging by the colour (or lack thereof) of his skin. The spider must have already

drained him and was just finishing off whatever it could get out of the body. Adora stepped out and back on the path and looked in the trees, “Catra! Where are you?”
Still no response. She stood still, unsure what to do. Staring into the trees, she scanned the area, looking for Catra, trying to see or hear anything.
Adora tries again, shouting as loud as she can, “Catra!”
A shiver goes down her spine. Did Catra get taken? Why hasn’t she come back? Is she hurt? Dead? A million thoughts going through her head at once when she finally hears it. At first, it’s barely audible. The sound of someone shouting, but the words are lost to the distance. Then she hears it again and it makes a little more sense.
“…Adora… Run…” it sounds like Catra, but the blonde can’t see her.
“Catra?! Where are you?!” Adora shouts back, unmoving from her spot hovering over the spider's last kill.
Then she spots the magicat. Sprinting towards her on all fours, “Run!”
Adora turns and starts sprinting down the path, Catra catches up quickly too breathless to converse as Adora takes a glance behind them. There’s not just one spider. There’s a lot of them. More than she can count on one glance.
Catra doesn’t say a word as she takes the lead and starts steering them towards a clearing. It’s a terrible idea. There’s no way they can outrun that many spiders. That’s when Adora trips over something. Catra skids to a stop immediately, turning back to retrieve Adora. Adora looks down at what’s tripped her over, and realised it’s not a rock or a branch, in fact, it looks like the hilt of a sword.
“Get up, Adora!” Catra shouts as she holds her hand out to the blonde, “We need to move, now!”
“Wait!” the blonde takes a second to look at the handle, “I know this.”
Catra turns around, “Now what?!”
Adora puts both hands on the hilt and instantly a bright glow blinds them both as the spiders are thrown back, far away enough to give the pair a little breathing room.

When Catra's manages to blink herself back to sight, she quickly checks over the blonde, "You alright?"
Rubbing her eyes, Adora looked down at the sword in her hands. Surprise on her face at the fact she had pulled it out from the ground somewhere without knowing it, she glanced down at the blade and noticed some strange markings, turning back to Catra's concerned face, "Yeah, I think I'm okay.' She tried to smile reassuringly, "There's something written on here."
Catra looked around, the spiders retreated somewhat far enough and were unmoving, almost scared to approach now that Adora held the sword in her hands, "What does it say?"
Adora squinted down at the blade and read slowly, "For the honor of… Grayskull?"
Whoosh! Catra turned around as the bright light flared up once again, this time engulfing Adora entirely, "Adora!"
When the light faded this time, Adora had been transformed. She was taller. Much taller. Her attire completely different and she wore a tiara. After the initial shock, Catra burst out laughing, "Woah. A tiara? Seriously?"
Adora looked up at the new headpiece addition and shrugged before slapping away Catra's hands from trying to grab at it, "Catra! Stop. Quit playing around."
"Fuck Adora." Catra stood up to height, "What the fuck just happened?"
"I don't know." Adora answered as she pushed Catra behind her as the spiders began approaching again, "Stay back. I got this."
Before Catra could reply, Adora was slashing through the spider army with ease as Catra stood on the sidelines and watched this magical being do her work. It wasn't long before there was no 8-legged arachnid standing on the field.
"Woah. Fuck, Adora. That was amazing." Catra remarks as Adora strides back with a smirk on her face, overshadowing the magicat, "Let me look at your sword."
Adora hands the sword over to Catra, who takes it in her hands and looks over it thoroughly before looking back to Adora, "Are you stuck like that?"
"Like what?"
"Like a fucking giant princess with a fucking sword?" Catra replies

with a chuckle, “I mean, don’t get me wrong, it’s hot and all…”
Adora blushes, “I don’t know how it works…” then Adora realises something and pouts at Catra, “Wait, you think this version of me is hot?”
Catra grins wickedly, “Adora, I think all versions of you are hot.”
She moves closer to Adora, but the affect isn’t really working so she leaps up, Adora catching Catra in her arms easily and the magicat wraps her arms around Adora’s neck, “But I prefer regular Adora.”
Adora rolls her eyes as she leans in to kiss Catra and before long they both tumble on the ground when Adora reverts back to her old self. “Guess I’m not as strong as the other version, huh?” Adora says while Catra laughs on top of her.
“Guess not.” Catra replies as she gets back onto her feet. “Come on.”
Adora takes Catra’s offered hand and they both look at the field of dead spiders. Catra offers the sword back to Adora, who takes it gratefully.
“You’re gonna need a sheath for it.” Catra remarks as they begin walking away from the carnage that Adora just caused, “What happened to the guy before?”
“He was already dead.” Adora answers, “Spider had already killed him.”
“Bummer.”
“Yeah.”

They get to a rather elaborate looking building after an hour’s walk down the path.
“Thank fuck!” Catra happily declares when they see the building, “Reckon Casta is there? Looks expensive enough, right?”
Adora’s eyes lights up when she sees it, “Woah… I’ve never seen anything like this before.”
Pulling out the note that Bow had given them earlier. The note is actually a really well drawn picture of the building they were going to meet Casta. Then thus building is right in front of them.
“According to Bow, this is the place.” Catra pockets the paper again and takes Adora’s free hand, “There better be food.”
Adora snorts, “Of course, that’s all you think about.”

“I think about other things too, you know?” Catra smirks, “Like, if there’s a bed for us to share.”
A blush comes over Adora’s face, despite no one being around to hear Catra’s wants, “You just want to see me naked…”
“No, princess. I just want to see this map.” Catra chuckles a reply back before nudging the blonde as they walk, “And seeing you naked is an added bonus.”
“Well,” Adora huffs good naturedly, “then you have to be too.”
“Be what?” Catra grins.
“…naked.” Adora whispers into the magicat’s ear.
“Whatever you want, princess.” Amusement in Catra’s voice as Adora smiles victoriously to herself.
They get to the front door of Casta’s building and Catra goes up and knocks on it three times before standing back. The door opens after a few seconds and reveals a slender woman with black hair and a confused look.
“Are you Glimmer’s aunt?” Adora asks.
The woman, peers out, looking for something or someone, “Yes. I am Castaspella.” She still looks around the pair, “Where’s Glimmer and Bow?”
“Glimmer hurt her leg yesterday and couldn’t come.” Catra replies, “Doc said she’d have to stay off of it for a while.”
“Oh, what happened?” Casta asks with concern for her niece.
“We were fighting a monster and it landed on top of her.” Catra replied simply before Adora nudged her, “Oh, she was really brave and whatever.”
A look of pride appears on Casta’s face upon hearing how brave her niece is makes Adora smile.
“Ahem.” Catra clears her throat.
Casta snaps out of whatever she was thinking, “Oh, sorry.”
“Um… Glimmer said that we could stay here for a little bit until we figure out where we need to go next?” Adora brings up quietly, “I mean, if that’s alright…”
“Of course!” Casta beams at her new guests, “I’m sorry, I didn’t catch your names.”
“I’m Adora. And this is Catra.” They shake hands with Casta as the older women gestures for the pair to come inside, “Thank you.”
“Oh, any friend of Glimmer’s is a friend of mine!” Catra thinks

Casta probably doesn't spend much time with many people from the outside judging by the way she's acting around them, "Oh, let me show you around!"
Catra just wants to get something to eat and then take a nap but lets herself get pulled along by Adora, eagerly following behind Casta.
"Excuse me, Casta." Catra clears her throat, bringing the taller woman to a halt, "Uh, sorry to interrupt your very extensive tour… but would I be able to get some water? It's been a bit of a trek and all."
Casta smiles, "Oh, where are my manners!" she leads them around to the dining hall, "Yes, of course you would be hungry and thirsty. I mean it doesn't look like you've brought along much at all."
"No. Most of our gear was lost at sea." Adora answers as Casta give her a confused look, "Never mind…"
"I like your sword." Casta eyes the sword in Adora's hand, "I can get someone to make a sheath for it, so you don't cut yourself. I mean, if you would like?"
"That would be amazing. Thank you so much!" Adora's eye light up as she nearly drops her sword, much to Catra's amusement.
In the dining hall, there's a few platters on the tables near the front of the room with food wrapped up ready for consumption as well as a few jugs of drink and cups on the tables.
"Help yourselves." Casta sits on one of the chairs at the dining table, "It's been a while since I've had guests."
"What do you mean?" Adora asks taking the wrapping off one of the platters while Catra fills up 2 cups with water and sits down, "Glimmer said this place was a relaxation retreat or something."
"It is." Casta answers, "But, we've had a…" she waves her hand around for a moment thinking of how to describe what she was thinking, "disturbances."
"If you are talking about those spiders, Adora here took care of them." Catra interrupts after chugging down her cup of water and getting up to refill it, "We did happen to find one poor soul that wasn't so lucky though."
"What do you mean, you took care of it?" Casta asks Catra, "We've been trying to rid them for months! Are you sure you got

them all?”
“Pretty sure.” Catra replies stealing a sandwich off of Adora’s plate, “There were a shit load of them chasing us at one point.”
“Oh.” Casta smiles, “That’s very good. Thank you.”
“Hey, Castaspella?” Catra leans forward in her chair to speak with the older woman, “Is there anywhere we can nap?"
"Yes. I have plenty of rooms. Pick any two you might like.” Casta offers.
“Oh, we’ll only need 1.” Catra replies, “We’ve gotten quite used to sleeping next to each other.”
Adora rolls her eyes at Catra’s elaboration but doesn’t say anything with her mouth full. Casta finally gets it and laughs, “Of course.” She puts her hands together, “Ah, young love.”
Adora chokes on the water she’s sipping as Catra snorts, “One room will be fine.” Catra finally ends the conversation on sleeping arrangements.
After they fill the refuel with food and drink, Casta continues their tour around the building with much more vigour than before and asking questions about Glimmer and Bow. By the time the tour is completed they end back up in the dining room for dinner. Not that the pair are complaining. Nothing wrong with a free feed. Eventually, Casta shows them a few rooms for the pair to choose from and then leave them to it.
The room that they choose has one bed and an attached bathroom as well as a balcony that overlooks the gardens. In the attached bathroom is one very large bathtub. Even though Catra is not fond of water, she can’t resist being so close to Adora in the tub and thus joins the blonde when Adora suggestive calls to her. The end up soaking in the tub until the water is no longer warm enough to be comfortable. Catra watches closely as Adora towels off and then heads to their bed, foregoing her clothes in the act. Catra follows her out, towelling off and then draping a fresh dry towel across her shoulders as she approaches the bed where Adora is laying on her stomach. The dark ink lines of the map cover the blonde’s body from her collar bones down to her toes. Catra smirks at her work as she takes it all in. She leans in and runs her claws gently over the lines of the map on Adora’s body.
“Know where it is?” Adora asks as she feels Catra’s claw moving

across her body.
“Mm.” Catra replies noncommittedly, “Turn over?”
Slowly, Adora turns onto her back, her arms by her side and her legs crossed at the ankles, “Like this?”
“Yeah.” The answer from the magicat is breathless, “Much better.”
“Hey! Are you even looking at the map?” Adora snorts as Catra’s eyes snap up to the blonde’s.
“I am.” Catra replies with a grin, “Am I not allowed to appreciate the beauty in front of me though?”
Catra twitches as she feels Adora’s fingers running up her torso, “Mm… only if I get to do the same to you.”
Catra leans down, close enough to feel Adora’s breath on her lips, “I know where we are going next.”
Adora lifts her head, trying to capture Catra’s lips but the magicat smoothly moves away with a laugh, “Tell me.”
“This is the home of the dragons.” Catra answers as she presses a quick kiss on Adora’s lips, “The place is called Draco. And it’s not just dragons, it’s also hydras as well.”
“How do you know all this?” Adora asks as she wraps her arms around the magicat.
“I was abandoned there as a child.” Catra replies, “I never thought I’d have to go there ever again.”
“We don’t have to go, if you don’t want to.” Adora rubs Catra’s back soothingly, “No one can see the map under my clothes…”
“That’s not the point, Adora.” Catra rolls her eyes at Adora, “We need to finish this.”
“But how?” Adora drops her head back onto the pillow, “What is the end goal?”
“The end goal is to stop these monsters from terrorising you.” Catra reminds the blonde, “And they won’t stop until the map is completed.”
“But I’ve already got the sword.”
“Yeah, now you have to work out how to use it.” Catra sighs, “We need to get you trained up enough to face whatever is coming next.”
“Well, you’re gonna have to help me then.” The magicat looks down at the ink lines over Adora’s collarbones, “Will you? Help me?”

“Well, duh, princess.” Catra chuckles into Adora’s neck, “I’m going to be right there next to you when we face whatever comes our way in Draco. You can count on it.”

Chapter End Notes

one more chapter to go!
Thanks for reading!

Mastering She-Ra

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora get off Mystacor and return to some old friends

Chapter Notes

I've extended the chapter count to 14 instead of 12.
Enjoy this chapter though and I'll have the next one out next week :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The exit window for the pair to leave Mystacor is indeed very short and as such the pair have to spend at least another 2 weeks in the cloud city. Catra spends that time sparring and training with Adora, teaching her the limited amount of sword fighting expertise she has. It's been lucky that Castaspella is actually royalty, just like Glimmer. As such, Adora has access to the best sword fighters in the cloud city. Catra doesn't join Adora when she trains with Castaspella's guards, but instead climbs the trees and scales the walls of the castle just so she can watch the blonde train without Adora seeing her. Adora is a quick study. Easily learning the techniques and different styles the guards bring, she also becomes more tactically better in fending off attacks and finding openings for her own attacks. It brings a smile to Catra's face everyday Adora trains with the guards. Towards the end of the end 2 weeks, Adora is better than most of the guards with a sword.
"Hey Adora." Catra greets as Adora walks back into their room, still sweaty from training, "How are you feeling?"
Adora beams back at Catra, "So good!" The blonde rushes over and hugs Catra, as the magicat groans at being sweated on, "I beat most of the guards today."
"Congratulations!" Catra grins as she pulls away from the blonde, patting down the sweat transferred to her clothes, "You've gotten

a lot better with that thing."
Adora holds her sword out proudly, grinning back at Catra, "You were watching, weren't you?" Catra doesn't answer as the magicat suddenly finds the ceiling more interesting, "Where were you hiding this time?" Adora whines as she pushes lightly at the magicat.
"I'm not telling you my hiding spots." Catra replies mischievously, "If I did, I won't have anywhere to get some peace."
"You are the worst." There's no bite in the comment as Adora rolls her eyes, "I'm going to take a shower."
"Mmm…" Catra grins as she watches Adora undress in the room, revealing the ink all over her body as she heads to the bathroom, "You keep doing that…" The magicat picks up Adora's top and swings it around her finger, "and I won't be able to control myself…"
Adora raises an eyebrow as she struts with more confidence towards the bathroom now that she's picked up a fresh towel, "Is that so?"
Catra growls playfully, showing Adora her fangs before getting onto all fours and prowling slowly towards the blonde, "Very much so…"
Adora giggles as Catra chases her into the bathroom and they shut the door behind them.

"Are you ready?" Catra holds her hand out to Adora as they once again stand on the edge of a cliff and look down through the clouds, "It should be easy this time. I think."
Adora nudges Catra with a grin, "Of course. At least we know where we are landing this time."
Catra nods as Adora intertwines their fingers and they step off the edge.

"Adora! Catra!" Bow jumps up, surprised that the pair have returned to Bates, enveloping the in a big hug, "I can't believe you guys are here!"
Adora wipes a few tears from her eyes, "We had to come back."
Catra takes a step back as Adora and Bow start chatting and catching up while the magicat wonders into the other room and finds Glimmer sitting in a chair and reading a book, "Hey

Sparkles.”
Glimmer looks up, stunned to see Catra, “What are you doing here?”
Before Catra can answer, Adora and Bow burst through the door. Adora running straight to Glimmer and giving her the biggest hug.
“Glimmer!” Adora beams, “Look! “
Adora pulls the sword out, removes it from the sheath and shows it to Glimmer, “Is that what I think it is?” Adora nods, the smile plastered on her face as she watches Glimmer look over it, “What happened?”
“We were attacked by giant spiders before we got to your aunts place.” Catra explains as she sits down on the edge of the bed in Glimmer and Bow’s room, “Did you know there were spiders in Mystacor?”
Glimmer shakes her head, “No. Aunt Casta never mentioned anything about spiders.”
“Figures.” Catra mumbles under her breath, “Anyways, Adora here trips over the sword while we are trying not to get killed by these huge spiders.” Adora rolls her eyes at Catra recount of their first day at Mystacor, “Anyways, she trips over the sword and then realises that it is actually a sword and then goes to pick it up. And in a flash, she turns into this huge muscle-bound woman with a tiara and takes out all the spiders.”
“…She-Ra…” Bow says softly from behind them.
“What was that?” Adora turns around to him.
He clears his throat, “I said, She-Ra.” The other 3 look at Bow in confusion as she sighs like they should know what he is talking about, “Seriously guys?! How can you not know about She-Ra?”
Catra shrugs, running her hand through her short hair, “What the hell is She-Ra?”
Bow’s eyebrows furrow, “She-Ra is the savior of the world, duh!” He points to the sword, “I thought it was a myth or a legend, but if what you are saying is true… this sword is the key to Adora becoming She-Ra.”
“What? Why me?” Adora sounds almost angry, “I don’t want to be the savior of the world!”
“Sorry princess, but I don’t think you’ve got a choice.” Catra gets up and wraps her arms around the blonde, “But, I’ll be right

beside you, no matter what."
Adora leans back into Catra's arms, "I know."
"You two are sickening." Glimmer sticks her tongue out in discuss, "I don't even want to know what you guys got up to in Mystacor."
Catra just grins while Adora turns red as she tries to hide her blush by turning around and nestling her face into Catra's neck.
"Anyways…" Bow interrupts, "Where are we going next?"
"We?" Catra repeats looking over at Glimmer, who's leg is still in a cast, "What we?"
"The 4 of us, of course." Bow smiles, "Where's the next destination? Can I see the map?"
"No!" Adora almost shouts, "I mean, no." she corrects a little softer, "I, uh…"
"Draco." Catra answers, "You can't look at the map or I'll claw your eyes out."
Bow puts his hands up in surrender and steps back, "Draco huh?"
"Isn't that the land of the dragons or something?" Glimmer pipes up.
"Yeah. Also, only Adora and I will be going. You two are staying here." Catra looks between Bow and Glimmer.
"Pfft, just get She-Ra to heal Glimmer's leg and we can all go." Bow suggests like they all should know this, he looks at Adora, "You can do that, right?"
"Uh… yeah, no. I don't even know where to start with that." Adora answers awkwardly, feeling a little guilty that she doesn't know how to do it, "I can't even transform on cue."
Adora groans as she sits back down on the bed as Catra takes the sword from Glimmer and holds it out to Adora, "Well, no time like the present to start trying, princess."
The blonde smiles at Catra as she takes the sword and holds it in her right hand. "Okay. Uh, stand back." Catra and Bow take a few steps back while Glimmer remains where she is. Adora clears her throat, "For the honour of Grayskull!"
Nothing.
"Uh, is something supposed to happen?" Bow stage whispers to Catra which earns him an elbow to the ribs, "Ow!"
Adora takes a deep breath and tries again, "For the honour of Grayskull!" Again nothing, "Why is this not working?"

Catra steps forward as Adora shakes the sword around in her hand like it will reset it or something, “Hey.” The magicat hands gently rest of Adora’s shoulder, “Just relax. Close your eyes and take a few deep breaths.” Adora does what she’s told and after 3 deep breathes she opens her eyes, “Better?”
Adora nods with an appreciative smile, “Thank you.”
“You got this.” Catra reassures her, “I know you can do this.”
To emphasize her point, Catra leans in and places a soft kiss on Adora’s cheek, making the blonde grin as she tries to capture the magicat’s lips, “No good luck kiss?”
Catra rolls her eyes, “Fine. One kiss.”
They lean in, Catra’s lips soft on Adora’s as Glimmer groans in the background but the pair ignore her. Adora leans her forehead on Catra’s and breathes out a “Wow.”
Catra pulls away grinning, “Okay. Now try.”
The magicat moves back so she’s standing next to Bow as Adora lifts the sword up with a newfound confidence, “For the honour of Grayskull!”
A bright flash of light and some a gust of wind sweeps through the room as Glimmer and Bow’s eyes widen, seeing Adora change into She-Ra.
“Holy shit!” Glimmer squeals, “You did it! I can’t believe you’re She-Ra!”
She-Ra smiles back at Glimmer, “Yeah, it’s weird, huh?”
“Oh my stars! This is amazing!” Bow runs up to She-Ra, “I can’t believe that worked!”
Glimmer gets up onto her good leg and starts hopping towards She-Ra, “Okay, cool. Now heal my leg!”
“Woah, Glimmer!” She-Ra puts her hands up, “I don’t even know how to do that. I just managed to turn into She-Ra.”
“Oh, come on! You can do it.” Glimmer chides.
“You can do it!” Bow cheers on.
“Are you guys nuts?” Catra pushes Glimmer to sit down onto the bed, “She only just managed to turn into She-Ra and now you want her to somehow fix your leg?”
Glimmer raises and eyebrow at Catra before answering, “Yeah. Why not?”
“Did you…?” Catra runs her hands down her face in frustration as

she feels She-Ra come up behind her and place a reassuring hand on the magicat's shoulder, "Okay, fine. Do you have any idea how she does that? Heal your leg, Sparkles?"
Glimmers shakes her head no. Bow steps up with a bright smile on his face, "I think I have an idea!"
After a few hours and a lot of yelling from Bow shouting, "Sword Safety!", She-Ra finally gets the hang of, well, being She-Ra. Glimmers leg is healed and multiple items of furniture is broken as well as a few holes in the walls, but the 4 of them are finally ready to head to Draco.
Glimmer stands up tall, bouncing around on her now healed leg, "Wow. My leg has never felt so good!"
Catra rolls her eyes and then looks back to She-Ra, "Reckon I can get my Adora back now?"
She-Ra smiles lovingly at Catra before reverting back to Adora. Catra sighs as she pulls the blonde into her, "Better?"
"Much."
"Okay, if you 2 are done being…whatever, can we go?" Glimmer interrupts, "Besides I am so sick of this place."
Bow laughs as he wraps Glimmer up in his arms and gives her the sloppiest kiss on the cheek making Glimmer groan good-naturedly, "Okay, let's go!"

"Oh my stars! You still have the horses!" Adora runs towards Melog and Swift Wind, before she starts cooing and hugging and patting them lovingly, "How are you guys?"
Glimmer laughs at Adora's reaction to the horses, "It's only been 2 weeks and you're acting like you haven't seen them in a year."
Adora sticks her tongue out at Glimmer as Catra chuckles behind them. Bow starts loading whatever stuff they have onto the horses and helps Glimmer on top of one. Catra walks up to Adora and pats Melog's nose, "Hey buddy, miss us?"
Melog moves his head around like he's nodding, Catra and Adora both laugh as Glimmer rolls her eyes with a grin, "Come on! Let's go already!"
"Calm down Sparkles." Catra chuckles as she turns to Adora, "Do you want to get on Swift Wind?"
Adora nods enthusiastically, Catra helps her up onto the horse and

they begin their journey towards Draco. Bow and Catra walk next to their partners in between the horses in a comfortable silence. Adora was busy talking to Swift Wind, complementing the horse on his perfect mane and how steady and strong he walked with her on his back. Catra smiled listening to the blonde mindless chat with the horse while Glimmer and Bow talked about what they were going to do when they got back to Bright Moon. Catra snuck glances at the blonde as they walked, not paying attention to what was up ahead. All of a sudden, the horses came to a sudden stop. Catra's ears twitched.
Adora noticed the slight movement in Catra's ears, "What is it?"
Catra held her hand up as she moved forward towards the noise. There was no movement up ahead that she could see, the noise was a constant though. Catra sniffed the air trying to get a confirmation of what could be out there, but still, nothing. The trio behind Catra remained quiet, waiting for the magicat to give them the go ahead. Adora grips the handle of her sword as she watches Catra prowl up ahead cautiously.
"Stay back." Catra orders, just loud enough for her group to hear her, "There's something here…"
The ground begins to move in front of where Catra stands and before she can make a move, the magicat is sucked underground.
"Catra!" Adora shouts as she jumps off Swift Wind and runs towards the hole where Catra has been taken, "Catra! Fuck! Guys, help me dig!"
Bow and Glimmer run across and start digging at the ground with their bare hands frantically, Adora continues to shout into the hole, "Catra! We're coming! Just hang on!"
With all their frantic digging they don't even hear Catra's grunts as the magicat claws her way out from the hole, "Fuck!" Catra groans as she reaches her hand up towards the light.
"Catra!" Adora catches Catra's arm by the wrist and starts pulling the magicat up, "Guys, help me pull her up!"
Bow and Glimmer abandon the spot they were digging at and go to Adora's side and try to grab onto Catra's arm. Catra grunts and growls, "Something's got my leg!"
"Pull her out!" Adora shouts louder, "Hold on Catra!"
Catra shakes and legs her legs as hard as she can, grunting when

she feels sharp pains radiating up her legs, "Fuck!" Catra's claws come out and she with her free arm she starts slashing at her legs until she feels whatever is stabbing into her legs let go, "Pull me up!"
With one final heave, the trio manage to pull Catra up and out of the hole. Adora pulls her as far as possible from the hole, holding her close to her chest as Catra growls in pain.
"Catra! Shit! Your legs!" Adora shouts as Glimmer and Bow run back to their horses to grab the first aid kit.
"I'm fine, Adora." Catra winces in pain but tries to smile back at the blonde, "It's not as bad as it looks…"
Adora takes a good look at the wounds on Catra's legs, it's bad. The magicat legs are torn and ripped up, flesh is coming off the bone, Adora can actually see the bones in Catra's legs where she's been injured, bloody and stringy. "You aren't fine, Catra!" Adora looks around frantically, "Bow! Get the sword!"
"What are you doing?" Catra's eyes start to flutter shut as she starts to turn pale, "I'm… fine…"
Bow runs over and hands the sword to Adora, "For the honour of Grayskull!"
She-Ra appears, cradling Catra in her arms, "No! Catra! Stay awake!"
Glimmer rushes over and starts putting pressure on Catra's legs, trying desperately to stop the bleeding while Bow works on ripping up more fabric to provide as dressing for Glimmer. Catra doesn't move or flinch as Glimmer applies dressing after dressing over her legs.
"Hey Adora." Catra rasps weakly, "I don't… I don't feel so… good…"
She-Ra brings Catra tight into her arms, "You'll be alright… I got you…" Tears fall from the princess' eyes, dropping onto Catra's cheeks as she pulls the magicat closer, "You can't die… I love you…"
Catra's eyes open slowly as she stares into She-Ra's, "You love me?"
"Yes!" She-Ra sobs as Catra tries to bring her arms up to embrace her, "Ever since the tower. When you saved me."
The words come out as a whisper into Catra's ears as a small

smile comes across Catra's face, "I love you, too. My… Adora."
The magicat's breaths become shallower and shallower the more Catra tries to move, "Then… fight."
"For you? Always." Catra softy agrees, her energy draining along with the blood leaving her body, "I'm… sorry. I don't…"
"Shh…" She-Ra shushes the magicat, holding her closer and kissing Catra's cheek, "Save it. I've got you."
She feels Catra's breath hitch, sounding like the magicat is having trouble breathing on her own, "Adora…?"
She-Ra pulls Catra into her chest, lifting her off the ground and a bright light engulfs them. Glimmer and Bow move back, squinting into the bright light to see what is happening. When the light fades, She-Ra is gone, reverting back to Adora as she holds tightly onto Catra. For a moment, everything is silent. The sound of the wind in the trees and the birds chirping the only sounds around.
"Argh…" Catra groans as the magicat opens her eyes and sees Adora and not She-Ra, "Am I dead?"
"No, you idiot!" Adora brings Catra into her for a very relieved kiss, "You almost died!"
"Ah… yeah…" Catra rubs the back of her neck sheepishly, "Sorry. I didn't mean to… you know."
Bow and Glimmer run over and the four of them collapse backwards into a big group hug, "Fucking hell! Don't do that again!" Glimmer scolds Catra.
Catra laughs as she starts removing the dressing from her legs, feeling that She-Ra's magic had healed the worst of it, "Sorry Sparkles. But no promises."
Adora huffs and shoves Catra before getting up and storming off.
"Adora?" Bow calls after her.
The blonde keeps walking towards their horses as Catra springs up and runs after her. "Hey!" Catra stops Adora by placing a hand on her shoulder, "Adora wait."
Adora stops but doesn't turn.
Catra sighs, "Look, I'm sorry. You know I don't go looking to get myself hurt or killed." Adora just huffs and crosses her arms, "But, you know that this trip is dangerous. We've been lucky a few times and unlucky at other times."
"You don't have to be the one to keep running into danger first."

Adora's voice is tense not angry, "You don't have to…"
Catra wraps her arms around the blonde from behind, her chin resting on Adora's shoulder, "I need to make sure that we are all safe. I'm the disposable one here." Catra's voice drops, "You… you're going to save the world. Sparkles and Bow are going to go back to Bright Moon, back to their worried families and me… well, what do I have? I live a life of solitude. I don't have anything to offer you."
"You have me." Adora turns around in Catra's arms, cupping her face as the magicat avoids her eyes, "You have to be here with me. Without you, there's no world worth saving."
"You mean that?" Catra asks unsure.
Adora nods profusely, "Catra… I love you. I need you. Without you… well, I don't want to think about that." Adora lifts Catra's chin up, "I just, I just can't lose you. So please, stop running head first into danger. We're a team. Let us help."
Catra sighs, "Fine. I guess I can stop doing that."
As Catra brings Adora in for a kiss, the ground shakes again. Adora pulls back, "What was that?"
"Reckon you can turn into the tall princess again?" Catra turns around and pushes Adora back behind her, "Think we might need her for whatever the fuck is underground."
The ground shakes again as Bow and Glimmer run back towards them, "Guys! Guys! Did you feel that?!" Bow shouts as he helps Glimmer up on the Melog before climbing up behind her, "What is that?!"
"That…" Catra begins to answer as Adora summons She-Ra behind her, "would be the thing that tried to eat me!"
"Oh…" Glimmer's expression worried, "What can we do?"
"Adora can take care of it." Catra turns around and She-Ra is standing in place of the smaller blonde, "Right?"
A smirk comes across She-Ra's face, "Definitely."
Without another word, She-Ra runs and dives into the hole they were digging at before and starts slashing at the creature underneath. Catra stands, leaning against Swift Wind casually, unconcerned as she inspects her claws waiting for She-Ra to return.
CRASH!

The creature that attacked Catra comes flying through the hole and crashes into several trees before coming to a stop with She-Ra flying out from the hold, sword in hand and raised. Walking confidently towards the creature with a smirk, She-Ra raises her sword and then points it to the creature, “You. Tried to kill Catra.”
Catra sprints over to She-Ra, “Woah! That was amazing!”
The creature does not move, still dazed from crashing through several trees as Catra walks towards it but the magicat is stopped by She-Ra, “Where do you think you are going?”
“I wanna see.” Catra grins, “You’ve got my back anyways, so what’s the problem?”
“Catra.” She-Ra’s voice is stern as she rolls her eyes at the magicat, “Remember our little talk?” Catra nods slowly, “Well, let me take care of this. Please?”
Catra sighs, “Fine.” Before she steps aside, “Just let me know if you need help.”
She-Ra snorts, “Yeah, I think I’ll be alright.” The smirk back on the blonde’s face, “Besides, I kicked it out of the hole, didn’t I?”
Catra shrugs, “Are you going to kill it?”
“I don’t know.” She-Ra replies moving cautiously towards the creature.
“Check it’s eyes.” Catra suggests as she scales a tree nearby to get a better view, “If it’s like the others, well, you’ll have to kill it. “Cos it won’t stop coming after you.”
“Us.” She-Ra corrected as she looked around for Catra, “Where are you?”
“Up here.” Catra answers, “Just in case.”
She-Ra makes her way over to the creature. And sure enough, it’s eyes glow like all the others they’ve faced together. And before she knows it, the creature gets up quickly, coming in for a second attack as She-Ra’s sword makes short work of it. Slicing it cleanly in two down the centre as Catra drops down from her perch on the branch directly above.
Catra steps up and inspects the dead creature as She-Ra reverts back to Adora, the blonde panting with her sword in her hand still bloody with the creature's innards. Catra turns around and walks towards the blonde, “Are you okay?”
Adora nods, her gaze locked on the creature she’d just killed,

“That was… intense.”
Catra chuckles, “Yeah. Good work.” The magicat grips Adora’s arm and leads her back to the others, “Come on. We need to get going.”
“Yeah…” Adora’s eyes still on the creature before she feels Catra drag her back to the main road and to their friends.
When they get back to Glimmer and Bow, Adora turns to Catra, “How do you do this?” Catra raises an eyebrow, unsure of what she is referring to, “How do you kill them and just, walk away?”
Catra looks down at her feet before answering, “I uh, it helps that I’m usually defending myself when I have to kill them.”
Adora nods.
“I don’t want to kill them, but… when it comes down to them or us, I will always choose us.” Catra adds, “I would lay my life down for you.”
“You nearly did already.” Adora huffs, “But, I can see why.”
“Yeah.” Catra replies, “It’s not so easy to kill when you aren’t being attacked. And I don’t plan to kill anything or anyone unless I have to. And neither should you.”
Nodding again, Adora steps forward and bring Catra in for a hug.
“Okay, lovebirds!” Glimmer groans, “Can we get going please?”
Adora giggles with a little bit of embarrassment, but takes a moment to kiss Catra lovingly as Glimmer groans again louder, “Like, now!”
The pair laugh as Adora mounts Swift Wind, while Catra limps beside her and they continue on to Draco. Adora pulls Catra up onto Swift Wind with her when she notices as Catra huffs at her.
"You are not walking on that." Adora scolds Catra, "Especially if we have horses that can do the work for you."
Catra wraps her arms around Adora's waist from behind and sighs in defeat, "You're right. We'll ride to Draco then. Only until my leg feels better."

Chapter End Notes

Land of the Dragons is the next chapter...
Thanks for reading and kudos!
If you have any comments, would love to read them too.

Caving

Chapter Summary

Getting deeper into the heart of Draco.

Chapter Notes

Second last chapter!!!
Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The trek to Draco isn't as bad as first thought. They trek through some nice, lush forests before they start to hit the rocky terrain. That's when they know they are close to where they need to be.
"Tell me again why we need to come here?" Glimmer asks, a hint of fear in her voice.
"It's so Adora can finish her quest." Bow answers squeezing Glimmer tighter in his arms, "Also so that these creatures stop attacking her."
"So… what do you think is in Draco?" Glimmer leans back into Bow's embrace on top of the horse.
"Probably a dragon." Catra cuts in before running ahead to assess the road, "Great… a fork in the road…"
"Can't you just check the map?" Glimmer points out as Adora turns red at the prospect of other people seeing the rest of her body apart from Catra, "Or… Catra can check the map. We can give you guys some privacy or whatever. Besides I think I need to stretch my legs."
Catra walks back to Swift Wind and holds her hand out so Adora can dismount and then leads them into the privacy of the woods. Adora stands awkwardly with her arms by her side unsure of what to do as Catra does a quick check to make sure no one was around or see them.
"Okay." Catra turns back to the blonde, "Turn around and lift up your shirt. I'm pretty sure this part of the map is on your back and trails around to… uh, your, um…"

Catra waves her hand around at Adora's breast, making the blonde giggle at the magicat, "You can say breast, you know?"
"Ugh! Fine. Breast." Catra rolls her eyes, "So… lift?"
Adora looks around before turning around and lifting her shirt slightly up, Catra takes the liberty to pull it up a little higher, tracing the ink lines with her finger as Adora shivers under the magicat's touch. Clearing her throat, Adora manages to ask, "Did you find it?"
Catra's eyes narrowed on a spot on her back as she traced it until she moved in front of the blonde and was carefully lifting up the front of her shirt to get a better look at the rest of the map. A wry grin appears on Catra's face when she pauses and looks up at a flushing Adora, "Yeah. Found it. We go left."
And with that, Catra drops Adora's shirt back down and holds her hand out again to lead them back to their companions. The blonde happily grabs hold of Catra's hand as they head back to Swift Wind.
"So? Which way?" Bow asks as Catra helps Adora get back on Swift Wind's back.
"Left." Catra replies as she grins up at Adora, "Come on, saddle up."
The other couple pull themselves back onto Melog and they travel left along the fork in the road, Catra walking alongside Adora and Swift Wind, keeping an eye and ear on their surroundings.

"Wow, did it just get really hot?" Bow wipes the sweat off his brow, "I feel like I'm roasting over here."
Catra breathes in, "Yeah, that's because we've now crossed over into Draco." The magicat looks around at their surroundings and then at their horses, "I think we'll need to leave Melog and Swift Wind here, for now."
"What? Why?" Glimmer protests, still on top of Melog.
Adora dismounts and pats Swift Wind on the nose, "Because Glimmer, they won't do well in this heat."
Reluctantly, Glimmer follows Bow and dismounts Melog, "How far is the walk?"
Catra shrugs, "No idea."
"What?!" Glimmer shouts, "What do you mean, no idea?"

“I mean exactly that, Sparkles.” Catra replies as she walks with Adora to lead Swift Wind back over the threshold and back to cooler grounds, “It’s not like anyone has mapped this area out.”
“But doesn’t Adora have the map on her?” Bow pipes up, “Somewhere on her body…”
Catra grins mischievously at the blonde who just covers her face and looks away. With a fang sticking out, the magicat replies, “Well, yes she does. But I don’t think it’s really appropriate right now for me to be between her thighs.”
“Catra!” Adora squeals making the magicat laugh, “Keep that up and you won’t be another near my thighs.”
Almost stopping immediately, Catra turns to the blonde stunned. The suddenness of Catra’s stoppage of laughter in turn make Bow and Glimmer crack up, laughing at the magicat pouting at Adora’s threat.
“Anyways…” Catra clears her throat, “Melog and Swift Wind should be safe here. I doubt anyone willingly comes to the edge of Draco for fun.”
Adora coos and gives a few more pets to both of the horses before reluctantly walking away from them. The two horses don’t seem to care much now that they are back on the cooler side of the path and are happily eating the grass and hiding in the shade.
Catra nudges the blonde playfully as she makes her way back to the group, “They’ll be alright.” Adora assures everyone.
Bow sends her a thankful look and a small smile to try and cheer the blonde up, whereas Glimmer puts her arm around Adora’s shoulder’s and pulls her into herself, “Yeah, they get to stay cool. Whereas we get to die in this heat!”
Adora laughs, thankful for Glimmer trying to make her feel better. They watch as Catra walks ahead as per usual, the heat doesn’t seem to be getting to the magicat as much. The others however have shed all non-modesty layers. Bow’s eyes widen upon seeing the intricate ink markings on Adora’s back and what is exposed on her chest and thighs. “Woah…”
Catra stops and growls a little, knowing that her companions were now ogling Adora, “Touch her and you’ll lose your hand…”
The threat has Bow retract his hands to a safe distance behind his back as Adora rolls her eyes at Catra, “Catra, they are allowed to

look at the map." Another growl, "Fine! But do you really want me to overheat by covering up?"
The sad puppy dogs look she gives Catra breaks the magicat's resolve, "No." Catra replies through gritted teeth before turning to the pair, "You can look. But if either of you touch her, I swear…"
"Yeah, yeah!" Glimmer waves Catra's threat off, "You'll claw our eyes out or whatever. Trust me, Wildcat, we are only interested in touching each other."
"Gross." Catra sticks her tongue out.
"Like you two aren't?" Glimmer retorts, "You should be glad what we aren't as desperate as you two."
"Can we please not talk about this?" Bow pleads.
Adora nods in agreement, "Yes, please."
"Fine." Catra agrees, "As long as they don't touch you."
Adora grins as she pulls Catra in for a sweaty hug, "I think they are aware not to cross that line."
"Better be." The magicat cut rubs her cheek against Adora's sweaty face before pressing a soft kiss against it, "We better get going."
"Mmhm." Adora nods with a smile, "Yeah, the faster we take care of this, the faster I can be ink free."
Catra points up ahead towards a mountain up ahead, "See that?"
"Yeah…?" Bow answers.
"That's where we need to go." Catra looks back to her companions, "There's a cave on the other side. I'm pretty sure that's where we're going to find the mother of all those creatures."
"Reckon it'll be some big ass dragon?" Glimmer grins at Catra, earning her an eye roll from the magicat, "What? It has got to be something epic. Right?"
"For our sakes, I hope not." Catra answers flatly, "I would rather not die right at the end."
Adora squeezes Catra's hand, "You won't. You're not allowed to."
Catra tries to give Adora a reassuring smile, but all she can manage is half of a smile as she squeezes back, "Same to you too, you know."
"Pfft! I'm not going to die Catra!" Adora chuckles, "I've got this." She pulls out her sword, "Remember?"
"How can I forget?" Catra quirks an eyebrow back to the blonde,

“I mean, don’t get me wrong, the tall, muscly princess is hot… but I think I prefer my Adora better.”
“Your Adora, huh?” The blonde playfully bumps Catra’s shoulder, “Yeah, I like the sound of that.”
“Good.” Catra finally smiles back.
“So… no epic fight?” Glimmer drawls rolling her wrists, “Well, I guess it’s better than getting eaten alive.”
“Ha!” Catra says loudly, “Yeah, that was not a fun experience.” The magicat turns to Adora and puts a finger up, “Nope. Do not go there.”
Putting her hands up in surrender, “I wasn’t…”
“Sure, you weren’t.” Catra rolls her eyes as the blonde grins wickedly next to her.
“We have to go all the way up that mountain, huh?” Bow asks, changing the subject, “We better find a place to camp for the night. There is no way we’ll be able to get up and over that mountain today.”
Glimmer grabs his hand happily, “Yeah. That seems like a day’s walk, at least!”
Catra sighed, she knew they were right, but the end was also so close that she really didn’t want to stop. Adora laced her fingers in Catra’s, her hand sweaty from the heat and the exertion of walking in it, “Hey.” The blonde says softly to Catra, “It’ll be okay. We need to rest anyways if we want to be fresh and rested enough to take on whatever is waiting for us.”
“I know, I know.” Catra admits, “I just… really want to get this over with.”
“Me too.”
Catra turns to Glimmer and Bow, “We’ll set up camp once we find a suitable spot. We still have a few hours of daylight, so let’s get as far as we can before the light burns out.”
Glimmer groans but doesn’t argue, “Okay!” Bow enthusiastically agrees.
“Are you guys cool to keep going? Or do you need a break for a bit?” Adora asks as she watches Catra scout on up ahead, “I mean, it is pretty hot.”
“We’re probably good for another hour or so.” Bow replies, wiping the sweat off his forehead, “As long as we can find somewhere

that has drinkable water…"
"Yeah, there's no towns or villages in this place." Catra shouts back from ahead, "What do you think I'm doing?"
"Uh… I don't know. Checking out if there's any monsters up ahead or whatever." Glimmer shouts back, "Do you see any water?"
"No, not yet." Catra voice carries back a little weaker, "But I think I see some trees up ahead."
"Really? Trees?" Bow says incredulously before shouting back, "What kind of trees?"
"I don't fucking know! Just trees!" Catra shouts back feeling irritated, "It'll be a shit lot cooler under these trees than not."
Catra comes back, re-joining the group, "Besides if there's trees, then there should be water or something around."
"How far up ahead is it? Adora asks, brushing a few stray hairs off of Catra's face.
"Probably an hour's walk."
"Yeah, okay." Adora replies, "Lead the way."
Catra beams at Adora as she takes the blonde's hand into hers and starts leading them towards the trees, "Come on, then."
They follow Catra up the trail she's already scouted and it's not long before they spot the trees the magicat had told them about before. Glimmer lets off a relieved sigh at the sight but at the same time she groans at how far it still is. Bow does his best to keep her spirits up as Catra just laughs up ahead at the pair.

The arrive at the trees and Glimmer and Bow both flop down on their backs under the shade of the trees. Catra rolls her eyes at them as Adora leans against a tree close to them and slides down to sit against it. Catra places a hand on the blonde's shoulder, "Are you alright?"
"I'm so fucking tired!" Glimmer shouts loudly, "Where's the water!?"
"I don't fucking know, Sparkles." Catra replies in a more calmly manner, "Don't you guys still have a water on you?"
"No!" Glimmer groans back, "We drank it all on the hike up here!"
"For fucks sake." Catra sighs as she pulls out her water bottle and throws it towards the pair lying prone on their backs, "Take it."
"Thank you." Glimmer sits up and grabs the bottle, greedily

gulping down a quarter of the contents before passing it to Bow, who takes a few sips and then throws it back to Catra.
"Yeah, whatever." Catra catches the bottle and offers it to Adora, "Here. Have the rest, princess."
"Are you sure? What about you?" Adora hesitantly takes the bottle from Catra, "Have some first."
"I'm alright." Catra pushes the bottle back to Adora, "Just drink it, will you. Please."
"No. not until you have a sip." Adora insists, pushing the bottle back to Catra with a stern look on her face, "And don't tell me you're alright. Your lips are dry and cracked."
Sighing, the magicat takes the bottle and takes a drink before handing it back to Adora, "Happy?"
"Yes." Adora tips the rest of the contents into her mouth, "We better find water."
"I'm on it." Catra tells her, "Just give me a few minutes."
"Okay." Adora softly replies as Catra goes to sit down next to the blonde. Adora's hand moving up to gentle pet Catra's ears as the magicat leans her head on the blonde's shoulder, "You need a break. Sleep. I'll wake you up in 15 minutes."
"No. No sleeping." Catra replies with a yawn, "I'm not tired."
Pressing a soft kiss on the side of Catra's temple as the magicat's leans the weight of her head on Adora's shoulder and purring lightly. Bow's eyebrows shoot up upon hearing Catra's purr as Adora shushed him and gestured from him to not make a big deal out of it. Glimmer and Bow chat lazily back and forth with each other as they rested beneath the trees. They were still on their backs and star-fished out, talking about all the things they'd eat and drink when the got home. Adora smiled at their chatter and rested her head on top of Catra's.

As promised, Adora gently wakes Catra up after the magicat has gotten 15 minutes of rest. The blonde giggled when Catra playfully nipped at Adora's neck when she woke up a little disorientated and not completely aware that they were not in the privacy of a room. Bow decided to go with Catra to search for water while Glimmer and Adora foraged whatever they could to make camp for the night.

“So… what are you going to do once this is over?” Bow asks to break the silence they’ve been trekking around in.
“I don’t know.” Catra replies honestly, “We’ll see if we survive this before we start making plans.”
“Uh huh…” Bow chuckles nervously, “But, what would you like to do, when this is all over?”
“Lock Adora and myself in a room and not come out until we need to eat or drink.” Catra replies plainly making Bow choke on his tongue. The magicat turns back and pats him on the back, “Are you okay, there? I’d give you water, but we got none. Hence why we’re on this trek.”
“No… I’m good.” Bow wheezed, still coughing a little.
Catra nods like what she just said was just part of normal conversation. When she sees him recover enough, she flashes him a grin, “What about you and Sparkles?”
“We can’t wait to get back.” Bow smiles, “You know, you and Adora should come back with us.”
“Why?”
“Because it’s what friends do.” Bow replies like it’s obvious, “Besides, I’m sure Glimmer will be able to get you guys a room, far away so we can’t hear you once you lock that door.”
He sends her a smirk and Catra laughs outright, patting him on the back, “I’ll ask Adora when this is all over. I’m sure she wouldn’t mind being in a castle.”
“Well… you know, since she is also She-Ra…” Bow rubs the back of his neck, “It kind of makes her a real princess.”
“She is a princess.” Catra repeat, not really understanding what Bow is saying, “To me anyways.”
“I know you’re going to hate me saying this…” Bow beams, “But you guys are like, the cutest.”
Catra shoves him, “Don’t call me cute.”
“Okay okay, sorry. But I had to tell you at least once.” Bow chuckles as they continue walking, “Do you think Glimmer and I are cute?”
“I am not going to answer that.” Catra tells him, “Besides, since you guys are married or whatever, does that automatically make you into a prince or something?”
Bow shrugs, “Yeah, I don’t think we’ve really talked about that. I

think my actual title is consort or something. Pretty sure it's not prince."
Catra nods, "So… not a prince?"
To the magicat's surprise, Bow bursts out laughing, "No. I don't want to be known as a prince either. I'd rather just be known as Bow. Or Sir Bow."
"Sir Bow?" Catra smirks, "Suits you."
"Thanks!"
"Yeah, don't mention it." Catra waves him off before sniffing the air and prowling around the rocks a little further ahead, "I think I smell something."
Bow jogs over to where Catra is, "What do you smell?"
"Water."
"Where?" Bow asks looking around, "I don't see anything."
Catra starts sniffing the rocks and then the dirt under her feet, her tail flicks side to side as her senses pick up on water, "Under here."
Pointing down at the spot where Catra can smell water and points to the spot with his finger, the magicat just nods. Still down on all fours, Catra begins to dig, flinging dirt over at Bow who turns his head, spitting out the dirt. He's about to say something but then thinks twice before moving to a different spot where he's not going to get flung with dirt.
"It's cool here." Catra says, resting her palm in the hole she's dug, "There's definitely water under here."
She continues to dig as Bow stands around awkwardly, unsure of what he's supposed to do. He doesn't have a shovel or anything and Catra is currently doing a fantastic job getting to the source of the water.
"Fine anything?" Bow asks, fidgeting with his arrows.
"Nearly." Catra grunts before she smiles, stepping out of the hole she just dug, "Ta da!"
"No way!" Bow looks into the hole excited, dropping down to his knees before Catra stops him.
"Woah, hang on there. You can't just drink this." Catra pushes him back, he lands on his bum, "You'll get sick."
Bow nods in acknowledgement sheepishly at how foolish he was being, "Sorry. I guess my thirst got the better of me."

Catra grins at him and he smiles back, "Well, help me dig a little more and then we can collect it. We'll need to find a way to filter it, might as well do it up here than lug a heap of water back to camp that we won't be able to drink anyways."
They quickly get to work and by the time they've collected enough water, they start to head back to their camp. The sun is starting to set, a cool breeze starts to blow, cooling off the pair. Catra leads them both back to the camp as fast as possible before all the light disappears, she hopes Adora has at least set a fire so they can find their way back in case it gets too dark. And by the stars, she has.
"Hey! We're back!" Bow greets to Glimmer running and hugging him, "And… we have water!"
"Great!" Glimmer cheers, "We managed to catch some dinner as well. It's not much, but it's something!"
Adora beams back at Catra, "Yeah, so now we have something to drink and eat." She gestures to the fire and sure enough, their dinner is cooking away, "Come on, I could use some water."
The spent the night under the stars, the camp fire burning bright for a few hours before it finally went out close to dawn. And when the sun came up, with a little bit of groaning they got back on the path up the mountain.

They'd managed to travel up the mountain in fairly quick time now they had a good night's rest, hydrated and had something to eat. It even surprised Catra that they hadn't come across any creatures on the way up.
"Just a little further, guys." Catra tells them, "We're nearly at the cave."
"Thank goodness!" Bow sighs, "I thought we'd have another day of walking uphill."
The sun was now directly over them and the heat was getting unbearable. Catra looked up at the track and then at her weary companions before stopping, "Okay, take a break guys."
"Really?" Glimmer asks surprised, "You actually want to stop?"
"Well, no." Catra admits with a shrug, "But if we keep going, the three of you are going to tumble back down the hill and then I'd have to carry your sorry asses back up the hill. And I really don't

want to do that."
"Not even for me?" Adora teases.
"Not you, princess." Catra rolls her eyes, "I'd make sure you didn't fall in the first place."
A smirk comes across Catra's face as Adora grins back, "Well, I do like when you put your arms around me…"
"Fuck! Where are all trees?" Glimmer groans as she wipes the sweat off her face and neck, "There's like no shade at all!"
Catra doesn't say anything, instead she just points. The trio look at where she's pointing and without a work, make their way over in haste. Catra had spotted the cave a while back on the walk up, so now was the best opportunity for them to cool off in the hottest part of the day. She figured she'd already worked them pretty hard since the morning and they'd probably lost a lot of fluid from sweating up the climb.
"We'll stay here for a bit, until the sun backs off a little." Catra says as she drops down against the rocky wall of the cave next to Adora, "You guys rest for a bit, I'll keep watch."
"Catra!" Adora whines, "I'm staying up with you. Stop trying to be a hero."
"I'm not a hero Adora. You are." Catra jokes, it falls flat and so does her ears, "Okay, fine. We'll take first watch, okay?"
Adora nods as she watches Glimmer and Bow take a few sips of water before cuddling up together on the cool floor of the cave and promptly falling asleep.
"Hey." Adora nudges Catra, who's running her hand through her hair, "How long should we give them?"
Catra eyes the pair and sighs, "An hour."
"Yeah. What do you want to do for an hour?" Adora asks with a sly look in her eyes.
Catra laughs softly and wraps her arm around Adora's shoulder, "Not that. It's too hot and sweaty to get… well hot and sweaty."
The giggle that escapes from Adora's mouth, makes Catra want to kiss Adora. So, she does.
"What was that for? I thought we weren't going to get hot and sweaty right now." Adora grins cheekily as she kisses Catra's cheek again.
"We're not." Catra says in between kisses, "I just want to do this."

“Okay.” Adora agrees and lets Catra cup her cheeks and deepens the kiss, “Mm… I can’t wait until this is over…”
Catra pulls Adora into her lap and presses soft kisses along Adora’s neck, “Me too.” She whispers back. Adora gives off a satisfied hum as Catra remembers her conversation with Bow yesterday, “Hey, how do you feel about going with those two chuckleheads back to Bright Moon once this is all over?”
“Hm?” Adora turns enough so she can see Catra’s eyes, “What do you mean? What would we do in Bright Moon?”
“Bow kind of offered as a place to stay in Bright Moon.” Catra tells the blonde with a smile, “In the palace.”
“Oh really?” Adora leans back into Catra, rubbing her face against the magicat’s cheek, “And… what would we do in Bright Moon?”
“Well, Bow also mentioned to get us a room far enough and private enough…” Catra trailed off into those thoughts before Adora’s giggle brings her back, “Sorry, where was I?”
“Something about a room being far enough…?” Adora reminds the magicat.
“Oh right.” Catra leans into Adora’s neck again, brushing her fangs against the blonde’s skin, “Well, we’d be far away enough for you to be as loud as you want.”
Adora whimpers at the thought, “And they wouldn’t mind?”
Catra chuckles, “No. Bow said that’s what friends do. Not so much the private room stuff, but like visiting each other and stuff.”
“I like it.” Adora declares, “Let’s go to Bright Moon then.”
Catra presses a kiss to the top of Adora’s head, “Don’t you fall asleep on me, princess.”
“Mm…not…” Adora yawns and Catra rolls her eyes, “Just, resting my eyes.”
Catra laughs, “Sleep Adora. You need it.”
“So do you…” Adora replies sleepily, “I can stay awake…”
Adora falls asleep in Catra’s arms.

“Wake up!” Catra shouts, startling the 3 humans, “Time to move out!”
“Catra!” Glimmer curses, “Do you have to be so fucking loud!?”
“Yes.” Catra replies softer, “We need to get going. So, get your asses up now and let’s get going!”

“How are you so… awake?” Bow rubs his eyes as he watches Catra help Adora up, “It’s just not natural.”
“I’m a hybrid.” Catra deadpans, “Besides, you guys need to up your hiking game.”
Glimmer and Bow both groan as they push themselves up slowly, Adora has a soft smile on her face as she looks at the magicat, “Hey. Did you get any rest?”
“No. I don’t need it. We only came in here so we didn’t roast under the sun.” Catra replies, “I’m good. Really.”
“Okay. But the moment I see you even a little bit tired, we’re stopping.” Adora warns the magicat, who nods in agreement, “Okay, it seems a little cooler out now.”
Catra leads them back out and they continue on up the rest of the mountain. When they get to the top, they all stop and take in the view.
“This is so amazing.” Catra hears Glimmer tell Bow, “Look how high up we are!”
Adora takes Catra’s hand, “She’s right, you know.”
“About?”
“The view.” Adora looks out at the scenery surrounding them. Catra just stares at the blonde with a grin, “Yeah, I know. I could look at it all day.”
Adora turns back to Catra with a blush, “Shut up!”
Catra cackles as they both turn back to the views. Letting go of Adora’s hand, Catra moves a little further down hill and sees the cave.
“We need to get there.” Catra points out to her fellow companions, “Come on.”
Catra waves the trio forward, keeping them a safe distance behind her as the begin to descend down to the cave. Once they get to the cave, the magicat signals for them to hide in the shrubs and trees around the cave as a precaution as she takes a quick look inside, much to Adora’s displeasure. Catra had to persuade Adora to stand down and not to turn into She-Ra yet as she’d like to keep that card up her sleeve until the time was right. The blonde reluctantly agrees and goes to hide with their friends.
Creeping along the side of the cave wall, Catra’s eyes glow as she looks inside, trying to see if there was anything inside. She moves

slowly and calculated, keeping her breathing under wraps and has her other senses on high alert as she ventures deeper into the cave. There's a drop off point on the edge of the cave, there's nothing but darkness down there, but her ears pick up movement. It sounds like wings. Big wings. Catra picks up a rock, looks over the edge and then calmly tosses it down the hole. She hears the rock ricocheting off the cave walls below until it can't be heard anymore. But then something else makes a noise.
"Oh shit…" Catra mumbles under her breath as she starts backing out of the cave as quietly as possible. There's a low growl coming from deep inside the cave as Catra continues to get the fuck out of there. Eventually she sees daylight from the entrance of the cave and her body feels a sense of relief. She steps out into the sunlight and runs to where her friends are hiding.
"What? What did you see?" Glimmer asks Catra loudly.
"I'm not sure…" Catra responds looking very shaken, "But whatever it is, it's fucking huge."
"That's not good…" Bow's voice full of nerves, "That's not good at all."
"No. But I believe it's a…" Before Catra can even finish that sentence, a large fire stream pushes out of the cave and then with a few loud footsteps the biggest creature any of them have ever seen makes itself seen.
"Is that a…?" Adora asks, her jaw drops as she gets a good look at the creature.
"Yeah." Catra answers, "That, would be the epic creature that I didn't want to face."
"It's a fucking dragon!" Glimmer whisper shouts at the magicat, "A really fucking huge dragon!"
Catra swallows hard as she turns back to her friends, "Yep, it sure is. Now, we are officially fucked."

Chapter End Notes

Thanks for reading, kudos and any comments anyone wants to drop.
One more chapter to go, the big old finale!

Final Battle

Chapter Summary

Battle of the dragons.

Chapter Notes

Last chapter!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Fuck!” Glimmer screams as she ducks behind a large rock and out of the way of the fireball heading towards her, “Why is it trying to kill just me?”
“Don’t know, Sparkles!” Catra shouts from the other side with Bow and Adora as they watch the dragon fly overhead towards Glimmer, “But good work keeping it away from us!”
Glimmer groans, “Do something!” the sparkly princess shouts back, “I don’t want to be burnt to a crisp!”
“Okay, okay!” Catra yells as she picks up a couple of rocks and starts throwing them towards the dragon, “Hey!!! Over here!”
Catra turns to Bow and Adora, “Uh, you guys should probably split. It’ll be harder for it to come after all of us at the same time.”
Bow and Adora both nod. Bow runs off towards Glimmer, while Adora runs in the opposite direction as the dragon focuses in on Catra. The magicat stays where she is, waiting for the right time to leap out of the way as she watches the dragon turn around and head her way.
“For the Honour of Grayskull!” Adora can be heard yelling from near the cave, before a bright flash of light takes over and the girl is transformed into She-Ra. “Come get me, dragon!”
“Adora!” Catra yells as she sprints towards the blonde, “Get away from the cave!”
She-Ra stands her ground as the dragon breathes out a fire towards the blonde which is quickly blocked by her sword as she grunts to make sure it doesn’t get through. The dragon circles around as She-Ra follows suit, keeping the dragon in front of her.

Catra is almost at the cave where She-Ra is standing and fighting, when she senses another presence.
"Watch out!" Bow screams from where he has met up with Glimmer on the far side of the rocks, "Dragons!"
Catra turns around, and sure enough there are another 2 dragons emerging from the cave directly behind her and She-Ra, "Fuck! We have to move. Now!" Catra shouts to She-Ra as they get the hell out of area, She-Ra blocking their fire balls with her sword until they get some space between them. They jump behind some large rocks out of breath, "Are you good?"
"Yeah. You?" She-Ra asks back.
"Yeah, for now." Catra replies as Bow and Glimmer join them in the relative safety behind the rocks, "You guys good?"
"No!" Bow shouts before covering his mouth at making so much noise, resorting to just shaking his head.
"We're fine." Glimmer responds, hands on her knees as she tries to catch her breath, "What do we do now?"
"I don't know. How do you kill a dragon?" Catra shrugs.
"Do we have to kill the dragons?" She-Ra asks, leaning back against the rock and occasionally peeking over to see where the dragons are, "I mean, it is their territory, after all."
"What are you saying?" Glimmer looks up in shock, "That we should just walk away?"
She-Ra peeks over again, "I don't know. Yes? Maybe?" She looks to Catra pleadingly, "What do you think?"
Catra sinks back against the rock, still catching her breath, "I don't know, honestly. They aren't like the creatures we've faced so far. If anything, these dragons don't seem to be attacking like the others and their eyes are clear." Catra peaks over catching a glimpse of the dragons as they pace around the entrance of the cave, "Maybe, it's not the dragons we are supposed to face."
"Then what?" Bow's voice shoots up an octave, "What else could it be?"
Catra breathes out, "I don't know. The map on Adora showed the cave, so I assumed that's where we are supposed to face the final whatever." The magicat eyes over She-Ra's inkless body, "Can you turn back, princess?"
"Woah! No way! We need She-Ra!" Glimmer protests, "What if

those dragons attack again?”
Catra’s ear flick as she peeks over again before she comes back and replies to Glimmer, “They aren’t. Look for yourself.”
Glimmer cautiously takes a peek, which turns into a long look before she comes back behind the rocks, “Okay. That’s weird.”
“I guess they were just defending their home.” Catra shrugs again, “I wouldn’t be too happy if someone just walked into my home and started shit.”
‘I guess….” Glimmer concedes, “So, what do we do now?”
Catra turns back to She-Ra, “Adora, can you turn back? I think there might be more to the map than just the cave.”
She-Ra nods and in a flash of light she transforms back to her smaller stature, giving Catra a shy smile when they catch each other’s glances, “Can we go somewhere private?”
“Of course.” Catra replies with a smile, “I would rather not have anyone else see you apart from my eyes.”
Glimmer rolls her eyes while Bow peeks back over at the dragons. He says, “They seem to be just playing around now.” He has a smile on his face, almost cooing at the dragons that were not that long ago trying to kill them, “Aw! They are so cute! When they aren’t trying to kill us.”
Catra rolls her eyes at him, “Can you guys give us some space?”
“No way!” Glimmer crosses her arms in front of her chest, “This is our safe spot. I am not moving!”
Catra huffs, “Fine. We’ll find somewhere private then.” The magicat holds her hand out to Adora who takes her hand and they start heading off further into the rocks, “Don’t come find us. We’ll come find you.” Catra calls back as Adora and her keep low and out of sight from the dragons that seem to have stopped paying attention to them.
Adora looks around as Catra pulls them higher up on the mountain, they look down and watch Bow and Glimmer leaning back against the rock looking exhausted. 2 of the dragons are still play fighting with each other, they are smaller than the third so they are probably younger than the other dragon, which has decided to take a nap just inside the shade of the cave.
“I think you’re right.” Adora says as they watch the dragons, “I think the big one was just defending it’s family.”

Catra sighs, “Yeah. Probably didn’t like me wondering into their home, huh?”
Adora nudges the magicat with a smile, “No. But I wouldn’t mind if you dropped by my home.”
Catra grins, “Would you want to go home after this?”
“I don’t know.” Adora wrings her fingers, “I mean, there’s not a lot to go back to, really.”
The magicat takes one of Adora’s hands and intertwines their fingers, “You don’t have to if you don’t want to, you know that right?” Adora nods looking down at their joined hands, “I mean, I’d like to take you back to my home when this is all over.”
“Really?” a cocky smile on Adora’s face, “You want to take me home, huh?”
“I mean, if you want to…” Catra looks away, “I mean, you don’t have to…”
“Catra.” Adora squeezes the magicat’s hand, “I would love to see your home.”
“Okay then.” They both watch as the 2 juvenile dragons return inside the cave leaving the more senior dragon to guard the entrance of the cave with their body, “Well, let’s see you then. Strip.”
Adora snorts, “Crude much?”
“No. I just like seeing you without much on.” Catra smirks, “Now come on.”
Adora slaps away Catra’s grabby hands on her clothes, “Hey! Stop that!” The smile on Adora’s face gives away any seriousness she may have had. When Catra removes her hands and puts them behind her back, “Okay, where was the last spot you noticed the map? Because as much as I know you like to see me bare, I would rather not be unclothed in a life or death situation.”
Catra scratches the top of her head, just to the side of her right ear, “Pretty sure, the cave was located here, by your breasts.” The magicat points to Adora’s chest with a grin, “So… if you could please lift up your shirt, I can see if there’s more to the map.”
Rolling her eyes, Adora turns her back to the dragons and the cliffs before lifting up her shirt, revealing her breasts to Catra, “See anything?”
“Uh huh.” Catra stares with a grin.

“Catra!”
“What? I’m looking!” the magicat huffs back, keeping her hands behind her back so she’s not tempted to touch, “The cave is still on here but…”
“But?”
“Hmm, that’s weird...” Catra hums to herself.
Adora in her curiosity tries to look as well but can’t due to having to hold her shirt up, effective blocking her own view, “Tell me!”
“You can put your shirt back down, princess.” Catra says as Adora lets her shirt drop back down covering her torso once again, “The cave isn’t the final destination. It’s still just a little bit further. Apparently, there’s a town not too far from here at the bottom of the hill.”
“That’s good, right?” Adora asks with a raised eyebrow.
“Uh… yeah?” Catra rubs the back of her neck, “Your map actually shows the final creature.”
“Okay… and what is it?” The blonde looking under her shirt to see if she can make it out.
“You won’t be able to see it.” Catra replies, “It’s at the bottom your breast.”
“Oh.”
“Yeah.”
“Okay, so what is the final creature?” Adora huffs, arms crossed over her chest.
“Do you know what a Hydra is?” Catra asks.
“No.”
“Okay. So, basically, it’s a creature that if you cut off one head, it grows another 2.” Catra explains, “If you keep cutting off its heads off, it’ll keep growing more.”
“That’s…not good.” Adora final settles on.
“No.” Catra agrees, “Because usually the easiest way to kill something is to cut its head off. But this… we’ll need to go for its body without being eaten.”
“Great…” Adora returns, “How far is the town?”
“Oh, not far at all.” Catra points in the direction of the town, “It’s just down there. You can see it from here. So probably half a day walk at the most. We just need to avoid them.” The magicat points to the dragons, “But I don’t think, they’ll be a problem once

we get out of their territory."
The blonde nods, "Come on. We need to get Bow and Glimmer and head to the town."
Catra lets Adora lead them back to their friends and all four of them keep as low as possible as they make their way down the mountain towards the town. Once they can no longer see the cave or the dragons, they all breathe a sigh of relief, standing up a little straighter as they walk normally again.

"So, you're telling us that the dragons aren't the final creatures?" Bow repeats after Adora had explained to the pair the new plan moving forwards, "And this new creature is some kind of… Hydra?"
"Is a Hydra, Bow." Catra corrects, "You've read about them, right?"
"Uh, kind of…" Bow's voice trails off.
"Bow!" Glimmer scolds, "What is it?"
"Just you know…" Bow smiles awkwardly at his wife, "They can have more than head if you cut off one."
"Yeah, we know that." Glimmer rolls her eyes, "What are you not telling us?"
The group stops and stares at Bow who stands there even more uncomfortably under the gaze of everyone's attention, he rocks back and forth on his feet until Glimmer knocks him on the back of the head.
"Ow!" Bow complains, "What was that for?"
"Quit stalling!" Glimmer scolds again.
"Fine! Fine!" Bow puts his hands up and takes a step back before taking in a deep breath, "This town we are heading too… it's a sacrificial town."
"What does that mean?" Catra pipes up, "You aren't saying people throw people into this town to get eaten by this thing, do you?"
"Kind of…"
"Bow!" Glimmer screeches.
"Alright! Yes." Bow replies fending off any further knocks to the back of the head by Glimmer, "The thing is, this Hydra is mythical, like old mythical."

“So?” Adora asks with a confused look on her face.
“So… it means that this Hydra has been attacked by many before us.” Bow replies.
“And?” Catra sighs, getting tired of the half answers Bow is providing.
“And… it may have more than one head already…” Bow concludes.
“Like… how many?” Glimmer asks this time, a look of shock on her face, “It’s bad enough facing one creature with one head…”
“How many people have tried to kill this thing?” Adora asks, “And how many years equates to mythical?”
Bow thinks about the second question for a moment, “From what I’ve read, people have been trying to rid this thing for over 200 years. No ones has succeeded, obviously.” He chuckles nervously at the prospect of being another fatality to this creature when they eventually get to the town at the bottom of the mountain.
“The town we are heading to, the town at the bottom of this mountain is called Algos. It was once a thriving town before this creature came along.”
Catra sighs, “Since it’s story time, we might as well take a break, make camp for the night.”
They all agree as they find a relatively safe spot inland, under the cover of some trees and surrounded by large rocks. Catra clears off the ground for her and Adora, moving a few of the larger rocks so they can sit back and lean against them before going in search for tinder and wood to build a fire. Bow and Glimmer squabble over where to rest for the night whilst Catra and Adora wonder around the trees, picking up branches and twigs from the ground as the sun begins to set. They return and set the fire and find Bow and Glimmer beaming with what looks like 2 rabbits in their possession.
“Look what we got!” Bow beams happily as he holds up their dinner for the night, “Caught it all by ourselves.”
Glimmer looks at him with the biggest smile on her face, “We sure did.” She says as she turns to the other couple, “See. We can hunt.”
“Good work, Sparkles and Bow.” Catra says much to Glimmers huffing.
“What!? Why doesn’t he get an annoying nickname too?”

Glimmers scoffs.
Catra chuckles Glimmers huffiness, “Because it’s funnier to rile you up, Sparkles. Call it a term of endearment.”
“Whatever… Wildcat.” That earns a low growl from Catra before Glimmer bursts out laughing, “Come on already, set the fire for us. I’m starving!”
“Alright!” Catra laughs, she signals to Adora to drop all the twigs and branches they’ve collected and gets to work on building the fire.

Once the fire is lit and their meals cooking over it, they all sit back and relax.
“Bow, finish your story from before.” Catra asks, “How many people have tried to kill this Hydra and how many heads does it have now?”
Bow lays his hands on his stomach and sighs, “In the last 200 years, I can’t really say for sure how many have tried to kill it, it’s not exactly all documented. But the ones that were and perished is around 80 I think. Well, 80 that I know of.”
“That’s not as many as I thought.” Adora says, trying to find a positive light on things.
“That’s how many that have been documented.” Glimmer points out, “He doesn’t actually know the true number.”
“Right.” Adora sits back and leans against Catra, “So many heads do you think it has now?”
Bow taps his fingers against his stomach as he thinks, “I can’t say for sure. The last time it was documented, the literature said it was up to eleven heads.”
“Eleven!” Catra sits up, jolting Adora a little, “Sorry princess.” The magicat says as she relaxes back and Adora leans back on her again, “Eleven…”
“Yeah.” Bow just stares into the fire.
“How can anything survive with eleven heads?” Adora asks, closing her eyes as she waits for an answer.
“I don’t know.” Bow replies, “Probably wouldn’t be very comfortable.”
Catra chuckles, “That sounds about right.” The magicat runs her hand throw Adora’s hair and rests her hand on the blonde’s

shoulder, “How do we kill it?”
“She-Ra has to kill it.” Bow replies, “According to the texts. Only the Sword can kill it. It’s been reaping havoc on that town for centuries.”
“Figures.” Catra says, “Guess She-Ra will save the day after all.”
Adora rubs her face on Catra’s shoulder, “Mm, can we talk about that later?”
“We should come up with a plan.” Bow sits up as he moves their catch around so it doesn’t burn, “I mean, more than She-Ra and her sword will kill it.”
Catra gently massages the base of Adora’s head, “It’ll be alright. We’ve got your back Adora.”
Adora smiles, her eyes still closed, “I know.”
“So… the plan?” Glimmer stands up, stretching her back, “Do we even have one?”
“Sure we do.” Catra grins, “We’ll talk about it in the morning after we’ve had a feed and a good night rest.”
“Fine.” Glimmer lets it go as they wait for their food to finish cooking. Bow and Glimmer drift off to sleep first as Catra and Adora take first watch.

Catra wakes up first, the blonde once again sleeping on the magicat’s arm, making it go numb. Catra smiles at a sleeping Adora, pressing a soft kiss to the blonde’s hair before pulling her arm free. She gets up to find Glimmer asleep and Bow pacing around the makeshift camp.
“Morning.” Catra whispers to Bow, keeping her voice low enough so not to wake up Adora, “I see Sparkles couldn’t stay awake.”
Bow smiles at his sleeping wife, “She looked like she needed it.” He replies as he puts is hands in his pockets, “So… today is the day.”
“Yeah.” Catra sighs, “It is.” The magicat looks over at their sleeping partners with a smile, “We’ll give them another hour, once the peaks over those trees, we get them up.”
Bow nods and begins to gather whatever belongings he can.
It’s not long before the sun peaks over the trees and they are gently rousing their loved ones. Glimmer grumbles out “5 more minutes” to Bow as he tries to get her to wake up.

Adora smiles when Catra presses a few soft kisses along the blonde's cheeks and jaw, "Morning…" the magicat hears Adora say roughly as she wakes up, rubbing her eyes and pressing a kiss onto Catra's lips.
"Time to get up, princess." Catra whispers into Adora's ear, her breath in the blonde's ear makes Adora giggle, "Come on. The faster we do this, the faster we can go home."
"I didn't know this was all about speed." Adora raises and eyebrow to the magicat.
"It isn't." Catra rolls her eyes, "But we really need to get this done. A town needs saving."
Adora smiles a little wider, "Yeah. We better go save it."
Catra helps Adora up onto her feet, picking up the few possessions they carried with them as they listen to Bow and Glimmer continue to argue about getting up. Catra laughs when Bow tries to lift her up and failing, making him almost topple over as well.
"Get up Sparkles. Time to go." Catra orders as Glimmer rolls over and glares at the magicat, "Come on. Get."
Glimmer groans, "Fine." She dusts herself off and gets up with the help of Bow, "Good morning to you too by the way."
"Morning!" Adora waves and greets happily, she turns to Catra, "How far do you think the town is from here?"
"Not too far." Catra replies, "I mean, once we get going that is."
"We're going!" Glimmers shouts over to them as they begin to trudge down the hill.
Once they start walking and wake up a little more, they begin to discuss their plans loosely on how to defeat the Hydra. Thinking that they've got some kind of plan, they move forward in relative silence. Resigned to their fate of facing this final creature.

They reach the town in good time, it takes barely 3 hours and they stand at the edge of the town, taking it all in. It's eerily quiet. As it should be since it's been inhabited by the Hydra for the last 200 years.
"Where do you think it is?" Glimmer whispers to the group as they look around the peripherals of town, "Do you think there's even anyone in this town?"

“Doubt it.” Catra replies flatly, “If there were, it wouldn’t be called the sacrificial town, would it?”
Glimmers rolls her eyes at the magicat, “Shut up, smartass.”
Catra cackles, not caring if they are heard much to Bow’s annoyance, “Shh! Do you want that thing to come after us?”
“Well, yes.” Catra replies like it’s obvious, “Isn’t that the whole point of being here?”
“Oh, yeah. Right.” Bow chuckles nervously, “Where should we look first?”
Catra takes a few steps into town and stops, pointing forward, “I think over there would be great place to start.”
The others join her and see where she’s pointing to, it happens to be the middle of town, completely decimated with skeletons and bones scattered all around the edges.
“Is that? Are those?” Adora asks, nudging a skull with her toe.
“Yeah.” Catra replies for everyone, “It’s got to be around here somewhere.”
“Split up guys, we’ll be able to find it faster.” Glimmer suggests.
“Yeah, no way Sparkles.” Catra retorts, “That’s a sure fire way for it to pick us off one at a time. It’ll be better if we stayed together. Have each other’s backs.”
“Okay, fine.” Glimmer huffs but not putting up much of a fight to get her way, “Well?”
“What?” Catra asks.
“What are we doing to draw it out?” Glimmer rolls her eyes.
Catra picks up the skull that Adora had just pushed with her toe before, steps forward and grins back at the group as she throws it as far as she can into the centre of town. It doesn’t make much of a noise by it does disturb other bits of bones and rubble around the area. The magicat turns back to them and smiles, “Come on. If we want it to come to us. We need to let it know that we are here.”
They all start making a ruckus, yelling and screaming as loud as they can, throwing whatever they can at the walls and breaking windows. Eventually all that noise is interrupted when a loud hissing sound emerges from one of the broken buildings with 2 walls still standing. Those 2 walls are promptly broken when the Hydra makes itself seen.

“Oh shit!” Glimmer mutters under her breath, “This is bad…”
“Not really.” Catra grins as she takes in sight of the Hydra before them, “This one’s only got the 1 head. What happened to the other 10?”
“I don’t really want to find out.” Bow replies as they start backing away from the hissing Hydra, “Adora…”
“Yeah?”
“Anytime now…” Bow’s voice squeaky with fear.
“Oh, right.” Adora grasps the handle of her sword, “For the Honour of Grayskull!”
The Hydra hisses at the bright light as She-Ra appears. Catra has her claws bared and fangs out as She-Ra pushes the magicat behind her, “Stay behind me, Catra.”
“No way, princess.” Catra moves to the side, “We do this, side by side.” A smirk on the magicats lips, “Oh, and remember. Don’t cut off its head.”
She-Ra smirks right back, “No. I’ll try not to.”
“Bow. Glimmer. Get into positions.” Catra orders them as the other two scramble off into separate abandoned buildings, “On my signal!”
“Aye Aye!” Bow shouts back once he reaches the rooftop.
Catra rolls her eyes, “Sparkles?! Where are you?”
Panting as she gets to the top of the rooftop, “I’m… here! Fuck, I really need to work out more…”
“Are you in position?” Catra yells out to her.
“Yes. Hurry up and do your thing!” Glimmer shouts back down from her spot on the roof.
Catra turns to She-Ra, “You take the front, I’ll go round the back. Remember…”
“No head cutting.” She-Ra answers cutting off Catra with a smile, “Be careful.”
“Careful dies, reckless kills!” Catra snarks before she sprints off toward the Hydra, sliding under its bite and managing to get to the other side without injury, “Your turn!”
She-Ra raises her sword and starts charging towards the Hydra, dodging its jaws whilst Catra slashes at its body with her claw and occasionally dodging the odd bite from the creature.
“Oops!” She-Ra lets out, “Sorry!”

“What?” Catra shouts from the back, “What oops?”
As she’s just finishing the question, she notices the Hydra’s head on the ground and her eyes widen, She-Ra looks back at Catra apologetically, “Sorry! I didn’t mean to…”
Just as She-Ra’s apologising to the magicat, the Hydra’s neck rises in the air from where it laid slain on the ground and splits in two in a gooey display before 2 new heads grow out of the ends taking the place of its fallen head.
“Sparkles! Bow! What are you waiting for?” Catra shouts to them as she jumps back avoiding a snapping head, “Light it up!”
“Move out the way!” Glimmer yells as she teleports the heavy stone bricks from the rooftop she’s on over the top of the Hydra. Catra flips away from the Hydra as She-Ra continues to punch and bash the Hydra’s heads with the side of her sword and her fists when the first of Glimmer’s teleporting stones falls over the Hydra’s body. They aren’t big enough to really injure the creature, but it creates enough of a distraction for Catra and She-Ra to back away to go grab the fuel from around the town whilst Glimmer keeps the Hydra busy.
“Hurry up guys!” Glimmer grunts feeling the power starting to drain from her as her attack on the Hydra begins to slow to the point where she can no longer teleport anymore stones and slumps down against the floor of the rooftop.
“Glimmer!” Bow shouts from his rooftop, “Stay there and get under cover!”
The sparkly princess can barely keep her eyes open let alone stand up on her own as the Hydra finally recovers from the barrage of stones falling on top it and begins to move towards the building Glimmer is situated on. Bow shoots an arrow at the Hydra’s massive body making it turn around and hiss at him before ignoring the arrow pricking it and continuing on towards Glimmer’s location.
“Guys! It’s going after Glimmer!” Bow screams out to She-Ra and Catra who are currently nowhere to be seen, “Where are you guys!?”
He’s torn between leaving his post and helping Glimmer as he frantically looks around trying to find the other couple. As he is about to abandon his post, he sees Catra running on all fours with

something in her mouth, She-Ra following close behind carrying a large keg.
"Glimmer!" He shouts once again.
"On it!" She-Ra shouts back to Bow as she starts pouring the contents of the keg on the body of the Hydra while Catra starts unreeling the rope she had in her mouth, laying it out a few metres.
"Glimmer will be fine!" Catra yells to Bow, "Get ready!" The magicat unwinds the second rope she had wrapped over her shoulder and turns to She-Ra, "We need to get the 2 heads together!"
She-Ra nods as she finishes pouring out the rest of the contents of the key on the Hydra as the creature begins snapping towards the both of them. One head goes for She-Ra and the other head goes for Catra. They've got the Hydra backed up against a damaged building wall and there's no way for Catra to slip behind it now. The magicat ties the rope into a lasso and begins swinging it in the air, trying to time it so she can wrangle both heads at the same time. She-Ra coaxes the Hydra to attack her but only manages to get one to pay attention to her, the other one annoyingly decides to go for Catra.
"Bow! Fire! Now!" Catra shouts up as she ropes one of the heads as the second one just won't cooperate with their plan, "Adora! Move!"
A flaming arrow comes whizzing past Catra's ear as it just pierces the Hydra before the whole creature is set alight. Catra and She-Ra both move backwards of the flames as Bow continues to shoot flaming arrow one after another until he has exhausted all his ammunition. The creature hisses in pain from the fire as it now follows Catra and She-Ra as they start running away. The flames eventually hit the rope that Catra has laid from before and it ignites, burning down the length of the rope and that goes around the Hydra, creating a wall of flame in an attempt to stop the creature from venturing out too far.
Catra dodges a flaming head snapping at her as She-Ra punches the other head.
"You need to stab it, Adora!" Catra says as she side steps another snap and clawing the head a little, "I'll get its attention on me!"

“Catra! No!” She-Ra screams as Catra lands a punch on the Hydra’s head before climbing onto its neck and avoiding the flames that burning it’s back.
“Fuck!” Catra grunts out as she’s bit on the shoulder and lifted off the Hydra’s body by the second head, flailing around in the air, trying to slash the creature with her claws as the other head keeps She-Ra preoccupied.
“Catra!” She-Ra shouts again as the head she’s fighting snaps at her and then sweeps its head violently, swatting She-Ra away with an “Oomph!”
Catra struggles as the second head now focusses in on the magicat and all Catra can think is that she’ll be another meal for this creature. But she’s not doing down without a fight. She shakes herself free of the Hydra’s jaw, effectively ripping away the shoulder muscles as she growls and grunts in pain as she sees She-Ra getting up slowly from the far side. With her left shoulder arm now practically useless with most of the muscles and tendons ripped out of her shoulder, she pounces up and attacks the Hydra with her good arm and claws. Her feet clawed into eh creatures flaming back as she dodges and swipes back at the Hydra’s head before sinking her teeth into neck of one of the heads.
“Look out!” She-Ra screams as she sprints full tilt towards the Hydra’s body, sword stretched out in front of her as she jumps up high into the air and over the dual heads before plunging the blade of her sword straight down into the middle of its back. The Hydra howls in pain as both heads try in vain to reach it’s back to pull the sword out.
Catra groans as she pounces off the Hydra and takes a few steps back to watch She-Ra at work, a grin on her face as she begins to feel herself go faint. She-Ra pulls the sword out of the Hydra’s back before stabbing it again his time closer to its neck. This time instead of cutting off its heads, she pulls the sword back and runs the sword the Hydra’s body from front to back, splitting it in half. She-Ra jumps off the creature once she’s cut through the final scales and lands next to Catra who’s panting heavily and favouring her right side as the magicat drops down to one knee. She-Ra watches as the Hydra hisses one more time before it is split in two, peeling apart in the middle, each side landing on the ground

with a thump as the Hydra finally falls. She-Ra is still breathing heavily, sword in her hand as she turns to Catra.
The magicat turns to She-Ra with a weak grin, “Hey, Adora.” Before she falls forward and blacks out.
“Catra! No!” She-Ra screams as she tries to cradle Catra’s head before it hits the ground, only to just manage it, “No, no, no, no!”
The magicat lies limp in Adora’s arms, barely breathing and unconscious as Bow runs past them, “Hey! Glimmer needs help!”
He doesn’t even take a moment to see Catra lying in She-Ra’s arms as he runs up the stairs to where Glimmer is still on the rooftop, drained of power and exhausted. She-Ra picks Catra up in her arms and rushes after Bow to the rooftop where Glimmer lies slumped against a stone wall.
She-Ra looks over to Bow, “It’s Catra! I think she’s really hurt!”
The fear in She-Ra’s voice cracks as Bow slides next to his wife, checking on her first, he turns back to She-Ra, “Just heal her, Adora.”
“I don’t know if I can!” She-Ra cries, “I don't know how I did it last time! This seems so much worse!”
Once Bow is done checking on the state of Glimmer, he runs back over to She-Ra and places a reassuring and calming hand on her shoulder, “Adora, you can do this. You’ve done this before. You can do it again.”
She-Ra shakes her head, unable to concentrate on her own magic to heal Catra, “I can’t!”
He places both hands on She-Ra’s shoulders now and looks down at Catra, “Yes. You can. I believe in you. We believe in you.”
She-Ra nods as she tries to smile but when she looks down at Catra, she feels nothing but doom. She-Ra pulls Catra closer to her, the magicat’s heart against her ear as she whispers to Catra, “You’re not done yet. You still have to show me your home…”
Bow takes a step back to look for something to put pressure on Catra’s wounds as She-Ra continues to whisper into Catra’s chest. “Come on, Catra.” She-Ra whispers, “You can’t leave me…”
Before Bow can run back with a few torn rags, he is halted by a bright healing light from She-Ra which makes him stop in his tracks and shuts his eyes. When he opens them, She-Ra has transformed back to Adora and Catra’s arm has stopped bleeding,

it’s still damaged but it doesn’t look like she’ll bleed out anymore, so he drops the rags. The magicat’s breathing gets stronger but she stays knocked out.
“Adora?” Bow approaches.
“She’ll be fine.” Adora smiles softly at the magicat still in her arms, “I couldn’t heal her arm completely but, she’ll be fine. She’s alive.”
Bow smiles back, “I’m just going to check on Glimmer.”
Adora nods as Bow takes his wife into his arms and lets her lean into him. Glimmer groans when she’s moved into his arms, her eyes open and she smiles back to him, “Did we get it?”
“Yeah, we got it.” Bow replies with the gentlest of kisses to Glimmers cheek, “It’s done. We can go home.”
“Catra?” Adora whispers into the magicat’s ear, “Can you hear me?”
For a moment, there’s no movement from Catra apart from the steady breaths of her chest, Adora’s squeezes her eyelids shut as she holds Catra tighter in her arms. Then she feels Catra’s tail wrap around her wrist and the flicker of her ear against Adora’s cheek before the magicat groans softly, the pain still not subsided but better than before.
Catra’s eyes open as do Adora’s, “Hey Adora…”
Adora pulls her in closer, kissing the magicat’s neck and jaw as Catra huffs a laugh, “You scared me, jerk!”
The magicat hisses as she tries to move her left arm only to find very little movement in it, but a lot of pain. Instead her right hand wipes the tears from Adora’s cheek, “Sorry. Didn’t mean to get all reckless on you…”
“You’re always reckless!” Adora chastises with a roll of her eyes, “I’m surprised you’ve survived this long without me.”
Catra nods in agreement, “What would I do without you?”
“Ahem…” Bow interrupts as him and Glimmer are now upright, “Can we go home now?”
Catra looks at Adora, “Help me up?”
Adora pulls Catra up with her by the magicat’s good arm, “Is this it?” Adora asks the group, “Are we done?”
Catra laughs, “Did you want more?”
“I’m ready to go home and sleep in my bed again.” Glimmer says with a tired look in her eyes, “I think I’m going to give it a little

while before we go on another adventure…”
Bow nods, “Yeah, I just want to be back in our bed.”
“Gross.” Catra sticks her tongue out before noticing the rags on the ground, she moves and picks them up with her right hand and holds them out to Bow, “Can you tie these together? I think I’m going to need a sling for my dead arm.”
Bow takes the rags and gets to work as Adora sidles up next to Catra, “So… you going to take me home?”
With a grin, Catra answers, “Definitely.”

Chapter End Notes

And... that's the end of it.
Thanks for reading, kudos and any comments!

End Notes

Updating every week on Sundays (Trying to anyways)

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!